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Retail inflation rose to 6.09% on-year in Oct, crossing the RBI's upper tolerance limit for the first time under the new CPI series ▶ Page 1

▶ Bharti Group Open to Raising Eutelsat OneWeb Stake to 30%: Sunil Mittal ▶ Tata Sons Rejects Noel Tata's Call for Sept 17 Board Meet Recording P 1

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CHIEF FINANCIAL OFFICER COLETTE KRESS NAMED INTERIM CEO

JENSEN, CHIEF EXIT OFFICER, NVIDIA

Face of AI boom shown the door after reports of two affairs—one with alleged Chinese spy, another with co's VP

Nvidia chief executive officer (CEO) Jensen Huang, the face of the AI infrastructure boom, was ousted from his post after reports of two affairs, including one with a woman suspected of spying for China.

Longtime chief financial officer Colette Kress will take over as interim CEO, Nvidia said on Thursday, and Huang will no longer have ties with the chipmaker. The board, which has never had a chair before, appointed director Harvey Jones to that role. Jones, 73, formerly led Synopsys, a company that Nvidia took a $2 billion stake in last year.

The resignation deepens a crisis partly of Nvidia's own making, since the company has long lacked a clear succession plan. The 63-year-old has been Nvidia's only CEO during its three-decade history. "Jensen's contributions to Nvidia are profound," the board said. "Nvidia is one of the most consequential technology companies in the world. The board and the company thank Jensen for his immeasurable contributions to the company and the industry."

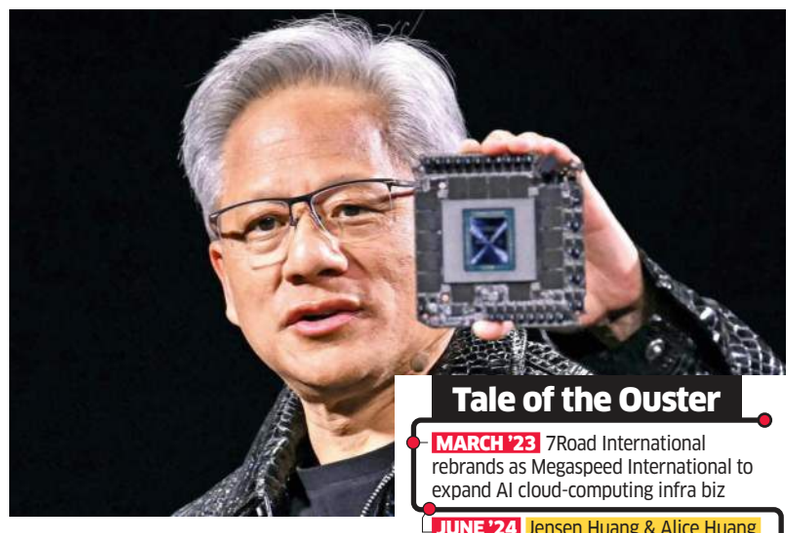
Huang, one of the three engineers who founded the chipmaker in 1993, had been under intense pressure since Sunday, when he admitted to a romantic relationship with Alice Huang, a former executive at the Singapore-based data centre firm Megaspeed International. He also had a relationship with Kimberly Powell, Nvidia's vice president of healthcare.

Under Huang's leadership, Nvidia's shares had soared more than 700,000% since it became a public company in 1999. The firm's market valuation has at times topped $5 trillion, ranking it among the largest companies in the world.

FORFEITS $108 M IN UNVESTED EQUITY

Huang will forfeit about $108 million in unvested equity compensation after being ousted--a fraction of his total wealth. The relinquished awards represent roughly 0.07% of his net worth, according to the Bloomberg Billionaires Index, which put his fortune at $144.5 billion before Thursday's announcement.

The company's equity compensation policy specifies that unvested RSUs, or restricted stock units, are forfeited once an executive terminates continuous service. **Bloomberg**



Tale of the Ouster

- **MARCH '23** 7Road International rebrands as Megaspeed International to expand AI cloud-computing infra biz
- **JUNE '24** Jensen Huang & Alice Huang are photographed together at the Computex conference in Taiwan
- **MAY '25** Video footage show the two attending a private dinner in Taipei
- **OCT '25** NYT reports on their socialising, reveals investigators are examining Megaspeed for chip exports to China
- **DEC '25** Prez Trump allows shipments of H200 AI chips to China
- **EARLY '26** Secy of state Rubio warns senior officials of the duo's relationship
- **MAY '26** Trump adds Jensen's name to US delegation list for Beijing at the last minute
- **SEP '26** Trump, Huang speak out against proposals to slow AI development at All-In summit
- **OCT '26** Ex-CEO awarded National Medal of Science
- **OCT '26** NYT reports US intelligence officials feared Alice was **acting on behalf of Chinese intelligence**. Nvidia says duo's relationship not 'unusual'
- **NOV 5 '26** Top House Republicans request closed-door briefing from Jensen on Nov 18 regarding allegations
- **NOV 8 '26** Huang admits he was unfaithful to his wife. Nvidia's board launches probe into potential foreign intelligence targeting then CEO
- **NOV 9, '26** House Democratic leader Hakeem Jeffries pushes for defence bill chip restrictions. **Shareholders file a proposed class-action lawsuit accusing Nvidia and Huang of fraud.**
- **NOV 10, 2026** The Information reports the affair facilitated at least $7.5 B in chip shipments to Chinese cos. Nvidia hires former acting US Attorney Joon Kim to lead probe
- **NOV 11, '26** NYT reports Huang also had an affair with Nvidia VP Kimberly Powell. Board meets
- **NOV 12, 2026** Nvidia announces Huang has resigned as president, CEO, and board member effective immediately

'ONE LEGEND IN PLACE OF ANOTHER'

Trump Bats for Cook

US President Donald Trump said on Thursday that former Apple CEO Tim Cook should replace Jensen Huang at Nvidia. "Now that Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang, who has done a fantastic job, has resigned, there is only one man to take his place -- Tim Cook of Apple," Trump said on his Truth Social network. "A Legend replaces a Legend!"

During his second presidency, Trump has treated Nvidia Huang as a close adviser, even bringing him on board Air Force One for a state visit to China in May. AFP

Would Be an Honour to Hire Huang: Musk

Elon Musk said early on Thursday that it would be an honoUr to hire Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang. Musk, in a response to a post urging him to recruit Huang, said: "That would be an honour." The statement from the Tesla CEO came before Huang's ouster. Musk and Huang have known each other for at least a decade, and both men joined US President Donald Trump's high-profile visit to China earlier this year. Musk previously expressed his admiration for Huang and said he expected to continue ordering chips from Nvidia. Bloomberg

Stock Falls in Early Trade, Pares Losses

New York: The US stock market has erased its early losses on Thursday after absorbing big swings for Nvidia's stock and oil prices. The moves suggest Wall Street sees limited fallout for the artificial intelligence industry, which carries immense influence on the market, following the sudden fall for one of its biggest evangelists. The Dow Jones Industrial Average was up 175 points, or 0.3%, while the Nasdaq composite rose 0.2% after eliminating an early drop of 1.6%. At the centre of the swings was Nvidia's stock. It plunged 14% at the start of trading following the resignation of Jensen Huang before paring some losses and was trading at $165, 4.81% lower at 11.45 PM. AP

Fearing Curbs, China's AI Cos Rush to Secure Nvidia Chip Capacity

Beijing: Chinese AI companies are trying to rent Nvidia-powered computing capacity outside China, worried that the scandal involving the US chipmaker's CEO Jensen Huang could spur Washington to tighten restrictions on their remote use of advanced processors, three sources said.

Seeking to protect US dominance of the critical sector, Washington restricts exports to China of Nvidia's most advanced AI chips. But Chinese companies can access such processors remotely by renting computing power at data centres overseas. A major Chinese cloud provider has discussed internally whether to lock in overseas Nvidia chip capacity, while some firms have contacted data-centre operators about reserving it, the sources said, asking not to be identifies.

The cos fear that the controversy could add political momentum to the Remote Access Security Act

Smaller AI labs are considering similar steps, including approaching major providers of rented computing power in Southeast Asia. The companies fear the controversy surrounding Huang could add political momentum to the Remote Access Security Act (RASA) a US bill that would give the commerce department authority to regulate remote, cloud-based access to restricted technology. The House of Representatives passed the bill in January by a 369-22 vote, and it awaits Senate action.

Advanced Nvidia processors are used to train and run the AI models behind chatbots and other generative AI products. Restricting overseas cloud access would make it harder for Chinese developers to obtain high-end computing power without importing the chips directly. **Reuters**

CFO Colette Kress to Chip in, For Now, To Clear the Mess

Nvidia chief financial officer (CFO) Colette Kress is set to take over as interim CEO from Jensen Huang, the company said on Thursday. Here are some facts about Kress

CFO SINCE 2013: Kress joined Nvidia in September 2013 as executive vice president and chief financial officer and has held the post since. She has appeared alongside Jensen Huang on the company's quarterly earnings calls. Nvidia's revenue was $4.13 billion in the fiscal year she joined and $215.9 billion in fiscal 2026.

CAREER BEFORE NVIDIA: Before Nvidia, Kress spent eight years in finance roles at Texas Instruments, then worked at Microsoft from 1997 to 2010. At Microsoft, she became CFO of the Server and Tools division in 2006, with responsibility for its financial strategy, planning and reporting. She moved to Cisco in 2010 as senior VP and CFO of its Business Technology and Operations Finance organisation

EDUCATION Kress holds a bachelor of science degree in finance from the University of Arizona and a master of business administration degree from Southern Methodist University.

WEALTH: Forbes ranks Kress No. 32 on its 2026 list of America's richest self-made women. Her shares in the chip firm were valued at roughly $750 million, as of Wednesday's close, down from more than $1 billion at the stock's peak last month. **Reuters**

Alice in Homeland: Alleged Spy is in Beijing

The suspected Chinese spy at the centre of the scandal that took down chief executive officer Jensen Huang has returned to her home country, according to sources.

Megaspeed International founder Alice Huang is currently living in Beijing with the knowledge of security officials, one of the sources said, seeking anonymity. It wasn't immediately clear when or why she traveled to the capital, nor what she may be engaged in.

MEGASPEED TO AID PROBE

Megaspeed, the Singapore-headquartered tech company at the centre of the scandal, pledged on Thursday to cooperate with investigations.

"Megaspeed has retained a leading US law firm to lead a comprehensive census of its graphics processing units (GPUs) and independently verify its export control compliance practices," CEO Tan Yong Pong via a statement posted on the company's website, adding, "Megaspeed takes its compliance obligations under US export control laws extremely seriously. Megaspeed is committed to working constructively and transparently with the US government," it said. **Agencies**

AI-opener Cos Eye Ex-spies Amid Security Risks

Amsterdam: AI firms are hiring former intelligence operatives to help shield them from espionage, a risk thrust into the spotlight as Nvidia axed its CEO Jensen Huang. Former intelligence officers, recruiters and company insiders said that chip, AI and tech firms—which have boomed in the last few years on huge artificial intelligence demand—have been beefing up their security muscle. "The AI firms have snapped up a lot of security talent," said Christopher Falkenberg, a former US Secret Service agent and now president of Insite Risk Management.

NEW HIRING TREND

Revelio Labs, which tracks hiring trends, said that counterintelligence hiring was a new phenomenon at AI firms, with more explicit roles being posted in the last couple of years by the likes of OpenAI, Anthropic and Nvidia. Most salaries ranged between $200,000 and $500,000.

Experts said counter-intelligence hiring was a new phenomenon at AI firms

Catherine Marinis-Yaqub, a former CIA officer who works for strategic risk and security firm Control Risks, said companies valued counterintelligence experts for their ability to spot threats such as employees stealing trade secrets and attempts to exploit vulnerabilities, including via executives, by blackmail or coercion. She helps spot threats that can look like chance encounters at gyms or coffee shops, which could be spies trying to befriend, blackmail or recruit them. "They're becoming more aware, but have a long way to go," she said.

AI VS HUMAN INTELLIGENCE

The AI firms have brought in big guns. OpenAI appointed former National Security Agency director Paul Nakasone to its board and security committee in June 2024. It is now hiring a senior global security investigator. The ad lists counterintelligence as a key skill. **Reuters**

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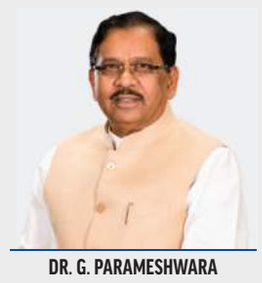
DR. G. PARAMESHWARA
Hon'ble Dy. Chief Minister
Government of Karnataka

AI-led Hiring Slowdown is Temporary, says Kris Gopalakrishnan

The current slowdown in hiring at technology services companies is a temporary consequence of the industry's transition towards AI-led offerings, Infosys cofounder S 'Kris' Gopalakrishnan said. He predicted a sharp increase in demand for AI-skilled talent over the next three to five years. ▸▸ 7

■ PM Modi Heads to Manila for ASEAN, E Asia, Quad Meets ▸▸ 3

■ Bullet-riddled Bodies of 2 SPOs Found in Kishtwar ▸▸ 3

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Kia India, Suppliers to Invest $2b in Andhra Pradesh for 2nd Mfg Plant

Korean auto major Kia India on Thursday said it will invest $2 billion, along with its supplier partners, to set up its second manufacturing facility in Andhra Pradesh. The facility will have installed capacity of 200,000 units per annum, taking Kia India's annual combined capacity across both plants to over 600,000 units. **ET was the first to report on August 13 that the carmaker was planning to expand car manufacturing capacity in India** to meet an expected sales growth in the domestic market and overseas demand. ▸▸ 8

Tata Sons Rejects Noel's Demand for Sept 17 Board Meet Recording

No conflict of interest in Venu Srinivasan, TVS ties with group, replies holdco in Nov 9 letter

Kala Vijayraghavan

Mumbai: Tata Sons has rebuffed Tata Trusts chairman Noel Tata's demand for a recording of the September 17 board meeting at which N Chandrasekaran was reappointed chairman of the group holding company for a second term. Tata Sons said in a November 9 letter, which ET has seen, that it's not required to retain or share audio-video recordings of in-person board meetings with directors under the law or its Articles of Association. Noel Tata is also Tata Trusts nominee director on the board of Tata Sons.

In its response to Noel Tata's communications of September 18, September 30, October 8 and October 26, the holding company said video recording of board proceedings is mandated only when one or more directors attend a meeting online. Recording of in-person meetings, it said, is not a requirement under the Articles of Association or the law.

"The company has never in the past had a practice of sharing audio/video recording of proceedings of an in-person board meeting with the directors," the letter said.

Tata Sons further clarified that recordings of in-person meetings are intended only to assist the company secretary in preparing draft minutes.

Tata Sons-TVS Transactions ▸▸ 11

Back and Forth

Noel's notes on Chandra reappointment minutes reviewed: Tata Sons
Says **appropriate changes** incorporated, final minutes to be uploaded on board app

Holdco says selection committee provision under Art 118 does not apply to reappointment of incumbent chairman

Backs Venu Srinivasan's vote for Chandra, says his TVS association poses no conflict and his son's role at TVS does not automatically create one

Dismisses conflict-of-interest allegations, says no business transactions between the holding co and TVS Motor or Hanno One Warehousing

N Chandrasekaran | Noel Tata

PROPOSED UNIT IN ODISHA TO RAISE TOTAL CAPACITY BY 80%

Wanted: Bids for India's Largest Petro Reserve

Partial leasing of Vizag facility also sought

Sanjeev Choudhary

New Delhi: India is seeking private investors to build its largest strategic petroleum reserve in Odisha. The facility, with a capacity to store four million tonnes (MT) of crude oil, is estimated to cost ₹8,571 crore.

The proposed facility, which will come up at Chandikhol, would increase the nation's existing strategic petroleum storage capacity by 80%.

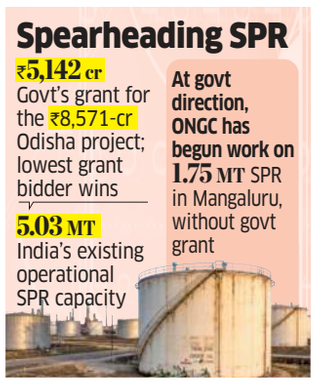
Dealing with Hormuz Disruptions ▸▸ 11

Spearheading SPR

₹5,142 cr Govt's grant for the ₹8,571-cr Odisha project; lowest grant bidder wins

5.03 MT India's existing operational SPR capacity

At govt direction, ONGC has begun work on 1.75 MT SPR in Mangaluru, without govt grant



RETAIL INFLATION SURGES TO 6.09%

Oct CPI Past RBI Limit, a First under New Series

Indicator last crossed 6% level in Oct '24

Our Bureau

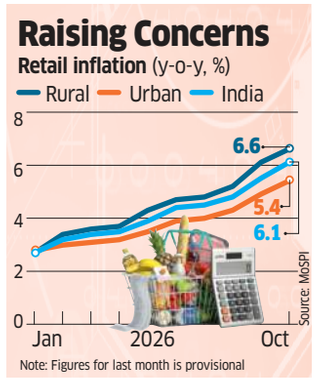
New Delhi: Retail inflation shot up to 6.09% year-on-year in October, breaching the upper tolerance limit of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for the first time under the new consumer price index (CPI) series, according to data released on Thursday by the ministry of statistics and programme implementation.

The increase was driven by a spurt in food prices.

Rate Hike Expectations in Dec ▸▸ 11

Raising Concerns

Retail inflation (y-o-y, %)



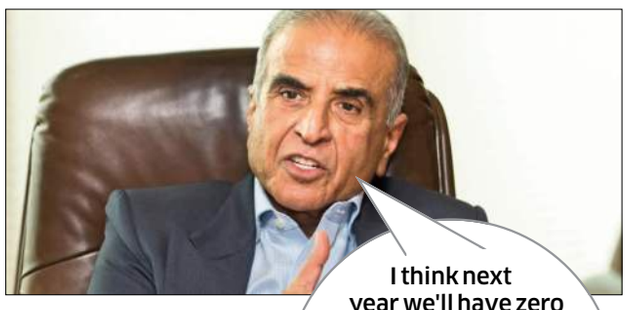
Note: Figures for last month is provisional

ET INTERVIEW

SUNIL BHARTI MITTAL
CHAIRMAN, BHARTI ENTERPRISES

Open to Raising Stake in Eutelsat OneWeb to 30%

Eyes 1B global telecom users; will bet big on fin services, sovereign cloud, AI data centres


AMRENDRA

I think next year we'll have zero public debt and only DoT's spectrum payments and AGR liabilities will remain. The company now has to start to think about where to apply cash flow

Kiran Rathee & Vinay Pandey

New Delhi: The Bharti Group is open to increasing its stake in Eutelsat OneWeb to around 30%, matching that of the French government, but it will not become a majority shareholder. The satellite company will primarily remain European, Bharti Enterprises chairman Sunil Bharti Mittal told **ET**.

Apart from satcom, financial services, sovereign cloud and AI data centres will be the next big bets while Bharti Airtel pursues one billion global customers in its telecom business, said Mittal, laying out his plans as the Bharti Group completes half a century this year.

FULL INTERVIEW ▸▸ PAGE 10

With Airtel now a well-established enterprise, the Group would now look at expansion.

Mittal said he is aware that succession can be disruptive and any founder must leave behind as much clarity as possible.

"We have created or laid early foundations of what I call House of Bharti. It's a charter that I have created for the next generation," he said.

"One thing I'm ensuring is in all situations, you bulletproof your enterprises. If there's a contest between the family and enterprise, enterprise wins every time, that's how I see it."

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MODI ADDRESSES JOURNALISTS

Today, Our Country is Working Towards a Deadline – 2047: PM at Diwali Milan

'The dream of making our country developed has been with us since independence'

Our Political Bureau | PTI

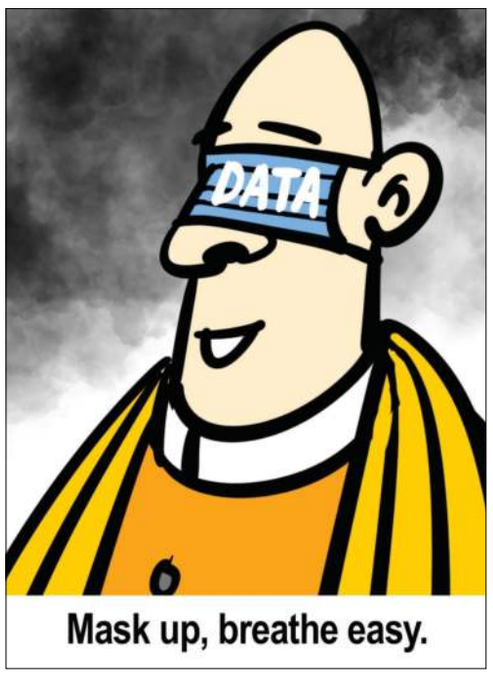
New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said the country has fascinating achievements to share with the world and urged the media to spotlight on the global stage these successes, terming them as the 'India Story'.

Addressing a Diwali Milan for journalists at the BJP headquarters here, Modi said in the world of news, one thing is very important: the deadline as the entire life of a journalist revolves around deadlines — whether it is the time a newspaper goes to print or a story is broadcast, every deadline is set.

"Today, our country is also working toward a deadline. That deadline is, the year 2047. The dream of making our country developed has been with us since independence. But now this dream has a set date, 2047. That means we must work together to make India a developed nation before we complete 100 years of independence," he said.

We have the 'India Story'. We must consider whether our news truly reflects India, our achievements... There is no shortage of such stories in India

POLILOQUY R PRASAD



'SAMAJIK PARIVARTAN MORCHA' AIMS TO CONSOLIDATE DALIT & MUSLIM VOTES

UP's New Front Takes Shape; Owaisi Names Azad as CM Face of Alliance

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: To consolidate Dalit and Muslim votes ahead of the 2027 Uttar Pradesh assembly elections, AIMIM chief Asaduddin Owaisi and Azad Samaj Party (Kanshiram) president Chandrashekhar Azad on Thursday joined hands to form the Samajik Parivartan Morcha, with Owaisi announcing Azad as the alliance's chief ministerial candidate.

Addressing a joint press conference in Lucknow, Owaisi said the alliance would seek to prevent BJP from returning to power in the state for a third consecutive term. "We have decided to form the Samajik Parivartan Morcha. I can say with confidence that this will be a strong Morcha to stop BJP from coming to power in UP for the third time," Owaisi said.

Announcing Azad as the CM face, he added, "The change we envision will truly take shape once Chandrashekhar Azad becomes the chief minister."

Azad rejected the description of the formation as a third front, insisting that it was a broader political movement for social transformation. "It is not a third front. It is the Samajik Parivartan Morcha. If you understand its depth, you will realise that it is the first front," he said.

Accusing successive governments of failing to deliver social justice, Azad said the Bahujan community continued to remain deprived despite changes in political dispensations. "We will no longer be swayed by anyone's influence. We will look after our own interests. We will not go around begging for favours from anyone," he said.

On the electoral strategy, Azad said there were no differences between the two parties over seat-sharing and that they would jointly contest all 403 assembly constituencies. He also invited Samajwadi Party and Congress to join the alliance.

The announcement comes as both parties have stepped up their preparations for the polls. AIMIM has announced candidates for three constituencies, while ASPK has so far named candidates for 87 seats.

The two had joined hands ahead of the 2022 assembly polls as part of the Bhagidari Parivartan Morcha, which failed to win a single seat.

It is not a third front... If you understand its depth, you will realise that it is the first front... We (Bahujan community) will no longer be swayed... We will not go around begging for favours from anyone
CHANDRASHEKHAR AZAD
ASP (Kanshiram) President

We have decided to form the Samajik Parivartan Morcha. I can say with confidence that this will be a strong Morcha to stop BJP from coming to power in UP for the third time
ASADUDDIN OWAISI
AIMIM Chief

Azad invites Samajwadi Party and Congress to join alliance

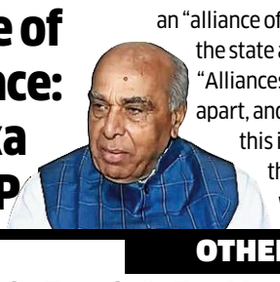
'WE WELCOME MORCHA'

Alliance will Cost BJP Another 2-3% of Votes: Akhilesh

LUCKNOW: SP chief Akhilesh Yadav welcomed 'Samajik Parivartan Morcha', saying the development will provide another option to voters and cost BJP 2-3% of its vote share in the UP polls. In a post on X, he said: "We welcome the 'Samajik Parivartan Morcha' (Social Change Front)! Change at the social level is certainly necessary, but true success will only be achieved when the 'Rajneetik Parivartan Morcha' (Political Change Front) becomes active. Whoever genuinely fights against communal forces for the welfare of the PDA (Pichhda, Dalit, Alpsankhyak) community and raises the voice of the PDA society, we will cooperate in taking their honest voice to the public," he said. – ANI

'BJP TO FORM GOVT AGAIN'

An Alliance of Convenience: Jagdambika Pal of BJP



LUCKNOW: BJP MP Jagdambika Pal on Thursday dismissed the newly announced alliance, terming it an "alliance of convenience" and expressing confidence that BJP will form the government in the state again. Reacting to the formation of the 'Samajik Parivartan Morcha', Pal said: "Alliances are formed before elections, and after losing the elections, these alliances fall apart, and they hurl abuses at each other. So the people of the state already know that this is just an electoral alliance, just an alliance of convenience." Pal further asserted that BJP will retain power in Uttar Pradesh in the 2027 assembly elections. "BJP will form the government in Uttar Pradesh again," he asserted. – ANI

OTHER NEWS OF THE DAY

Akali Dal Waris Punjab De Urges ECI to Expedite its Registration

CHANDIGARH: Akali Dal Waris Punjab De has urged Election Commission of India to expedite its registration as a political party, alleging undue delay in processing its application. In a representation to ECI through Punjab CEO, Waris Punjab De said its application for registration under Section 29A of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, had been pending since January 22, 2025. – PTI

CM Reddy Appears in Court Over Covid-19 Norms Violation Case

HYDERABAD: Telangana chief minister A Revanth Reddy on Thursday appeared before a local court over a case registered against him in 2021 for alleged violation of Covid-19 norms during an assembly bypoll campaign in Nalgonda district. The case was booked against Reddy at Peddavoora police station during the campaign for the Nagarjuna Sagar byelection. – PTI

TN Minister Rejects DK's Proposal on Mekedatu Dam

After DK's statement that state does not need TN's permission to build a dam across Cauvery river

PTI

Chennai | Tiruchirapalli: Tamil Nadu minister for rural dvelopment and water resources N Anand on Thursday rejected Karnataka chief minister DK Shivakumar's recent assertion regarding construction of the Mekedatu dam on the Cauvery river, saying the state government will not permit the project.

His remarks follow Shivakumar's statement that Karnataka does not need TN's permission to build the Mekedatu dam across the Cauvery river. Shivakumar was responding to a letter sent by CM Joseph Vijay to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, objecting to the Mekedatu project and seeking the Centre's intervention.

In his response, Shivakumar had said there is "no need for permission from anyone," claiming that the Supreme Court has already given permission for Karnataka to build the dam, provided they release 177 TMC of water to Tamil Nadu. He also claimed that the balancing reservoir would benefit Tamil Nadu more than Karnataka.

Anand said, "Under no circumstances will we allow that, and certainly, nothing will ever happen as he (Shivakumar) claims." Meanwhile, DMK leader Duraimurugan claimed that since the Cauvery is an interstate river, no single state can independently build a new dam or store water. "Not even a single bucket of water from the Cauvery can be withheld without Tamil Nadu's consent," he said. Refuting Shivakumar's claim that the SC had granted permission to construct the dam, he said there is no such binding legal ruling.

INVESTMENT BUZZ

Chief Minister DK Shivakumar at the inauguration of Invest Karnataka – Global Investors Meet 2027 at a hotel in Bengaluru on Thursday. IANS

'EXTENDED SERVICE WILL STRENGTHEN FORCES'

Agnipath Tweaked After Armed Forces' Feedback: Rajnath

Urges top officers to retain op readiness, with jointness being the key along with tech superiority

Manu Pubby

New Delhi: The decision to extend the 'tour of duty' for soldiers recruited under the Agnipath scheme was taken following feedback from the armed forces, defence minister Rajnath Singh said on Thursday, adding that it reflected the government's commitment to incorporating suggestions by the services into policy decisions.

He also expressed confidence that the extended tour of duty for Agniveers would contribute to further bolstering the armed forces. The government announced on November 4 that it has overhauled the Agnipath scheme for recruitment into the armed forces, opening a route to permanent service for all soldiers instead of requiring 75% to leave after serving for four years.

Speaking at the Air Force Commanders Conference, the minister urged top officers to retain operational readiness, with jointness holding the key along with technological superiority.

He also emphasised the need to continue bolstering intelligence and surveillance capabilities, enhance integration among systems and identify potential threats before they unfold.

"Our defence forces must develop capabilities and methods that leave the adversary with no time to react or recover while simultaneously ensuring that we are never caught off guard by an unexpected move from the enemy."

Rajnath Singh launches a suite of AI apps developed in-house by IAF's AI Centre of Excellence – PTI

Our defence forces must develop capabilities and methods that leave the adversary with no time to react or recover while simultaneously ensuring that we are never caught off guard by an unexpected move from the enemy. Surprise can manifest in various forms, both conventional and electronic
RAJNATH SINGH
Defence Minister

PAN-INDIA COASTAL DEFENCE EXERCISE

Navy Conducts 5th Edition of 'Sea Vigil-26'

VASCO (GOA): Indian Navy is conducting the fifth edition of the pan-India Coastal Defence Exercise 'Sea Vigil-26' across the country's coastline and Exclusive Economic Zone from November 11 to 19, with a focus on evaluating coastal security preparedness, identifying gaps and strengthening coordination among maritime stakeholders. The biennial exercise is being conducted in two phases. The first phase, the Coastal Defence and Security Readiness Evaluation, is underway, followed by the Sea Phase on November 18 and 19. – ANI

A NECESSARY STEP TO REGULATE FOREIGN FUNDING: RSS-LINKED ORGANISATIONS

Christian Groups Seek Withdrawal of FCRA Bill; RSS Bodies Back Proposal

'Will undermine religious freedom, hamper services to marginalised sections'

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Christian organisations on Thursday demanded the withdrawal of the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, alleging that its provisions would undermine religious freedom and hamper services to marginalised communities. In contrast, RSS-linked organisations backed the proposed legislation, calling it a necessary step to regulate foreign funding. The contrasting positions emerged at a joint parliamentary committee meeting examining the bill at the Parliament House complex here, where representatives of various organisations presented their views, sources said. Christian groups, including the National Council of Churches in India, Apostles Methodist Church and Evangelical Church of India, strongly opposed the proposed legislation, arguing that it would undermine the community's religious independence and restrict its ability to provide services to vulnerable sections of society.

On the other hand, RSS-linked organisations, including Vanvasi Kalyan Ashram, Akhil Bharatiya Adhivakta Parishad and Rashtriya Sewa Bharati, welcomed the bill, maintaining that foreign contributions needed to be regulated and the proposed legislation was a step in the right direction.

Christian community members participate in a rally organised by the Association of Karnataka United Christian Forum for Human Rights, urging the Karnataka government to repeal the 2022 anti-conversion law, at Freedom Park on Thursday.

NMC NOD RECEIVED

IIT Kharagpur to Launch PG Medical Courses

It is also the first IIT to be set up in the country

Press Trust Of India

New Delhi: IIT Kharagpur has become the first IIT to introduce postgraduate medical degree programmes accredited by the National Medical Commission (NMC), it said. Beginning with the academic session 2026-27, the institute will welcome its inaugural cohort of MD students at Dr BC Roy Multi-Speciality Medical Research Centre, marking a transformative expansion of the IIT system into PG medical education. IIT Kharagpur is also the first IIT to be set up in the country.

"India's first IIT is now taking a historic step towards shaping the future of medical education. Our vision is not simply to train specialist doctors but to create an ecosystem where clinical excellence meets engineering ingenuity...," said director Suman Chakraborty.

Ahistoric step towards shaping the future of medical education: Director

KDA MEMBERS TO MEET DEMONSTRATORS, WANGCHUK TODAY

Leh Protesters Seek Statehood, Safeguards; Wangchuk Removed from Site, Asked to Stay at Home

'Will intensify agitation to press for result-oriented dialogue process with MHA'

Hakeem Irfan Rashid

Srinagar: Scores of people, led by Apex Body Leh (ABL), started a peaceful protest in Leh on Thursday to press for their demands for statehood and constitutional safeguards, even as the authorities removed climate activist Sonam Wangchuk from the protest site and directed him to stay home.

The Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) has extended its support to protesters in Leh, calling for a peaceful candle march on Saturday evening in Kargil.

Representatives of ABL, KDA, political, social and religious bodies and Lok Sabha MP Mohmad Haneefa have urged the Centre to defer the Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Council elections scheduled on December 4. Panchayat and municipal polls are scheduled for November 21. The chief electoral officer of Ladakh has prohibited parties, candidates and their supporters from organising dharnas, protests, demonstrations, sit-ins, hunger strikes and rallies within the limits of Leh and Kargil during the model code of conduct period for the elections.

"We had planned this protest quite some time ago. We had already drawn up a timeline and a plan, and we are proceeding accordingly. We will intensify the peaceful agitation to press for the result-oriented dialogue process with MHA to address the aspirations of people of Ladakh and review the recent excise policy and other decisions," said ABL chairman Chering Dorjay Lakruk.

"This protest is not for the upcoming elections, but this was not the time to conduct polls. They have removed Gen Z from the voter list as part of Operation Lotus and want to conduct elections in extreme weather conditions," said Lakruk. A delegation of KDA members is arriving in Leh on Friday to express solidarity with protesters and meet Wangchuk as well.

"Our right to protest and express dissent is being suppressed, but we will expose and fight all the conspiracies being tried against the people of Ladakh," said Sajjad Kargili of KDA.

Will expose and fight all conspiracies being tried against people of Ladakh: KDA's Sajjad Kargili

THE COST OF CRITICISM

Krishna Byre Gowda Denied Opportunity to Speak at Modi Event

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Karnataka minister Krishna Byre Gowda on Thursday expressed disappointment over being dropped from the list of speakers at Prime Minister Narendra Modi's metro event in Bengaluru on Friday, linking the decision to his recent criticism of the Centre's contribution to the metro projects. "The reward for asking for justice for Karnataka state? My speech was cut," Gowda wrote on X. The Bengaluru Development Minister, who also oversees Bengaluru Metro Rail Corporation (BMRCL), said his name featured in the draft programme but was removed from the final schedule.

"My speaking slot was included in the draft programme. In the final list that came last night, the Bengaluru Development Minister's speech was cut," he said.

"We bear most of the capital expenditure. This is how we are punished for asking for a fair share for Karnataka. That's all right, you can cut my speech. But you cannot stop us from working for Bengaluru's development. We will work even harder," he added.

The remarks come a day after Gowda questioned the Centre's share in Bengaluru Metro funding. Addressing reporters on Wednesday, he said the combined cost of Metro Phases 1, 2, 2A, 2B and the proposed Phase 3 stood at ₹77,891 crore. According to him, Karnataka's contribution amounts to ₹65,291 crore, or 84% of the project cost, while the Centre's share is ₹12,600 crore, or 16%.

MINISTER'S STAND

We bear most of the capital expenditure. This is how we are punished for asking for a fair share for Karnataka. You can cut my speech. But you cannot stop us from working for Bengaluru's development

"The state is effectively investing nearly five rupees for every rupee contributed by the Centre," Gowda said, arguing that the actual funding pattern differed significantly from the commonly cited 50:50 model for metro projects. He said the Centre's share had declined across successive metro phases, while Karnataka continued to bear the costs of land acquisition, project overruns and operational losses. The state has so far absorbed about ₹1,046 crore in operating losses, with another ₹52 crore yet to be reimbursed, he added.

Calling for higher central support, he said Bengaluru's role as a major contributor to GST, income-tax and export earnings warranted greater infrastructure investment. Expanding the metro network to 400-500 km was essential for the city's long-term growth and could not be funded by the state alone, he said.

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MAIDEN QUAD SUMMIT UNDER TRUMP 2.0 EXPECTED ON NOV 17, DURING MODI'S 3-DAY PHILIPPINES VISIT

PM Heads to Manila for ASEAN, E Asia, Quad Summits

Dipanjan Roy Chaudhury

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi is set to travel to the Philippines next week to attend the 23rd Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN)-India Summit and the 21st meeting of the ASEAN-led East Asia Summit process and is expected to participate in the maiden Quad Summit under Trump 2.0 early next week.

The visit will take place from November 16 to 18, Rudrendra Tandon, Secretary (East) MEA, stated during a special media briefing here on Thursday.

"In addition to a very active bilateral relationship with all 11 ASEAN member states, we see our engagement with the ASEAN regional platform also as a key element or building block of our Act East policy," Tandon said.

Work on for the 49th ASEAN Summit and related events in Pasay, Philippines –AP

The PM's programme in Manila will include a dinner hosted by President Ferdinand Marcos Jr for the visiting leaders, followed by the ASEAN-India Summit and the East Asia Summit the next day, with bilateral meetings with other leaders in between.

While the Quad Summit is scheduled on November 17, there is no certainty yet of a standalone bilateral meet between the PM and US President Donald Trump. Modi is expected to travel to the USA mid-December for the G20 Summit. ET had reported recently that the Quad Summit will be held in Manila on the margins of ASEAN and East Asia Summits with focus being on critical minerals, critical technology and resilient supply chains.

"There is also a very strong demand from the Indian community to meet the prime minister, so we are trying to adjust that also in his schedule," Tandon said.

KEY TO ACT EAST POLICY

Trade with ASEAN has reached $122b; India sees the regional partnership as central to its Act East policy

Tandon said ASEAN has emerged as a major trading partner for India, with trade with the entire region at approximately $122 billion.

"We in India strongly believe that, as an Indian Ocean country that abuts this very important Southeast Asian maritime zone, a strong strategic relationship with ASEAN member states, as a collective and individually, is good for both of us," Tandon said.

Such a relationship, he said, will make both sides more resilient in handling rapid geopolitical changes and will contribute to peace and stability in Asia.

Describing the East Asia Summit as a very unique ASEAN-led grouping of eight leaders, Tandon said leaders of ASEAN and these countries will discuss global security issues and issues of common concern in an informal setting.

"This year's East Asia Summit process is led by the ASEAN Chair, which is the Philippines. That's why it's happening in Manila. This, too, is a remarkable example of how successful ASEAN collective diplomacy has become," he said.

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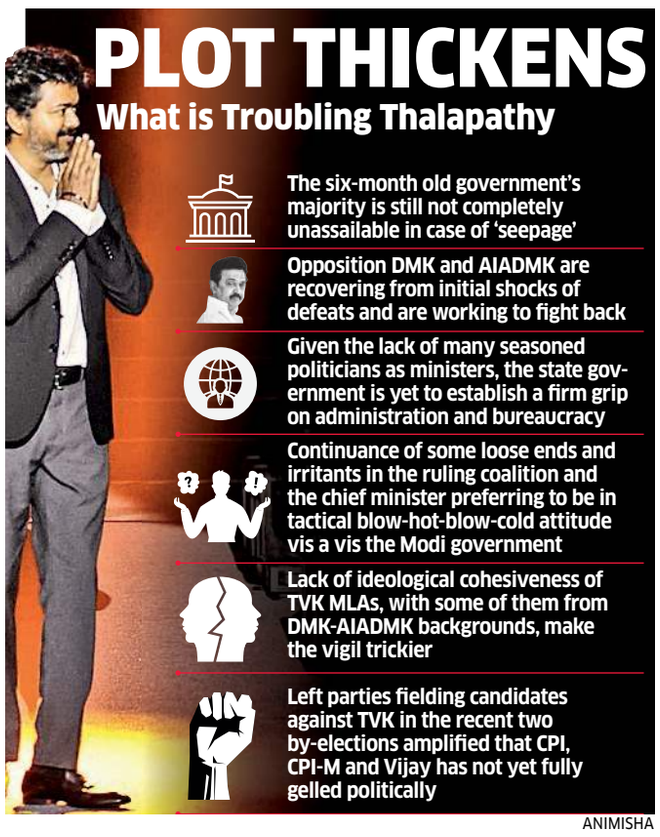

ANIMISHA

DESPITE TVK CHIEF'S STEADY POPULARITY

Six-Month Immunity Ends, TN CM Vijay Wary of Toppling Bid

Govt vulnerable to defections, with the ruling bloc barely above halfway mark

CL Manoj

New Delhi: The euphoria over C Joseph Vijay's dramatic leap to Tamil Nadu's top post is yet to die down, but the chief minister's caution to his TVK party MLAs on Wednesday to guard against any toppling bid has officially underscored that his nascent government is already in alert mode. Some stakeholders in the state's ruling front privately said they have reasons to be extra cautious as the six-month bar, insulating the state government from any no-confidence motion, has now ended.

While Vijay, they said, continues to ride on his celluloid stardom-propelled mass appeal, the conduct of some of his MLAs, mostly a collection of political novices, has not been faultless, with some creating needless controversies, a factor that worries some in the ruling front given the four larger backgrounds:

1) That the six-month old government's majority is still not completely unassailable in case of 'seepage'

2) Opposition DMK and AIADMK are also recovering from initial shocks and are working to fight back

3) Given the lack of many seasoned politicians as ministers, the state government is yet to establish a firm grip on administration

4) Continuance of some loose ends and irritants in the ruling coalition and the chief minister preferring to be in tactical blow-hot-blow-cold attitude vis a vis the Modi government.

On paper, TVK (109), Congress, IUML and VCK, which are partners in the government, have around 118 MLAs, including the Speaker, in the assembly with effective strength of 229 (with five vacancies), with majority mark at 115. The ruling side also has outside support from four Left MLAs and an Independent. The combined Opposition parties, including the 'unaligned' DMK and AIADMK, have 106 MLAs. Some ruling front functionaries apprehend that DMK is now plotting a toppling bid on the Vijay government by trying to combine the Opposition parties, including AIADMK, by bridging the faultlines and by wooing some sections of TVK MLAs and ruling allies. Vijay's caution to his MLAs on Wednesday is seen in this context.

While DMK has been denying any toppling plan and charging the Vijay government of trying to poach the Opposition MLAs, the ruling front does not buy it. "The DMK leadership, more so, leader of the Opposition Udhayanidhi Stalin, is desperately trying to somehow topple the Vijay government by joining hands with AIADMK and other Opposition parties. They know that once CM Vijay settles down with his government, the DMK and Udhayanidhi will have to languish in the Opposition for years, if not decades. The Centre and BJP are trying to exploit the situation amid their attempt to get the delimitation Bill passed," claimed a ruling coalition leader.

Lack of ideological cohesiveness of TVK MLAs, with some of them from DMK-AIADMK backgrounds, make the vigil trickier. While TVK had initially engineered the resignations of six AIADMK MLAs and won two by-elections so far to marginally increase its strength, the ruling front now suspects 'a deliberate delay' in notifying the remaining five assembly by-elections".

DMK MOVES

TVK leaders fear DMK is seeking to unite Oppn parties, including the AIADMK, and woo TVK MLAs

INVESTIGATING 92-ACRE TRANSFER NEAR PAKISTAN BORDER

ED Probes ₹21L Trail to Retd Punjab Official's Wife in Border Land Case

ED searches 18 locations, seizes ₹1.75 cr in cash; freezes heavy machinery, including excavators, suspected to have been used in illegal mining

FILE PHOTO

Raghav Ohri

New Delhi: The Enforcement Directorate (ED) has traced alleged payments totalling ₹20.70 lakh from accounts linked to a stone-crushing firm to the wife of a retired Punjab government official in a money-laundering probe into the transfer of 92 acres of village common land in Pathankot district to private beneficiaries, people in the know told **ET**.

The land, comprising 734 kanals in Gol and Bhattian villages, is located along the Ravi river basin, less than four kilometres from the International Border with Pakistan. The agency is probing allegations that the transfer facilitated illegal extraction of sand and gravel from the area despite restrictions on mining in the sensitive border zone. According to agency sources, the land was transferred through an official order issued by Kuldeep Singh, then a District Development and Panchayat Officer (DDPO). Singh had reportedly been given additional charge as Additional Deputy Commissioner (Development), Pathankot, for 72 hours, just three days before his retirement. The ED is examining the circumstances under which he was assigned the additional charge and the subsequent transfer of public land to six private individuals allegedly acting as fronts for the mining network.

The financial trail allegedly includes two payments made by Shiv Shankar Stone Crusher to Singh's wife. Bank records examined by the ED reportedly show a transfer of ₹16.50 lakh on June 26, 2023, followed by another payment of ₹4.20 lakh on July 4, 2023. The agency suspects that the payments were linked to the land-transfer order, people quoted above said.

JUST BEFORE RETIREMENT

Official given additional charge for 72 hours, three days before retirement, before the alleged land transfer

Investigators have also examined the activities of a local business family allegedly associated with several stone-crushing firms in the region. The federal agency is probing whether these firms were part of a wider network that financed illegal extraction and routed payments through personal bank accounts.

The ED has also scrutinised alleged payments to local village representatives. Accounts linked to a member of the business family reportedly showed regular transfers to a local sarpanch and his wife dating back to 2019. The agency suspects that these payments were intended to secure local support for the mining operations and facilitate control over the land. The investigation has assumed significance because of the location of the alleged mining activity. Agency sources said the land falls within a sensitive stretch near the IB, where unauthorised excavation could have implications for border infrastructure and security. The Punjab and Haryana High Court had previously imposed restrictions on mining in the area, citing concerns that excavation could affect border security. The ED has, so far, conducted searches at 18 residential and industrial premises linked to the alleged network. During the operations, it reportedly seized ₹1.75 crore in cash and froze heavy machinery, including excavators and transport vehicles, suspected to have been used in illegal mining.

The ED's case stems from an FIR registered by the Punjab Vigilance Bureau against Kuldeep Singh and others. The agency is investigating the alleged proceeds generated through the transfer of public land and illegal mining operations.

Shah Visits Delhi Police HQ to Review Law and Order

Our Political Bureau

New Delhi: Union home minister Amit Shah visited the Delhi Police headquarters on Thursday afternoon to take stock of the law and order situation, and to discuss measures to curb organised crime, the trafficking of illegal weapons and related illicit activities, said people familiar with the matter.

According to officials, directives will be issued to formulate an effective strategy to address these issues. Furthermore, the home minister is expected to seek feedback from senior officials regarding the matters discussed in his previous meeting with the Delhi Police, concerning women's safety and the drug trade.

Earlier, Shah visited the Delhi Police headquarters on October 24 to meet senior police officials to discuss the law and order situation in the national capital. Delhi chief minister Rekha Gupta also arrived at the headquarters alongside him.

Kolkata

A bulldozer demolishes an illegal structure encroaching on a footpath outside Abhishek Banerjee's residence in Kolkata on Thursday -- PTI

"No number of bulldozers can silence my voice or break my resolve. I will continue my fight against the Bangla Birodhis. I will neither retreat nor budge an inch until my last breath"

ABHISHEK BANERJEE
Mamata-AITC MP

OBJECTIONS FROM SHIV SENA (UBT) AND MNS

Chhath Songs at Stations Spark Cultural Row in Maha

Krishna Kumar

Mumbai: The Railway's decision to broadcast Bhojpuri Chhath Puja songs at several Mumbai stations has triggered a political row, with both the Shiv Sena (UBT) and the Maharashtra Navnirman Sena (MNS) opposing the move. The opposition comes amid wider friction over the festival in the state, including the community from Bihar seeking permission to hold Chhath rituals at the state's water bodies and the MNS objecting to it.

For the last couple of days devotional songs of Chhath Puja in Bhojpuri language began playing over public announcement systems at major stations in the Central Railways and Harbour line railway stations like the Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus, Lokmanya Tilak Terminus, Wadala and other stations. A few irate Marathi speaking commuters questioned station officials who claimed that they were playing the songs on the instructions of the Railway Board.

"The Railways does not play the Jaya Jaya Maharashtra Mazha (official state song), it does not play the Ae mere watan ke logo or the Jhanda Uncha rahe hamara. However they are playing these songs. A stand has to be taken against it. Under which rule are they (Railways) playing it. We are not against any region or against any language. You can celebrate your festivals but do not encroach on Maharashtra's culture."said UBT Sena MP Sanjay Raut.

A DAY AFTER CRPF CAMP ATTACK

Bullet-Riddled Bodies of Two SPOs Found in Kishtwar

Security personnel during the second day of cordon-and-search operation following a terror attack on a CRPF checkpoint in Kulgam – PTI

Hakeem Irfan Rashid

Srinagar: The bullet-riddled bodies of two Special Police Officers (SPOs) of Jammu and Kashmir Police were recovered from Kishtwar district on Thursday, a day after they went missing from the remote Dachhan area.

The two SPOs have been identified as Babi Chand (57) and Rashpal Kumar (45). They were posted with the Special Operations Group (SOG) of the local police at Kiyar village in Dachhan and had gone missing on Wednesday while travelling from their camp to an Army post at Dharna-Marwah.

Their mobile phones were initially reachable but were later switched off, prompting concerns and prompting an extensive search operation.

"We are investigating the circumstances of the killings and all angles are being probed," a senior official told ET.

Soon after the duo went missing on Wednesday, armed forces rushed reinforcements and deployed specialised teams equipped with drones and sniffer dogs, widening the search across the forested upper reaches of Dachhan. Soon after the bodies were found, operation was expanded to cover a wider area around Kiyar and the route towards Dharna-Marwah to locate the suspects. While drones scanned inaccessible forest stretches, sniffer dogs assisted ground teams in tracking possible movement.

"A massive operation is underway to catch and kill terrorists if there are any in this area," said another official. According to police officials, at least three local militants, including Jehangir Saroori, are active in Kishtwar district.

On October 4, Deputy Commissioner, Kishtwar, Pankaj Kumar Sharma, had urged residents of remote areas of Marwah, Warwan and Dachhan to stand united against terrorism and share timely information about the movement of suspected terrorists with security forces.

FAROOQ CALLS FOR INDIA-PAK DIALOGUE

Kulgam Attack: Probe Points to Role of Local Militants, Several Held

Hakeem Irfan Rashid

Srinagar: The armed forces have questioned, summoned and detained several people as part of the investigating into the attack in Kulgam in which three CRPF personnel were injured.

Jammu and Kashmir police suspect local militant Latief Ahmad to be allegedly involved in the attack as the modus operandi matches two other attacks that took place earlier this year in Anantnag and Kulgam districts.

"As per eye witnesses, including CRPF personnel, one person with his face covered opened fire and his gait matched that of Latief, who is currently active and was involved in two other attacks before this," a senior police official told ET.

Officials said he had come walking towards the CRPF check point and fled from the spot with the help of some of his supporters. "He used an AK rifle and we are investigating some specific leads and questioning some people," said another official.

On July 22 this year, Jammu and Kashmir police head constable Ashiq Hussain Qureshi was killed in a militant attack in Anantnag district of southern Kashmir. On July 31, two non-local brick kiln workers were killed in a targeted attack in Kelam village of Kulgam.

Meanwhile, ruling National Conference president Farooq Abdullah asserted that bullets and military confrontation cannot resolve political disputes and that meaningful engagement between India and Pakistan must begin without waiting for hostilities to end.

The former J&K chief minister said Kashmir is, was and will remain an integral part of India.

"Ab aap intezaar karenge, jab tak aap sabki goliyan band ho jayengi, tab tak raat ho jayegi" (If you keep waiting for everyone to stop firing, it will be too late by the time the guns fall silent)," said Abdullah. He spoke in response to a query about the BJP-led government's stated position that talks and bullets cannot go together.

"I have always told Pakistan to stop terrorism. Nothing can be achieved through terrorism. The process of dialogue must begin because only through talks can a way forward be found," he said.

MASKED ATTACKER

Witnesses, including CRPF personnel, said the masked attacker's gait resembled Latief's, who is suspected in two earlier attacks: A police official

He expressed concern over claims by the central government that terrorism had ended in J&K, maintaining that the recent incidents indicate that the threat continues to persist and that concrete measures are needed to eliminate it.

"I have already said such incidents are still happening. One never knows where the next attack might take place," he said.

Calling for the revival of SAARC, Abdullah said regional countries must come together, resolve their differences and work towards collective progress, citing the European Union as an example of former adversaries building a common future through cooperation.

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BANGALORE-BASED SOFTWARE PROFESSIONAL, 33, 173 cm, Brahmin-Iyer. Father is a businessman. Seeking a like-minded, well-educated groom. Contact: 9513165788

MUMBAI-BASED DEPUTY MANAGER, 35, 152 cm, Khatri. Father is in business. Open to a groom who is well settled. Contact: 9513165788

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MATRIMONIALS

WANTED BRIDES

BY CASTE

BRAHMIN

ALLIANCE invited for USA based, 32/5'11", MS (Finance),H-1B, well-settled finance professional from a reputed Sanadya Brahmin family.Seeking educated, compatible bride, preferably USA-based or willing to relocate. Contact:9425093237

KAYASTHA

SRIV MD (GenSurg) 2nd year residency US CITIZEN H'some Boy 1999 5'10" parents seek Kayastha/Hindu Girl Pref. MD/IIT/NIT/CA living in USA email to: hsri99@outlook.com

SM4 MBA Finance Boy 34/ 5'7"Manager MNC GURGOAN Fmly. in Varanasi PRO. QULFD.Girl Kayastha/Caste no Bar. Whatsapp 9450533020

BY RELIGION

SIKH

SM 4 Sikh(Rmgr) Clean Shave Boy, US Ctzn, Cmptr Prgr working as Data Scientist, 32Yrs/5'9", Parents retired, only elder sister married, Seeks educated girl. Cast No Bar. Ph. +1(201)245-7455. Email: SinghP@Live.com

GENERAL

CASTE NO BAR

39, Punjabi, 5'11", divorced (no kids), Mumbai-born, well-settled in Toronto, Canada. Seeking a well-educated, family-oriented life partner. Caste no bar. WhatsApp +1 6472917929

BY NATIONALITY

NRI/ GREEN CARD

PQM4 Kayastha bachelor 36/5'11" B.Tech(NSIT) Asst. Director in rptd MNC (Ireland). Cultured & highly educated south delhi based bengali family. sg3210@gmail.com

SM4 Gupta 33/5'10 Soft Ware Engineer USA on H1B visa. Pref girl working/Studying in USA. All upper caste Jain, Khatri accepted. 8795810135

WANTED GROOMS

BY CASTE

AGARWAL - BISA

Daughter of Affluent high Status, educated Business family of Mumbai.Pretty, cultured, Slim, accomplished with rich moral values and jolly nature. 35/5.3" Inter C.A doing Graphic Designing profession and Director of family export business. Invite proposals from only Mumbai based Agrawal or Maheshwari families of similar status
Email: Chaudhari.c@gmail.com
WhatsApp: 9820848111

BRAHMIN

SM4 B'ful Brahmin, Sep94/5', MBA Healthcare(Germany), BDS(Mumbai), Nadi-Aadi, Jestha-03, Rasi-Scorpio, Wrk Mumbai pharma Comp. Seeks well-settled Brahmin/upper class 31-36yrs. Mail: RP37.NAUTIYAL@GMAIL.COM , 9869449736(WA)

LOOKING for a Well Educated Settled Groom for Our Qualified Bengali Daughter. Second Marriage. Contact 9936998443.

KAYASTHA

SM4 Doc(Pediatric) 5'4"/27 btfl girl. Parents doctor. Up cast, early marriage. 9867229014

BY COMMUNITY

RAJPUT

IIM, NIT pass out Dec 90 born, 5' 2" Sr. Mgr in MNC, 55+ lakh package seeks allia nce from equivalent qualified person, preferably Kumaoni, Garhwali, Himachali, Rajput cont.9358671358

IIM, NIT pass out Dec 90 born, 5' 2" Sr. Mgr in MNC, 55+ lakh package seeks allia nce from equivalent qualified person, preferably Kumaoni, Garhwali, Himachali, Rajput cont.9358671358

BY RELIGION

MUSLIM

FAMILY looking for their 1. Canada Citizen daughter Age 28 Yrs. 2. Canada Citizen Son Age 34 Yrs. WA 9494078092, 7337276699. Shia community.

GENERAL

CASTE NO BAR

B.TECH(IITR) SM4 B'ful, girl 1989/156cm, from a V rptd Jat fmly of W'UP, wkng at a good post in a startup (by IIT'ns) seeks an upper cast H'some, well edu and c'tured boy, 9412216866, 8218886530, E-ela.chaudhary7@gmail. com

SM for Jatav June 90/5'2 Asst Prof DU. Seeks prof qual match. Delhi based well edu family. Parents retd from govt job. Ph/WhatsApp # 9871216298

KHARWAR, 30/ 5'5" , BALLB NLU Lucknow , Company Secretary, Author, Upper Middle Class Father & Mother Govt Employee,8545012737

PQM for Yadav girl, 1983/ 5' 1", Teacher in Lucknow, M.Phil. M.A. Sanskrit. Plz call after 7 PM. Mob. 9591048979.

ALLIANCE INVITED (PUNE BASED ONLY)
For an educated Punjabi Agarwal Girl
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e-mail : marryji0208@gmail.com

BY NATIONALITY

NRI/ GREEN CARD

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real estate

BANGALORE PROPERTIES

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SALE BSK 2nd stage 35x55 site with ground plus first-floor house 37000/=sft .25x65 site with 2bhk Indpt House Sita Circle 25000/= Sft. 9886044313 .

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SALE at Banaswadi Vacant Plot N/E Corner 5700 sqft. On 60 ft main road and 40 ft road

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SALE - 30×70 West-Facing, A-Khata, Bannerghatta Road, Hulimavu @Rs.21000/sqft, Bhagavathi Layout, near Raghavendraswamy Mutt Owner: 9019800985 / 9448061583.

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TO-LET OC-CC Fully Furnished **Office** on ORR (Mahadevapura) Next to Metro Stn. 1st Floor 3730 Sqft 54 Work Stn 6 Cabins | 2nd Floor 3830 Sqft 85 Seats 4 Meeting Rooms Server Room Receptions

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FOR Sale Luxury 3BHK Flats Premium project by Reputed Builders Eco Design, Ample Space, Vasthu Compliance , Security and Greenery Tatanagar Bangalore Brokers Not Entertained Contact +91 9980883973"

HSR LAYOUT

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INDIRA NAGAR

INDIRANAGAR East Facing PROPERTIES FOR SALE 40x61 Plot with 3 Floors Old House | New Excellent Constructed 5 Floors Building on 40x50 Plot Each Floor 3BHK 8105743500

40X61 PLOT with old House on 40 Feet Road. Newly Constructed 5Floor Building with Teak wood & Granite Flooring

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40/60 BDA 4BHK duplex 13th main Indiranagar HAL 2nd stage price 46,500/-per sft Broker Excuse Ct: 9035263495

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3 BHK furnished ready to move ultra modern GF flat 1,969 sft on Sarakki Main Road, 3.25 cr with 2 car park (nego). Owner 9845397832 Brokers Excuse.

KALYAN NAGAR

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KORAMANGALA

SALE RUNNING Play/Pre School Day Care Creche in Koramangala 3rd Block

WITH RS 72 Lacs PA Turnover. 50 Students Ask: Rs 1.30 Cr Nego. 9880075949,7026001122 AgarwalEstates.com

NELMANGALA

30X57 Vijaya Vittal Lyt Near Hyundai Showroom 400 Meter From Tumkur Road 30X40 EF Dhanojipalya Nelamangala: 9590009797/ 9845659969

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SAHAKARA NAGAR

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4BHK FLAT Sobha Garnet at Sarjapur road, 2 Min to Metro Station, Rs. 4.50 Crore (Negotiable). Contact: 98441 99067.

LUXURY 4BHK +Studio +Gym Room Villa for Sale in Gattahalli 1300Sqft Land 4500 Built up area S/F 3Side Open area. 3.8Cr Nego Ct: 7026500097

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PRIME 2,280 Sq. Ft. Corner Property @ Vasanthnagar, North-West Facing, Excellent Location Genuine Buyers Only Contact: 9845071800

VISVESWARAIAH LAYOUT

SMV LAYOUT 7th Block 40x60 SITE FOR SALE Per Sqft 18500/-

SMV LAYOUT 7th Block 40x60 Site For Sale West Facing Opposite Park, Good Location. Contact :- 9845488488

SALE 40×60 East Facing, BDA Site, Sir M Visvesvaraya Layout @Rs12000/sqft, 4th Block, Site No. 1483. Contact Owner: 9019800985/9448061583

WHITEFIELD

PRESTIGE park grove luxury 4 BHK SBA 3793 sft sky home apartment on 22nd flr out of 34 floors @ seegehalli for sale. 5.63 cr Nego. 9902925519/ 79960 45551

YELAHANKA

SSD HOUSING UNDER THE STARS PREMIUM VILLAS 93419 43940

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AISHWARYA PROPERTIES AGRICULTURAL LANDS FOR SALE 98450 33699

SIRA TUMKUR YEDIYUR, BELLUR, HASSAN RD & HIRISAVE HIGHWAY, KUNIGAL 99803 66969/ 98450 23971

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COMMERCIAL plot for sale 6340 sft St. Johns road NW facing corner plot Rs 35000/- psft Rajan Sood 9980132655

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PREMIUM & spacious 3 & 4 BHK fully furnished flats. SFS 208 COLONY, Yelahanka New Town.Attached Park, High-End Interiors, Premium Living.Call : 9986500570, 6363169504.

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PROPERTY ANCILLARIES

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8000 sq.ft. of KIADB Vacant Industrial Land @ Bommasandra with Clear Title, Borewell, Boundary & 5 Floors Plan Approval

@ BOMMASANDRA Industrial Area near Delta Electronics & MTR Factory, Bangalore. KUMAR- 9036690352 BROKERS EXCUSE

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RENT OPP HALASURU LAKE, FULLY FURNISHED 1500 SFT OFFICE SPACE. DG, LIFT, PARKING. CALL 93428 22252 / 99169 22211

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personal

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Komal Rajeshkumar Maurya, D/o Rajeshkumar Maurya, No.A1, Swagat Kuteer, 6th F Cross road, Kaggadasapura, Blr-93. Have changed my name from Komal Rajeshkumar Mourya to Komal Rajeshkumar Maurya for all future purposes.

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I, SYED MUBASHEER, Residing at No. 2/6, Khan Residency, Ground Floor, 1st Cross, 2nd Main, Krishnappa Garden, Thilaknagar, Jayangar, Bangalore - 560041, have changed my name to SYED ALI MUBASHIR for all my future purposes.

I, IQBALUNNISA HUSSNODDIN, Residing at Masha Allah Manzil, 5th Cross, Ashoka Nagar, Opp Govt University, Tumkur, Kuvempunagara, Karnataka 572103, have changed my name to IQBALUNNISA for all my future purpose.

I, Darshan Jain Hemander Kataria S/o Hemander Madanlal Kataria R/o # No-710, 11th Cross, 5th Main, MC Lyt, Vijayanagar, Bengaluru-560040 have changed my name to Darshan Jain for all purposes.

JC676771A SUB/MT Sikandar Singh Yadav ASC centre & college my mother name service records Samundri Devi changed to Samudri Devi, Dt: 12.11.2026, for all purpose.

PADMAVATI, W/o 14837684W HAV Mahadev Gouda Patil ASC center south have changed my name to Padmavati M Patil, Dt: 12.11.2026, for all purpose.

I, Aravinda Jawali, have changed my name to ARAVINDA GURULINGAPPA JAWALI vide affidavit dated 11/11/2026. Sworn before notary Deepa M Bengaluru.

14878848W NK/MT Bisen Kuldeep Shankar ASC centre & college my mother name service records Kunta Bai changed to Kuntabai Shankar Bisen, for all purpose.

I, SYED MUBASHEER, **16111596H** HAV Chandrakanth Jogani 4ENGR Regt C/o 56 APO my daughter name service records Bhumika to Bhumika Chandrakanth Jogani, for all purpose.

I, Vijaya w/o JC-676393M, Sub/MT, Murugan A S of 503 ASC Bn changed my name from Vijaya to Vijaya M, for all Purpose.

14856356X HAV/SKT Sandeep kumar ASC centre south my father name service records Satbir Singh changed to Satbir, Dt: 12.11.2026, for all purpose.

I, JC-676393M, Sub/MT, Murugan A S of 503 ASC Bn changed my son's name M Arjun to Arjun M, for all purpose.

6499095K Nk Wagh Manoj Anand Rao 571 ASC BN my daughter name service records Harshada changed to Harshada Manoj Wagh, for all purpose.

I, JC-676393M, Sub/MT, Murugan A S of 503 ASC Bn changed my daughter's name M Anushka to Anushka M, for all purpose.

I, Vinyamol W/o 14835432L, Hav, Soorej Mon A R of ASC Centre (South) changed my name from Vinyamol to Vinyamol V T, for all Purpose.

LOST & FOUND

I, Sadhana K V R/o No. 71 East Park Road b/w 13th & 14th Cross Malleshwaram Bengaluru-03 have lost the original Khata Certificate standing in the name of my husband Late B M Mohan pertaining to the property at Site No. 5 J P Nagar 8th Phase 1st A Block Bengaluru-62.

BUSINESS CONNECT

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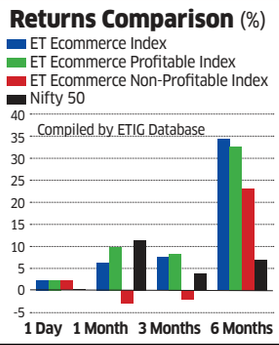
Returns Comparison (%)



Tweet OF THE DAY

BRIAN FEROLDI
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Investors who manage their own capital have a massive advantage over investors who don't

MeitY Reviews Gig Platforms' Data Collection for Physical AI Training

INSIDE JOB Seeks answers on consent, privacy and cross-border transfer of first-person video

Pranav Mukul & Disha Acharya

New Delhi | Bengaluru: IT ministry officials on Thursday met representatives of home services platforms and technology companies to discuss concerns over privacy and data sovereignty in the collection of first-person video and sensor data from gig workers for training physical AI models, people aware of the matter said.

Authorities are concerned that the practice could infringe workers' rights, compromise consumer privacy and threaten national data security. The meeting, chaired by ministry of electronics and information technology (MeitY) secretary S Krishnan, was attended by senior executives from Snabbit, Pronto, Urban Company and other technology and robotics companies.

"The meeting was triggered by a home services platform equipping its domestic workers with head-mounted cameras to record everyday household tasks, with the footage being used to train physical AI models," one of the persons briefed on the discussions told ET.

MeitY sought information on standard operating procedures (SOPs) for collecting, processing and storing such data, including safeguards for obtaining workers' consent and protecting the privacy of other individuals captured in the recordings, the person said.

The companies were also questioned whether data collected through these practices was being sold, shared or transferred to developers outside India.

Instant house help platform Pronto has begun in-home video recording through its Verified service. However, Urban Company and Snabbit have decided against doing so.

"Pronto has been asked to submit a detailed representation on its SOPs and data collection practices," another person said.

Some senior executives at the meeting raised concerns over the practice of collecting data in India and selling it to overseas physical AI developers, arguing that it "did not put the country in a favourable light".

They also questioned the broader approach of positioning India as a source of training data for AI systems being developed overseas, the person cited above said, adding that companies had sought MeitY's intervention to regulate the practice.

Executives of robotics startups argued that India should focus on building domestic physical AI capabilities rather than merely collecting and supplying data to overseas companies for model training, people familiar with the discussions said.

Email queries sent to MeitY, Snabbit and Urban Company remained unanswered.

A spokesperson for Pronto said, "The company shared its current practices, which are designed to be compliant with applicable regulations, and remains committed to continuing to engage and cooperate with the ministry as the policy and regulatory landscape evolves."

Pronto's data collection initiative comes months after the Bengaluru-based startup raised $20 million in funding from US-based tech investor Lachy Groom, the cofounder of AI startup Physical Intelligence.

Pronto's founder, Anjali Sardana, has also set up a new physical AI venture, Provision Labs, ET had reported on October 26.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO
www.economictimes.com

MeitY sought details on SOPs for collecting, processing and storing first-person video from gig workers

Questioned firms on safeguards to obtain workers' consent and protect privacy of household members

Sought clarity on whether the data collected was being sold

Also sought disclosures on data-sharing contracts, vendor agreements, data retention policies

Sought details on the nature and scale of data collected

Tech Buzz

Google Debuts Faster 'Gemini Decision' Engine

NEW DELHI: Google has introduced a new AI tool that can evaluate up to 1,000 questions across text, images, audio, video and PDF documents in a single pass, as the company expands its AI offerings for faster and more cost-efficient decision-making by businesses and developers. The Gemini Decisions API, powered by the new Gemini Decision 1 model, is designed for tasks such as selecting tools, checking policies, routing queries to AI models and evaluating information. – **Agencies**

10.6m
Number of new jobs AI is expected to generate globally by 2030. —Gartner

UK Regulator Fines Meta for Inaccuracies

LONDON: Britain's media regulator Ofcom said on Thursday it had fined Meta $596,565 for providing inaccurate information about its WhatsApp Business service in response to requests it made as part of its telecoms market review. Ofcom reviewed the market for business bulk SMS text messages in 2025 to better understand the services available to businesses. Ofcom sought information in 2025 about WhatsApp for Business, including messaging volumes and revenues. The regulator said Meta had provided inaccurate information multiple times. –**Reuters**

Timed IPO Jackpot for Anthropic Staff

ET GRAPHICS

Anthropic, the artificial-intelligence company behind Claude, is preparing for a public-market debut that could create one of the largest employee wealth events in the technology industry. **Shristi Achar** crunches the numbers

THE COMPANY'S LATEST AMENDED REGISTRATION STATEMENT PROPOSES

825m Class A shares in an initial public offering

$70-78 Price range per share

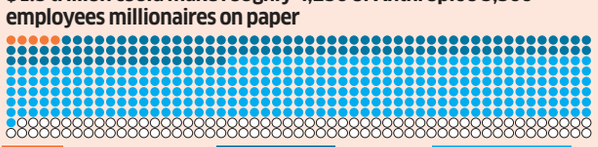
$56.1-62.5b Roughly what the primary offering would raise at this price range

$1.26-1.41T Roughly the valuation this gives it (fully-diluted)

$27-29 billion
Seven cofounders: Already billionaires; their paper wealth could roughly double to $27-29 billion each, according to The Observer's reporting of a Hill.com (a private market tracker) analysis

MILLIONAIRES ON PAPER

With the IPO, Hill.com reckons that a valuation of more than $1.5 trillion could make roughly 4,250 of Anthropic's 5,300 employees millionaires on paper



50 **Early employees:** Centi-millionaires (with equity worth at least $100m)

1,200 **Employees:** Deca-millionaires (holdings worth at least $10 million)

~3,000 **Other employees:** Millionaires (with equity worth at least $1 million)

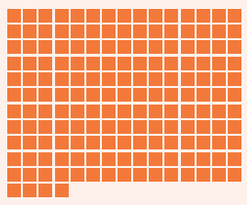
Note: These are estimates rather than guaranteed payouts ■ 1 square = 10 employees

WHO HOLDS THE SHARES

■ 1 square = 10 million shares · Values at $78 upper price

Early Restricted Stock Awards (RSAs)

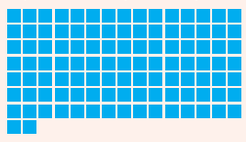
~1.69b
~$131.5 billion



7 cofounders. In 2021, they were given 1.73b shares. After some were sold or bought back over the years, they currently hold 1.69b shares of regular stock. Approx. 45m shares difference accounts for both non-founder early-staff RSAs & any shares repurchased or sold in pre-IPO tender offers

Unvested Restricted Stock Units (RSUs)

~1.07b
~$84 billion (before tax)



Spread across current/recent staff. Headcount up from 940 to 5,300 since Dec 31, 2024. (RSUs have been granted only since 2025.) A back-of-the-envelope calculation equating net headcount change of 4,360 with number of new staff who got RSUs puts the average value at ~$20m (this disregards older staff who may have got RSUs, and that seniority would determine actual RSUs granted)

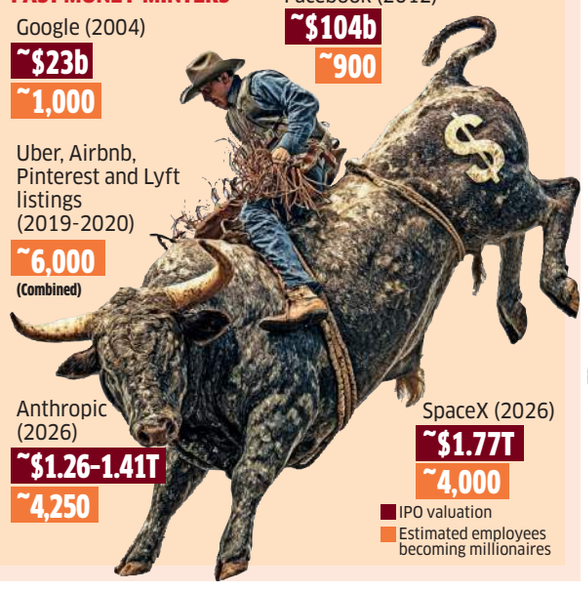
Employee Stock Options

~1.77b
~$138 billion (Gross)
(~$133b net after $5.2 billion strike costs)

Weighted-average exercise price is $2.91 across all options. About 1.08 billion options were vested as of September 30, 2026

Source: ET calculations based on Anthropic's SEC filing; Hill.com analysis, cited by The Observer; media reports. Values at the $78 upper price unless stated

PAST MONEY-MINTERS



India Eyes Windfall as 'Blue Tsunami' Chills US Data Centre Push

Political risk rattles US AI data hubs, making India a top alternative if policy stays stable

Dia Rekhi

Chennai: The "Blue Tsunami" in the US midterms has triggered investor anxiety over potential moratoriums on data centres, threatening massive AI infrastructure buildouts, with incoming Democratic administrations in several states expected to adopt a hard line.

The uncertainty could slow investments and prompt some developers to look at other potential sites, including India, industry executives said.

"There's a lot of turbulence and uncertainty over the future of our data centre projects in the US," one Indian executive at a global construction firm told ET. "Pausing or placing moratoriums on such facilities was one of the core issues that the Democrats ran on, so we're expecting that regulation will get tighter."

This may not affect projects currently underway, but the data centre business has been driving growth for several companies in the US lately "and now there is looming concern over how this might play out," said the executive who did not wish to be named.

"The midterms changed the politics of the buildout before they changed any law," said Paul Kedrosky, fellow at Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) and partner at venture capital firm SK Ventures.

"Voters rejected 44 of 45 data-centre ballot measures, and control of the congressional committees shifted," he explained. "The tax treatment, subsidies, and permits this construction depends on are political decisions, and the consent behind them is being withdrawn, locally first."

As a result, there could be a flight of capital outside of the country or at a minimum, "a wait and see approach," according to Alexander Tanenbaum, partner at corporate law firm Torys LLP.

He said some of Torys' clients are looking at data centre development in the Nordic countries including Sweden and Finland. They've also seen a move towards Canada because of access to power, including renewable power, stable political system, cold climate, and skilled workforce. A lot of those things, barring climate, apply to India as well, Tanenbaum added.

"Our clients are historically comfortable investing in India and there's a perception that India has a very skilled, tech-friendly workforce," he said. "So, to the extent that India is able to put together a political recipe that allows for this investment, global investors will likely be amenable to putting money into the country."

Felix Wang, partner and managing director of investment research firm Hedgeye, too, believes there is an opportunity to position India as a prime destination for hyperscalers and neocloud providers scaling AI infrastructure.

"We're seeing that many of the GPU buyers are looking elsewhere, because the US now has become a little bit more restrictive on data centre build," Wang said.

INDIA'S WINDOW

Opportunity to position India as a prime destination for hyperscalers & neo-cloud providers scaling AI infra, says an expert

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO
www.economictimes.com

Keeping Tabs

3,000+ operational data centres in the US as of Feb 2026

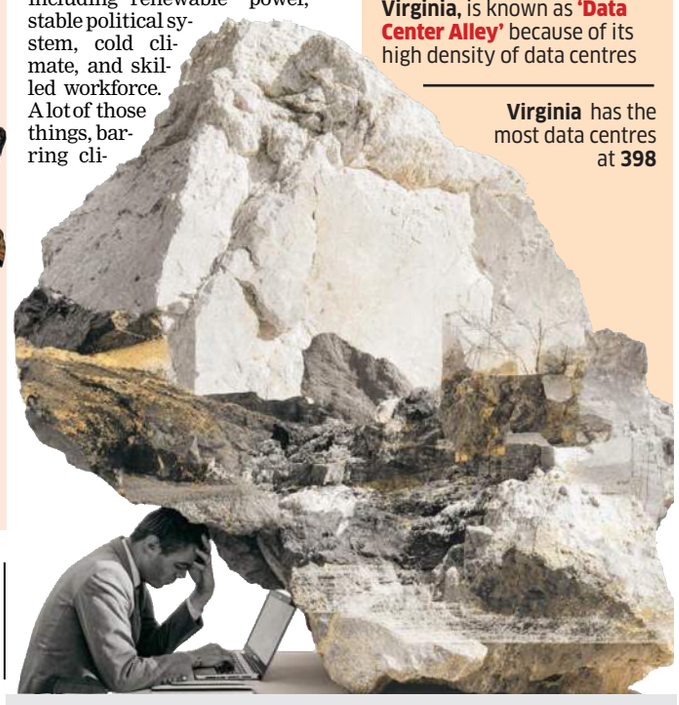
1,500+ additional data centres under development

87% of US data centres are located in urban areas

9 states have 100 or more operational data centres

Loudoun County, Northern Virginia, is known as **'Data Center Alley'** because of its high density of data centres

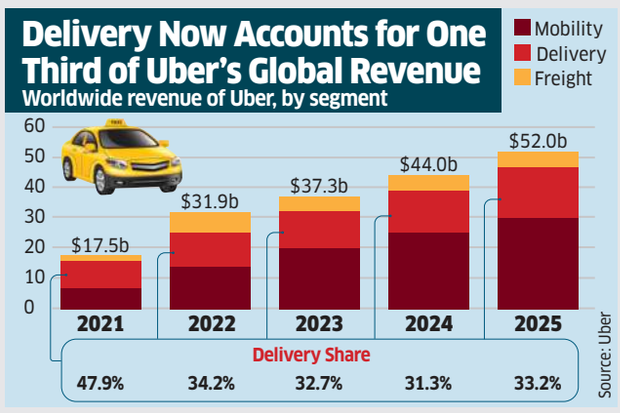
Virginia has the most data centres at **398**



Tech Trotter

Meanwhile in tech...

Delivery Now Accounts for One Third of Uber's Global Revenue
Worldwide revenue of Uber, by segment



EU Court Adviser Backs $1.7b Fine Against Google

BRUSSELS: Google suffered a setback on Thursday as an adviser to Europe's top court faulted a lower tribunal's decision to scrap a €1.49 billion ($1.7 billion) fine levied against the firm seven years ago for anti-competitive practices related to online advertising. The General Court rejected the EU decision in 2024, prompting the Commission to appeal to the Luxembourg-based Court of Justice. Google, whose AdSense platform provides search ads, removed the contested clauses from agreements in 2016. – **Reuters**

Ola Elec's Q2 Revenue Dips 39%

Lower operating expenses helped narrow firm's net loss to ₹362cr

Our Bureau

Bengaluru: Electric two-wheeler maker Ola Electric reported revenue from operations of ₹421 crore for the September quarter, down 39% from ₹690 crore a year earlier, as vehicle registrations continued to slide.

The company said it has stopped orders from its direct-to-consumer stores on Nov 1, and plans to close them by December. Ola Electric, which had announced a pivot to a dealership model in August, now has 255 dealer partners operating over 300 stores, it said in the shareholder letter.

The Bhavish Aggarwal-led company expects operating expenses to further reduce by ₹50 crore as it shuts down the company store network. In the September quarter, lower operating expenses helped it post a narrower net loss of ₹362 crore from ₹418 crore a year ago.

Operating expense reduced to ₹369 crore in Q2 from ₹472 crore a year ago. This has improved adjusted operating loss before interest, tax, depreciation and amortisation to ₹246 crore from ₹258 crore. "After the transition to dealers, we are now running a paid order backlog which we intend to quickly extinguish as we ramp production. The constraint is the ramp-up of our supply chain, not our own manufacturing capacity, as our plant can build well above current output," the company said. It said there is a paid order backlog of about 5,000 vehicles in September, whose deliveries were delayed by a week, pushing them into October.

NPCI Scheme to Tap Merchant Fees to Boost UPI Adoption Among Small Shops

UPI PUSH Three-year scheme set to come into effect from the date MDR is implemented

Nikhil Patwardhan

Bengaluru: The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has notified a scheme to use a part of the merchant fees on UPI transactions to incentivise banks to bring small shops onto the Unified Payments Interface network and increase their transaction volumes.

The UPI Vyapaar Saksham Scheme will run for three years from the date the merchant discount rate (MDR) takes effect, according to a November 11 circular sent to all Unified Payments Interface (UPI) members. ET has reviewed a copy of the circular.

NPCI proposed a small-merchant fund on September 15, when it announced a 0.4% MDR on eligible merchant payments above ₹2,000 made through UPI from bank accounts, subject to a cap of ₹300 per transaction. The fee was scheduled to take effect on October 15, but NPCI's steering committee deferred the rollout until after Diwali. It has yet to notify a revised date. Issuing and acquiring banks, payer payment service providers, and UPI apps will each contribute 5% of their eligible MDR income to the fund.

Acquiring banks, which sign up merchants directly or through payment aggregators, can claim incentives under the Vyapaar Saksham scheme quarterly. Only settled payments of ₹2,000 or less will count towards those incentives.

The scheme covers merchants with a turnover of up to ₹40 lakh in the previous financial year.

HELPING HAND

The scheme covers merchants with a turnover of up to ₹40L in the previous fiscal

Social Media Firms Seek DPDP Alignment in Child Safety Rules

Suraksha P

Bengaluru: Social media platforms cautioned the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) against introducing a separate age-assurance obligation in its proposed online child safety guidelines, arguing that the Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) framework already covers it, people aware of the development said.

In a meeting held by NCPCR on Thursday, the platforms said age-assurance and parental-consent mechanisms under the data protection regime should be harmonised with any NCPCR guidelines rather than being governed by parallel obligations. The meeting to discuss proposed guidelines for technology companies on protecting children online was attended by NCPCR chairperson Valeti Premchand and member secretary Sanjeev Sharma, along with Manoj Meena, director, National Cybercrime Threat Analytics Unit, Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre, and Sathyanarayanan Subramanian, additional director, cyberlaw, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, people cited above said. Representatives of Google, Meta, Snap, Reddit, Roblox, Garena Games and ShareChat presented their points of alignment with the NCPCR's Child Safety Implementation Matrix.

The matrix includes principles relating to safety by design, age assurance, default protections for minors, child data protection, detection of child sexual abuse material and grooming, harmful content, digital wellbeing, reporting and redressal, parental empowerment, and audits and impact assessments, the sources said.

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www.economictimes.com

Now, for a Post-Gen Jensen Nvidia

A smooth leadership transition needed

Jensen Huang's resignation as Nvidia boss over a scandal around his affairs shakes the keystone of the AI ecosystem. Nvidia faces the prospect of slowing AI infrastructure build-out and scrutiny over its role in funding it. Nvidia locks access to scarce manufacturing capacity in long-term contracts that control access to vital hardware needed to run frontier AI models. The company's strategy of financing infrastructure that uses its chips has raised concerns over circular funding. The question is expected to be probed at greater length by Congress under the less AI-bullish Democrats. This is apart from the rising number of states in the US that are restricting data centres.

As founder and hands-on boss, Huang built Nvidia's walled garden that locks millions of developers into its chip architecture and makes switching to a competitor's chip an expensive proposition. The company routinely cannibalises its chip line-up to outpace rival chipmakers. It also controls the networks that control communication between clusters of graphical processing units at supercomputer scale. Nvidia has an overwhelming dominance in a full-stack ecosystem of specialised hardware, proprietary software and high-speed networking. Huang, with dozens of direct reports, kept the machine running. Finding a replacement won't be easy. Neither will be holding on to so much concentration.

The scale of Huang's indiscretions outweighs anything reported so far in corporate history. Nvidia is the world's 2nd most-valuable company, and reached $5.6 tn peak value — before the scandal broke. Investors have lost $600 bn this week. This matters, because of the weight Nvidia and fellow technology stocks have in the US500. The effects are rippling through AI and technology stocks to the broader market and risk throttling investment. An AI slowdown will squeeze US growth and intensify fiscal stress. Nvidia needs a smooth leadership transition because of its centrality to the tech-fuelled growth of the world's two largest economies, the US and China.

For a Greener Future, Bring Back Coal Cess

Reintroducing a coal cess should be on the FM's priority list for Budget 2027-28. India's CO_2 emissions continued to rise in 2025, even as global emissions growth slowed. India has slipped 5 places to 28th in the latest Climate Change Performance Index, which assesses 64 countries and the EU. This is despite adding a record 55.3 GW of non-fossil capacity in 2025-26, making it the world's 3rd largest in installed RE capacity. Coal's share of installed capacity has fallen from 61% in 2014-15 to 41.7% in 2025-26, but its dominance in generation persists.

Electricity demand is expected to grow 6.4% annually till 2030, making a rapid coal exit near-impossible. A coal cess will signal India is pricing its carbon dependence. It could also reduce carbon costs exporters face at the border. Britain has recognised India's Carbon Credit Trading Scheme (CCTS) for carbon-price relief under its CBAM. The EU is yet to do so. A cess could strengthen India's case for similar relief, while retaining more carbon revenue at home to fund the energy transition.

Unlike a carbon tax, a cess won't require an amendment to tax laws. It can be an interim measure as CCTS expands and a carbon tax is debated. With GST on coal at 18%, an additional ₹500 a tonne, against the previous ₹400, is hardly excessive. Cess proceeds are outside Finance Commission's divisible pool, making it possible to earmark them for a 'Just Transition Fund'. Allocation based on effort-sharing could recognise states' differing capacities and transition costs, addressing their resistance to a central cess. In 2024-25, coal cess yielded ₹52,500 cr. A revived cess would create a dedicated transition fund and signal India's commitment to a decarbonised development pathway.

JUST IN JEST

Sonia Gandhi's memoir is more to be attended than, perhaps, read

Waiting to Belong at Belonging's Launch

Delhi has a must-attend event next week. After reading the blurb and some pages of Sonia Gandhi's 544-pg memoir, Belonging: A Journey of Love, and forwarding key passages already tweeted, the real bragging right is not reading the book but being seen at its Nov 16 launch. Unlike most book launches, with earnest questions, plonk and kebabs, this one will require a little more than literary curiosity since the guest list is being personally curated by the publisher and the author's family. It is understood that no SIR documentation will be needed.

Invitation is more valuable than the book itself. The gathering is sure to bring together Delhi's political crème de la creamy layer that no longer share drawing rooms or official programmes. Gandhi, not being from the reigning Parivar these days, should draw guests from the political, bureaucratic, journalistic classes, not to mention culturati, who have not ventured too much this side of the fence. The city's elaborate social grammar will be on display: look familiar, but not overeager; informed, but not too invested. A little political ambiguity will certainly help. Launch of Belonging may offer space in that ephemeral zone that is neither establishment nor anti-establishment. In the national capital, belonging has always been a feeling. Being seen belonging will be a social coup for so many.

Even with Jensen Huang resigning from Nvidia, the chip landscape will be irrevocably changed

Hormones Guiding History?

Chipped away

Saibal Dasgupta

Even with Nvidia's board announcing on Thursday the resignation of co-founder-CEO Jensen Huang — with a second affair, one with Nvidia vice-president of healthcare Kimberly Powell, revealed on Wednesday — the big question now is whether 'L'affaire Alice Huang' will be fully investigated.

Trump has already shown governmental reluctance to investigate a major Republican Party donor. Besides, he needs to weigh the risk of disrupting relations with China over the issue, especially since China controls over 80% of processed rare earth supplies.

Megaspeed International, the Singapore-based cloud computing firm founded by Alice Huang, has been reportedly using Nvidia chips to provide compute power to Chinese buyers. China can use compute power available in different countries, even if it can't buy advanced chips directly from the US. In such a circumstance, Washington may move to restrict sale or leasing of compute power using US chips.

Beijing-based Global Times has written off the 'espionage story' as manufactured to weaken US-China relations. Some commentators have pointed out that the scandal has conveniently broken at a time when Microsoft has started releasing its own chips. But such 'leakages' aren't new.

In February, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei had announced that his company had worked proactively to deploy its series of LLMs, Claude, across US Department of War and intelligence agencies. Reports later revealed that Centcom and Pentagon had used Claude during airstrikes against Iran that started in March. This was the first major disclosure about a privately-run AI model being used for 'mission-critical' applications, like AI analysis, modelling and simulation, operational planning, and cyber ops.

The Jensen-Alice honeytrap incident needs to be viewed in the context of its political and military implications, not as yet another case of corporate espionage

The Jensen-Alice honeytrap incident needs to be viewed in the context of its political and military implications, not as yet another case of corporate espionage

China has developed a certain expertise in accessing foreign technologies through a variety of means since launching economic reforms in December 1978. It has also become adept in the use of Western-style propaganda, hiring lobbyists and PR agencies to counter repeated accusations of technology thefts.

Foreign collaboration has been fundamental to China's semiconductor development. Its chip industry has flourished with the help of machinery, manufacturing expertise, designs, investment and trained personnel from the US, Japan, Taiwan, South Korea and European countries. Such legal routes suffice for producing copycat products, but fall short of driving true innovation.

Zhang Rujing, a.k.a. Richard Chang, regarded as China's 'godfather of semiconductors', after moving to the US from Taiwan in his early 20s, started working at Texas Instruments (TI) in Dallas from 1977. In 1997, he left TI, going on to found Semiconductor Manufacturing International Corporation (SMIC) in Shanghai, drawing on international expertise, foreign investment and overseas equipment suppliers.

If Jensen really is found to be a victim of Chinese espionage, the implications would be mind-boggling. Theft could narrow down US tech advantage in chip and AI industry

Since then, government agencies in the US, South Korea, Taiwan and the Netherlands have, on different occasions, accused China of stealing materials, designs and technology related to the semiconductor chip industry.

In one case, China agreed to pay damages worth $200 mn after Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Company (TSMC) accused SMIC of stealing fabrication process and manufacturing secrets. ASML of the Netherlands also filed cases of pilferage against individual Chinese nationals associated with their projects in China. The US accused China of stealing Micron's DRAM (Dynamic Random-Access Memory) technology, and Avago/Skyworks semiconductor trade secrets. South Korean prosecutors have levelled charges involving unauthorised transfers of Samsung and SK Hynix semiconductor technology to Chinese ventures.

One way of illegally accessing tech has reportedly been using honeytraps on foreign officials, scientists and businessmen. Female spies connected to Ministry of State Security (MSS), a.k.a. Guoan, China's intelligence agency, are allegedly put to the task. MSS also obtains information and support services from intelligence agencies of countries that have friendly ties with China. Thus, a honeytrap can be set in a range of locations.

If Jensen really is found to be a victim of Chinese espionage, the implications would be mind-boggling. Nvidia designs advanced processors powering much of the global AI revolution. Tech implications could be substantial. A possible theft could narrow down US tech advantage in chip and AI industry.

The scandal also has the potential of causing serious political discomfort for Trump as Democrats are bound to question his decision to sell advanced Nvidia chips to China on Huang's advice. Washington might respond by imposing fresh restrictions on sales of chips to not only China but also to other countries. Such a decision can have serious impact on India, which mostly uses Nvidia chips.

Even with Jensen removed from Nvidia, hormones may well have decided the march of history.

The writer is former TOI Beijing correspondent

Huge Inflows in Small Spaces

Nirmal Jain

Something remarkable is happening in India's financial sector. Global capital is increasingly finding its way not just into large corporations and infra projects, but also into institutions that finance small shopkeepers, first-time homebuyers and aspiring entrepreneurs. This could be one of the more consequential developments in India's journey towards becoming a developed economy.

Japan's Mitsubishi UFJ Financial Group (MUFG) has invested in Shriram Finance, Abu Dhabi's International Holding Company (IHC) has backed Sammaan Capital, Bain Capital has committed to Manappuram Finance, and Blackstone has agreed to invest ₹5,000 cr in IIFL Finance. These investments reflect growing international confidence in India's specialised lending institutions and potential to deliver sustainable, profitable growth.

NBFC crises of the late 1990s and 2018 exposed vulnerabilities in governance, liquidity management and funding structures. Each episode prompted regulatory reforms and greater institutional discipline.

▶ **Regulatory trust** RBI has progressively strengthened capital adequacy, provisioning, liquidity, governance and supervisory requirements. Its scale-based regulatory framework has brought greater scrutiny to larger institutions.

Meanwhile, leading NBFCs have evolved from entrepreneur-driven businesses into professionally-managed organisations with substantial balance sheets, independent boards, diversified funding and sophisticated risk-management systems. The result is a sector better equipped to pursue sustainable growth, even as credit, liquidity and governance risks demand constant vigilance.

Up with the downpour!

▶ **DPI doors** Aadhaar, digital KYC, UPI and the account aggregator framework have created capabilities that few countries possess at comparable scale. Traditionally, assessing borrowers with irregular incomes and limited financial documentation required extensive physical verification, manual processes and subjective judgement.

Today, consent-based financial data, digital transaction histories and AI can make underwriting faster, more accurate and less expensive. AI-enabled systems can also identify inconsistencies and potential fraud that would be difficult or costly to detect manually.

▶ **MSME headroom** Despite decades of policy support, India's MSMEs contribute about 30% of GDP. Their contribution is substantially higher in economies like China and South Korea, although statistical definitions differ. This gap reflects multiple structural factors. But inadequate access to affordable finance remains an important constraint.

India's favourable demographics, rising aspirations and relatively low formal credit penetration create considerable headroom for expansion. A small manufacturer needs working capital, a retailer needs inventory, a transporter needs another vehicle, and a family may need financing for its first home. These are modest requirements individually. But, collectively, they represent an enormous economic opportunity.

Specialised NBFCs are particularly well-positioned to facilitate this process. Their understanding of local markets and unconventional income profiles complements banks' deposit franchises and funding capabilities. Policymakers and regulators increasingly recognise this relationship, with RBI's clearer co-lending framework creating opportunities for collaboration while preserving accountability and customer protection.

For international investors, the proposition is commercially attractive and strategically meaningful. They can partner with established institutions to participate in India's long-term growth, supported by improving governance, technology and regulatory oversight.

For India, with its substantial investment requirements and structural CAD, such capital is especially valuable. Long-term foreign equity strengthens domestic financial institutions without creating foreign debt repayment obligations. Through NBFCs, it can reach the grassroots economy rather than remaining concentrated in large, capital-intensive projects.

The next priority is to complement equity inflows with deeper corporate bond markets, diversified long-term funding, efficient overseas borrowing arrangements and risk-sensitive regulation. These measures can lower funding costs and, ultimately, make credit more affordable.

That would be a remarkable win-win: rewarding investors, while helping build a more inclusive, resilient and prosperous India.

The writer is founder-MD, IIFL Finance

Ease of Engagement, Not Just Biz

Arijit Barman

With foreigners dumping close to $40 bn of stocks over the past year, everyone — from Sensex savants to Sebi — is clamouring for removal of equity tax on foreigners to reverse the dollar drain. But tax tweaks alone won't cut it. We should first think of ease of engagement, starting with a reset of attitude and priorities.

Policy wonks have historically fussed too much about foreign capital buying domestic assets. But being perennially paranoid about the colour of money has only diminished India's market appeal. Between the 'Magnificent 7', US private credit, US treasuries or the trillion-dollar opportunity to bankroll AI chips, global data centres, power infrastructure, and global assets, global moneybags are getting pulled in by asset classes of all shapes and sizes. While there are multiple distractions, India continues to sour global investor sentiments.

Just last month, the yield spread between India's 10-yr sovereign bonds and US treasuries widened by 58 bps, the sharpest monthly surge since 2019, skyrocketing our risk premium. Factor in rupee depreciation, withholding tax, and the uneven playing field between domestic and international investors, and there's very little incentive left for global fund managers to open their fat cheque books.

India is too difficult, relative to other opportunities where rules are clear, tax treatment is predictable, enforcement is credible, and returns compensate for risk. So, what can we do to make long-term, institutional capital want India again?

For starters, create a big institutional investor category. Large, regulated global investors — pension funds, alternative asset managers, financial institutions, sovereign wealth funds, insurers — that meet clear thresholds on assets under management, regulatory oversight, disclosures, beneficial ownership and track record should be seen as part of India's capital architecture, not as concession to foreign ownership.

More importantly, they need to be treated at par with their domestic peers. Post a one-time vetting by regulators, we should allow greater flexibility on instruments, pricing, end-use and secondary transactions, while being held to higher standards of reporting and transparency.

We already recognise special categories like qualified institutional buyers (QIBs) for equity and debt. But it's time to expand their scope of engagement.

Pièce no résistance

For example, regulators must review norms to allow international investors to invest in optionally convertible instruments, redeemable preferred equity, even structuring warrants without conditions. The external commercial borrowing (ECB) route allows those with requisite foreign venture capital investor (FVCI) licence some leeway. But those investments are limited to a handful of sectors.

Even for listed companies issuing convertible preference shares, there's an artificially determined timeline of 18 mths to convert those shares. In fear of allowing capital that might look like debt, several commonly accepted instruments aren't allowed. It's time we move from instrument control to risk control.

Sophisticated capital providers and companies should be allowed to negotiate commercial instruments, provided the regulator has visibility on leverage, maturity, beneficial ownership, related-party transfers, pricing abuse and systemic exposure. Regulate risk, not ban structures.

We have forever oversold equity and undersold debt, even at the cost of being a more efficient capital source in many cases. Borrowing *is* risky. But if we don't learn risk-taking, equity alone won't be able to fund large-scale, capex-heavy, transformative projects or deals.

The debt market also needs to be nurtured around the way capital actually moves. We obsess only about government bonds. But investors are increasingly preferring a taste of the whole spectrum of capital structures: corporate credit, performing and distress or special situations opportunities, along with infrastructure and mezzanine capital or structured equity.

India needs all that if banks are to lend more to households and MSMEs, while larger companies and platforms access institutional capital. Rules that prevent bilateral credit trades, constrain prepayment flexibility or make exits uncertain reduce liquidity while raising cost of capital.

The policy choice is whether India continues to design capital rules mainly around preventing abuse, or also to attract pedigreed and patient pools. Rapid financialisation of savings has its limitations, too. There's a limit to what domestic capital can fund.

Regulators have started moving in the right direction. RBI's recent liberalisation of the ECB framework, including higher borrowing headroom and a more market-based approach to pricing, is a meaningful step, much like withdrawal of concentration limits for FPI investment in corporate debt through the general route. But they are still incremental.

A clearer framework that taxes income primarily in the investor's place of residence, subject to substance, beneficial ownership and anti-abuse rules, would make Indian debt more competitive. This isn't tax forbearance but capital-market policy.

Ease of engagement becomes crucial as we play catch up in the data centre race. If we aspire to make, build, compute and employ more, we must first make it easier for serious capital to enter, stay, compound and recycle.

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THE SPEAKING TREE

Prakriti Meets AI

A K JAGANNATHAN

Life is an interplay between transcendence, divine reality and prakriti, the material world. Gita teaches that Atman, present in every living being, is pure, eternal and imperishable. Human actions, however, are influenced by the three gunas of prakriti, become subject to the law of karm, leading to the cycle of birth and death, and the existence of samsar. Krishn's teachings illuminate various paths to moksh, the ultimate liberation from this cycle.

Today, another powerful force has emerged: AI, created by human ingenuity and technological advancement. Reports indicate that some individuals are developing emotional attachments to AI-generated personalities. An AI companion can be designed to be endlessly agreeable, available always, and seemingly free from conflict. In such a scenario, genuine human relationships risk being replaced by artificial substitutes, blurring the distinction between real life and virtual experience.

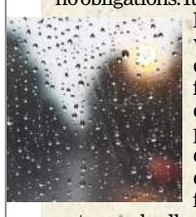
Gita offers a timeless remedy. Just as a seeker is urged to cut down the upside-down Asvattha tree of worldly delusion through detachment and wisdom, society must cultivate discernment in using AI. It is neither a saviour nor a threat. Used wisely, it can preserve knowledge, disseminate wisdom, and safeguard humanity's spiritual and cultural heritage. Used selfishly or unethically, it can deepen confusion and fracture the social fabric. The choice, ultimately, rests with us.

ALGO OF BLISSTECH

First Rain Before Winter

There's something deliciously unexpected about the first rain just before the onset of winter. It arrives like an old friend who has missed the last train home and decided to surprise you instead. The sky darkens, the wind turns mischievous, and suddenly the familiar world acquires the excitement of an unscheduled holiday.

Unlike the monsoon's relentless downpours, this rain has no obligations. It need not replenish reservoirs, rescue crops or justify its existence. It falls, simply because it can. And catching it, preferably without an umbrella, is one of life's cheaper extravagances.



The smell of wet earth rises from pavements and vegetation, recalling a time when getting drenched was an achievement, not a medical concern. Leaves glisten, streets briefly surrender their dust, and even the most disagreeable buildings appear freshly washed and surprisingly respectable.

There is the pleasure of knowing that this rain is a farewell. Soon, the air will sharpen, evenings will arrive earlier, and jackets and sweaters will emerge from their annual exile.

But, for now, there is water on your face, a cool breeze against your shirt, and the exquisite sensation of being gloriously, unnecessarily wet. Winter can wait.

Chat Room

Let's Celebrate, Bhasmasur-Style

Apropos the Edit, 'Mystery of Delhi's Missing $PM_{2.5}$ Data' (Nov 12), when more than 20 monitoring stations go silent during the peak smog hours on Diwali, and the 'missing' readings later show $PM_{2.5}$ more than 60× the national standard, the real casualty is public trust. Delhi residents, of course, needed no data or device to know that the air was unbreathable. While more than 80% of the city's post-Diwali pollution was traced to firecrackers since the Supreme Court's green-cracker allowance was breached in the extreme, politicians pointed fingers at neighbouring states. And worse, many people treated the appeals for restraint as a challenge to their religious celebrations and burst even more crackers, with a vengeance. If the data went missing, so did political will and common sense. So, when firecrackers went up this Diwali, wisdom went down.

M S Allama Prabhu
Bengaluru

AI-Led Job Slump to Reverse in 3-5 Years: Kris Gopalakrishnan

Infosys cofounder says hirings to remain muted for one-two years as cos are trying to reconfigure their service offerings

Beena Parmar & KR Balasubramanyam

Bengaluru: The current slowdown in hiring at technology services companies is a temporary consequence of the industry's transition towards artificial intelligence-led offerings, Infosys cofounder S 'Kris' Gopalakrishnan said. He predicted a sharp increase in demand for AI-skilled talent over the next three to five years.

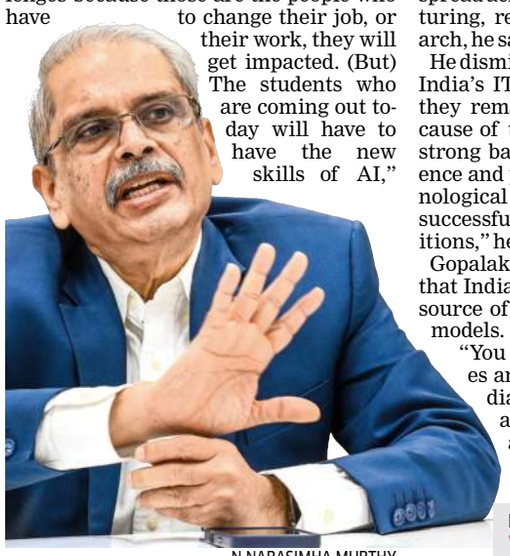
"Recruitment will be affected for probably one or two years because this transition is happening. Companies are trying to reconfigure their service offerings," Gopalakrishnan told **ET** on the sidelines of the Infosys Prize 2026 announcement on Thursday.

His comments come as widespread layoffs occur across large tech companies including Qualcomm, Oracle, Microsoft and Amazon, triggering fears of large-scale job losses also in software services, which has been India's largest employment-creating sector over the past two decades.

Across India's top IT majors, exits are outpacing new hires in IT and engineering functions, as their combined headcount fell nearly 3% to around 798,000 in October 2026 from 822,000 a year earlier, ET reported recently. Tata Consultancy Services, India's largest IT company, last year announced the retrenchment of more than 12,000 employees.

Gopalakrishnan called it a skills transition rather than a structural decline in demand.

The kind of jobs will change, he said. "As progress happens…as new tools are introduced, the transition will see some challenges because those are the people who have to change their job, or their work, they will get impacted. (But) The students who are coming out today will have to have the new skills of AI," he said.



N NARASIMHA MURTHY

INDIA AS AI PRODUCT HUB

You will see more product companies and AI models coming out of India. Hundreds of startups are already building AI-based products, and the next challenge is to scale globally

By the time today's students enter the workforce, AI training is expected to be embedded in academic curricula, while companies and universities are already investing heavily in reskilling initiatives.

In the interim, he said, companies are focusing on retraining their existing workforce and redesigning service offerings around AI.

Despite concerns over AI-led disruption, Gopalakrishnan expects the more than $300 billion Indian IT and software services industry to continue expanding after the ongoing transition. He pointed to the steady growth of global capability centres, which now employ around 2 million people. The broader technology industry employs about 6 million.

"The industry will continue to grow, though perhaps not at the pace seen earlier. Once the transition is complete, growth will resume," said the former Infosys CEO, adding that "in the next two to three years, things will improve dramatically".

Meanwhile, demand for AI skills will spread across sectors including manufacturing, retail and pharmaceutical research, he said.

He dismissed fears that AI could weaken India's IT services giants, arguing that they remained globally competitive because of their deep client relationships, strong balance sheets, extensive experience and proven ability to navigate technological shifts. "These companies have successfully managed multiple transitions," he said.

Gopalakrishnan expressed confidence that India would emerge as a significant source of AI products, applications and models.

"You will see more product companies and AI models coming out of India. Hundreds of startups are already building AI-based products, and the next challenge is to scale globally," he said.

FOR FULL REPORT, GO TO www.economictimes.com

Sports World Play

Michael Rocks No More

Man United fire coach Carrick after worst start to a Premier League season

James Robson

Michael Carrick was fired by Manchester United on Thursday after overseeing the 20-time English champion's worst start to a Premier League season, with US men's coach Mauricio Pochettino a potential candidate to succeed him.

Carrick's departure comes less than six months after he was given a two-year contract and the responsibility of reviving the fortunes of the once-dominant force of English football. United haven't won the league since managerial great Alex Ferguson retired in 2013.

A 4-4 draw with Aston Villa on Sunday left United 18th in the 20-team standings and in the relegation zone after just one league win all season. With eight points from 10 games, it is United's worst start for 40 years — predating the Premier League era.

"After a disappointing start to the season, the club has come to the extremely difficult conclusion that a change is necessary in order to achieve our ambitions," United said.

United have been working on a potential deal to have Pochettino replace Carrick, a source with knowledge of the situation told The Associated Press on Wednesday. The 54-year-old Argentine is under contract with the US team through the 2030 World Cup.

Pochettino, who has previously coached Southampton, Tottenham and Chelsea, took over the US in October 2024 and led it to the round of 16 at this year's World Cup. He was a leading candidate for United in 2022 when Erik ten Hag was ultimately hired.

Michael Carrick

EIGHTH MANAGER

Firing Carrick comes after he insisted he would not walk away from the job following the chaotic draw with Villa that highlighted United's defensive flaws.

It means United are on the hunt for an eighth permanent manager since Ferguson's departure 13 years ago, a turbulent period in which the club has been overtaken by Man City, Liverpool, Arsenal and Chelsea.

Carrick, a former United midfielder, was appointed on a short-term deal midway through last season and guided the team to a third-place finish and Champions League qualification. **AP**

COST OF HIRING & FIRING (POST-2013)

COMPENSATION FOR SACKING

Manager	Cost (£m)
David Moyes	4.9
Louis van Gaal	8.4
José Mourinho	19.6
Ole Gunnar Solskjaer	10.0
Ralf Rangnick (Interim)	14.7
Erik ten Hag	10.4
Ruben Amorim	8.2
Michael Carrick	2.9

COMPENSATION FOR SIGNING

Ole Gunnar Solskjaer	1.0
Erik ten Hag	1.6
Ruben Amorim	11.0
Mauricio Pochettino*	7.4

*If hired

IYER APPARENT

Shreyas to Make ODI Captaincy Debut as India Shuffle Pack

Mount Maunganui: Shreyas Iyer will have a point to prove with the bat on his ODI captaincy debut as India and New Zealand look to navigate sweeping squad changes while balancing their white-ball commitments with preparations for the upcoming Test series in the fourth match on Friday.

India lead the five-match series 2-0 and will be looking to seal it, while New Zealand must win the remaining two matches to level the series after the third ODI was abandoned.

Iyer, whose struggles against the short ball have resurfaced during the series, will lead India in the final two matches after Shubman Gill left the squad to prepare for the Test series, which begins on November 19. KL Rahul and Anshul Kamboj have also left the squad to get ready for Tests.

The changes offer an opportunity for Ruturaj Gaikwad, Ishan Kishan and senior fast bowler Mohammed Siraj to get valuable time in the middle ahead of the Tests. **PTI**

7:30AM | SONY TEN, SONY LIV

VITALS

KUMAMOTO MASTERS

Srikanth, Lakshya in Quarters

Kumamoto: Veteran shuttler Kidambi Srikanth and Lakshya Sen progressed to the men's singles quarterfinals with contrasting wins at the Kumamoto Masters Japan Super 500 badminton tournament on Thursday. Former world No.1 Srikanth stunned fifth seed and world No. 8 Kodai Naraoka of Japan 21-15, 11-21, 21-18 to set up a clash with another local shuttler Koki Watanabe. Lakshya defeated Dong Tian Yao of China 21-8, 21-14 to reach the last eight. He will face Japan's Yushi Tanaka. **PTI**

ISSF WORLD CHAMPIONSHIPS

Vivaan Traps LA28 Quota

Doha: India's Vivaan Kapoor came within touching distance of a world title before settling for silver in the men's trap event at the ISSF World Championships on Thursday, but his podium finish also earned the country a quota place for the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics. **PTI**

Sinner Looking to Gain Weight

World No. 2 Jannik Sinner said he lost a lot of weight after having his tonsils removed and is now rebuilding muscle as he continues to work towards his return from a knee injury. The 25-year-old's knee issue has kept him out of action since he won his fifth Grand Slam title at Wimbledon in July, but he said earlier this week he was confident of being back in time for the Australian Open in January. In a video posted on his YouTube channel on Wednesday, the Italian was seen speaking with a doctor about how the weight loss could affect his recovery. **Reuters**

WATCHOUT! Tonight

NATIONS LEAGUE **Bulgaria v Iceland** 1:15am; **Netherlands v Greece** 1:15am; **Serbia v Germany** 1:15am (Sony Sports Network)
ODI **Australia v England** 9am (Fancode)

THE HIMACHAL PRADESH STATE CO-OPERATIVE BANK LTD.
Head Office-The Mall Shimla (H.P.)-171001
(Bank of the State -For the State)
Phone-0177-2804491-93, Email:-info@hpscb.bank.in

Advertisement for one post of General Manager in The H.P. Sate Cooperative Bank Ltd., Head Office, The Mall Shimla on Deputation Basis.

The Himachal Pradesh State Cooperative Bank Ltd., Head Office, The Mall Shimla invites applications for one post of General Manager in the Bank purely on deputation basis from amongst the eligible officers working with NABARD / Nationalized Banks. The deputation will initially be for a period of one year, which may be extended on need basis. The officers desirous to apply for the aforementioned post must fulfil the criteria uploaded on Bank's website www.hpscb.bank.in.

The interested officers may submit an application on plain paper duly consented/recommended by the concerned employer along with complete Bio-Data through proper channel to the Managing Director, HPSCB. Applications submitted directly without the consent/ recommendation of the employer shall not be entertained. The last date for receipt of application through proper channel is 15/12/2026, where after no applications shall be entertained. The applications received from interested officers shall be scrutinized by Bank and applicants shall be informed about further course of action in the matter accordingly.

The Bank reserves the right to modify, cancel or withdraw the hiring process without assigning any reason. **Managing Director**

HINDUSTAN AERONAUTICS LIMITED
Regd.Office: 15/1 Cubbon Road, Bengaluru- 560 001
CIN : L35301KA1963GOI001622 , TEL : 080 22320001,
E-mail : investors@hal-india.co.in, website : www.hal-india.co.in

STATEMENT OF AUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND HALF YEAR ENDED 30TH SEPTEMBER 2026

Rs in Lakhs

S. No.	Particulars	Standalone					Consolidated				
		Quarter ended		Half Year ended		Year ended	Quarter ended		Half Year ended		Year ended
		Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited	Audited
		30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	30-Sep-26	30-Sep-25	31-Mar-26
1	Total Income from Operations	7,61,311	6,62,846	13,12,839	11,44,760	33,08,979	7,61,325	6,62,861	13,12,842	11,44,762	33,08,882
2	Other Income	98,960	88,894	1,89,241	1,63,788	3,70,375	98,830	88,767	1,88,854	1,63,476	3,69,913
3	Total Income	8,60,271	7,51,740	15,02,080	13,08,548	36,79,354	8,60,155	7,51,628	15,01,696	13,08,238	36,78,795
4	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax and Exceptional Items)	2,46,945	2,22,045	4,59,473	4,06,814	12,11,208	2,56,605	2,22,698	4,70,038	4,08,129	12,15,193
5	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional Items)	2,46,945	2,22,045	4,59,473	4,06,814	12,11,208	2,56,605	2,22,698	4,70,038	4,08,129	12,15,193
6	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional Items)	1,83,904	1,66,252	3,41,965	3,03,967	9,07,567	1,93,564	1,66,905	3,52,530	3,05,282	9,11,552
7	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	2,05,135	1,72,047	3,52,143	3,12,283	9,36,353	2,14,801	1,72,696	3,62,703	3,13,580	9,40,330
8	Paid-up Equity Share Capital (Face value - Rs.5 each)	33,439	33,439	33,439	33,439	33,439	33,439	33,439	33,439	33,439	33,439
9	Other Equity excluding revaluation reserves	-	-	-	-	40,52,812	-	-	-	-	40,70,673
10	Capital Redemption Reserve	-	-	-	-	14,761	-	-	-	-	14,761
11	Earnings Per Share (Face value of Rs.5/- each) (EPS for the quarter are not annualised) (in Rs.)										
	(i) Basic	27.50	24.86	51.13	45.45	135.71	28.94	24.96	52.71	45.65	136.30
	(ii) Diluted	27.50	24.86	51.13	45.45	135.71	28.94	24.96	52.71	45.65	136.30
12	Net Worth (including Retained Earning)	-	-			40,86,251	-	-			41,04,460

Notes:

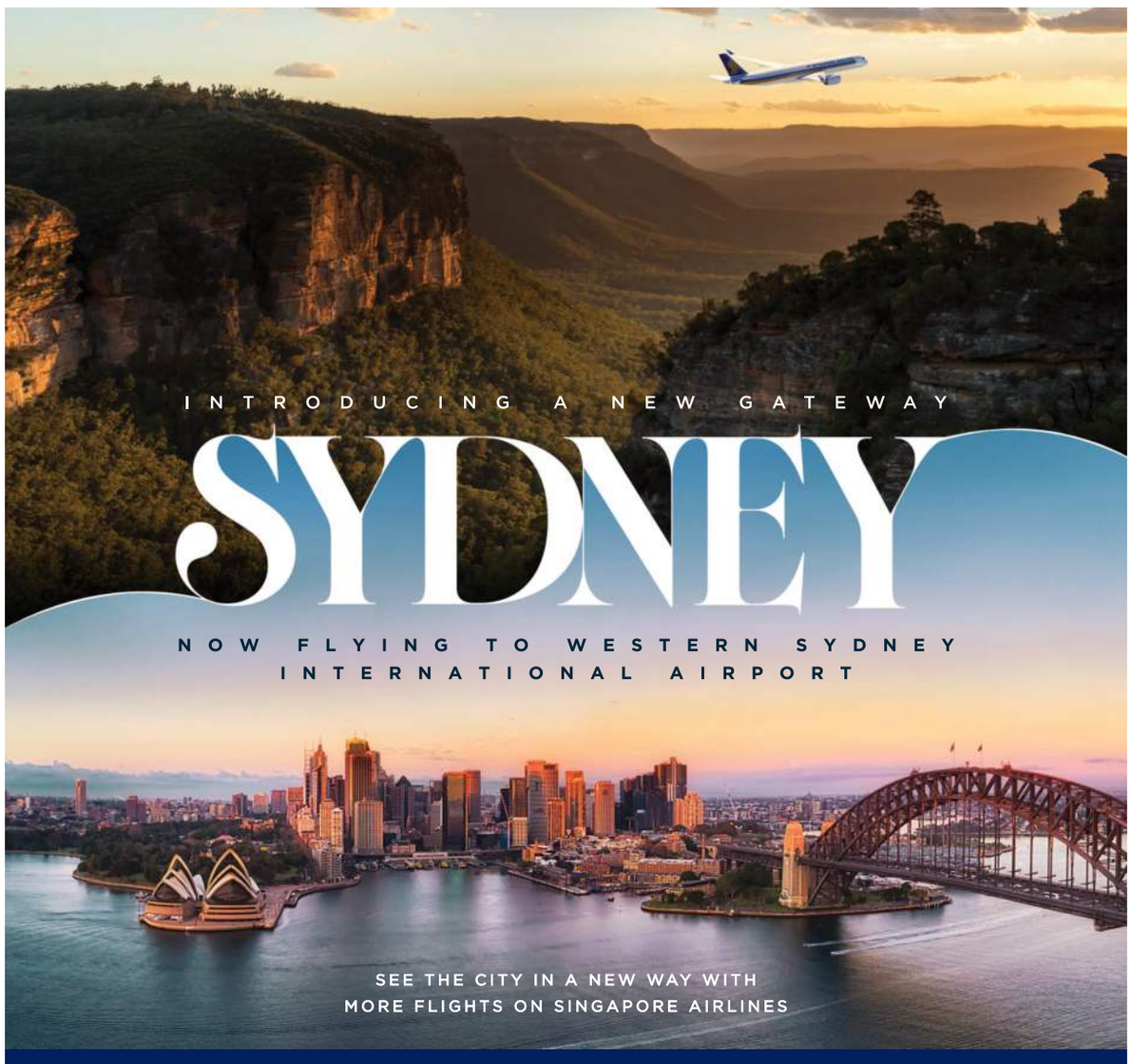
1 The Company has prepared these standalone and consolidated financial results in accordance with the Companies (Indian Accounting Standards) Rules, 2015 prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013.

2 The Statutory Auditors have issued unmodified opinion on the standalone and consolidated financial results of the Company for the quarter and half year ended 30th September 2026.

3 The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly audited financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the quarterly audited financial results are available on the Stock Exchange websites i.e. www.bseindia.com & www.nseindia.com and also on the Company's website www.hal-india.co.in. The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code produced below.

Place : Bengaluru
Date : 12.11.2026

RAVI K
Chairman & Managing Director
DIN: 10807781



Step straight into the wonders of Western Sydney

Starting 23rd November 2026^, Singapore Airlines will commence daily non-stop flights to Sydney's newest aviation hub, Western Sydney International (Nancy-Bird Walton) Airport (WSI). Operating around the clock, WSI offers you greater flexibility and a convenient new gateway to the expansive beauty of New South Wales.

FROM ₹ 83,600*
All-in return

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*Fare shown is for travel in Economy Class on Singapore Airlines flights from Bengaluru to Sydney and includes all associated taxes and surcharges. Seats based on fares shown above are limited and are subject to availability. Book online at singaporeair.com, contact your travel agent, or call the Singapore Airlines Contact Centre at 1800 121 212.

^Subject to regulatory approval.

SUITS & SAYINGS

ET's roundup of the wackiest whispers in corporate corridors

Deal Dilemma

A former chief of a leading consumer goods company, now advising private equity firms, has landed in an awkward spot. He inadvertently found himself advising two rivals on the same potential deal. The overlap arose because one of the contenders is a diversified conglomerate, with the deal in question involving just one part of its business. Having realised the conflict, the veteran executive is now stepping away from one of the assignments, much to the displeasure of the client being dropped.

Vows & Ventures

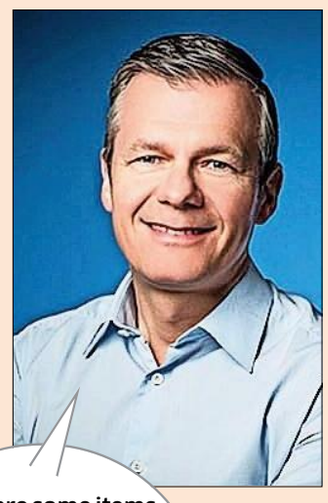
A wedding that has set tongues wagging in real estate circles could turn out to be more than just a union of two prominent business families. A leading developer is set to marry the daughter of a conglomerate family, and the match could prove to be quite a catch in more ways than one. The conglomerate, for which real estate is not a core business, has substantial landholdings that could help the developer son-in-law expand his footprint. Whether the matrimonial alliance also leads to a merger of their real estate interests remains to be seen.

Privy to the whispers in power corridors or juicy tips on India Inc? Do share with us at **etsuits.sayings@timesofindia.com**

Kellanova to Add Snacks & Reach to Mars' India Push

India clocking double-digit growth for Mars, will drive growth in next decade, says CFO

Shilpa Ranipeta



Hyderabad: Mars expects its India business to more than double following its acquisition of Kellanova, its CFO Claus Aagaard told **ET**, as the global food and pet care major now looks to leverage its combined portfolio. Kellanova will not only help Mars strengthen its presence in salty snacks and breakfast cereals, but also expand its distribution reach in what Aagaard termed as one of its fastest growing markets. "India is clocking double-digit growth for Mars, and is going to be a significant fuel for growth over the next decade," he told ET at the launch of the company's new global capability centre in Hyderabad.

> There are some items catering to local tastes, and we want to continue to focus on that to improve the quality and health score of product where we can
>
> **CLAUS AAGAARD**
> *CFO, Mars*

He added that Mars is seeing an acceleration in growth in India, with consumers buying more units as well as trading up. While consumer demand is showing signs of recovery across key markets, Aagaard said the improvement remains fragile, with a fresh wave of inflation driven by rising oil prices posing a risk to spending.

Mars completed its $36-billion acquisition of Kellanova in December 2025, bringing three billion-dollar snacking and cereal brands—Pringles, Cheez-It and Kellogg's—into Mars' portfolio, adding to its existing stable of six billion-dollar confectionery brands, including Snickers, M&M's, Twix, Dove, Skittles and Extra.

In India, the expanded portfolio helps Mars tap into rising premiumisation, with the company betting on increasing household incomes and changing consumption patterns to drive growth rather than competing at the entry price points. Aagaard added that consumers increasingly trading up and shifting towards online and quick-commerce channels is driving growth for the company.

Kellanova's cereal business also gives Mars deeper access to stores and channels where its existing snacking portfolio has had a more limited presence. Aagaard said the company is also looking to build on the growing demand for healthier snacking options through Kellanova's breakfast portfolio, opening up opportunities to introduce more products catering to changing consumer preferences, including those with protein and vitamin benefits. In salty snacks, Mars sees Pringles as a key brand to scale in India.

"There are always some items catering to local tastes, and we want to continue to focus on that to improve the quality and the health score of the product where we can," Aagaard said.

Pet care continues to be a significant growth opportunity in India for the world's largest pet care company. In India too, Mars is the market leader with over 50% market share, with Aagaard still seeing significant headroom for growth. Seven in 10 pet parents in India are first-time owners, Aagaard says, pointing to the relatively early stage of category development. He expects an expanding pet population and rising household incomes to drive demand for packaged pet food.

The company, which sells Pedigree, Whiskas, Sheba and Royal Canin, estimates prepared pet food accounts for less than 10% of pet food consumption in India, highlighting the headroom for category expansion. Euromonitor projects India's pet care market to exceed ₹11,000 crore by 2031.

Pet ownership has continued to grow since the pandemic, with the company seeing adoption spread beyond metros into smaller cities and towns. Tier 2 and tier 3 markets are becoming increasingly significant as awareness of pet nutrition rises. Quick-commerce too, is emerging as an important channel for Mars to reach more pet parents.

The segment has also attracted new entrants including Godrej Consumer Products, Reliance Retail, Nestle and Wipro Consumer. However, Aagaard said Mars would not chase the lowest price points at the cost of product quality.

CleanMax Bets ₹50k cr on Andhra

Joins hands with Neysa for 2 GW AI compute facility; plans 6 GW wind, solar and storage project

Nidhi Sharma

Visakhapatnam: CleanMax, India's largest commercial and industrial renewable energy provider, will invest ₹50,000 crore in setting up an AI compute facility and a wind, solar and storage project in Andhra Pradesh.

CleanMax has joined hands with Neysa, a Blackstone portfolio company, to set up a 2 GW AI compute facility in Kurnool district with an investment of ₹8,000 crore. The project will come up on around 600 acres in the Orvakal Zone and bring together renewable energy generation and AI computing infrastructure. The Andhra Pradesh Economic Development Board (APEDB) and CleanMax signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) for the project at the CII Partnership Summit 2026 in Visakhapatnam on Thursday. CleanMax will also invest about ₹42,000 crore in another project involving 3 GW of wind energy, 2 GW of solar energy and 1 GW of pumped hydro storage.

Speaking to **ET**, CleanMax chairman and managing director Kuldeep Jain said, "The AI compute facility is a unique project as this will be the first time we are moving it from a big city to a remote location. Compute factories are power guzzlers. We have decided to move them closer to the power generation facilities."

The partnership was also confirmed at a meeting between representatives of CleanMax, Neysa and Blackstone and Andhra Pradesh IT and HRD minister Nara Lokesh on the sidelines of the summit. The delegation included CleanMax chairman and managing director Kuldeep Jain, chief commercial officer Tejus AV, Neysa founder and managing director Sharad Sanghi, and Blackstone managing director Nikhil Goyal.

The project is expected to generate around 1,000 direct and 1,000 indirect jobs, with commissioning targeted for March 2028. CleanMax will bring its renewable energy capabilities to the project, while Neysa will provide the AI computing infrastructure.

Chartistry

ECONOMY

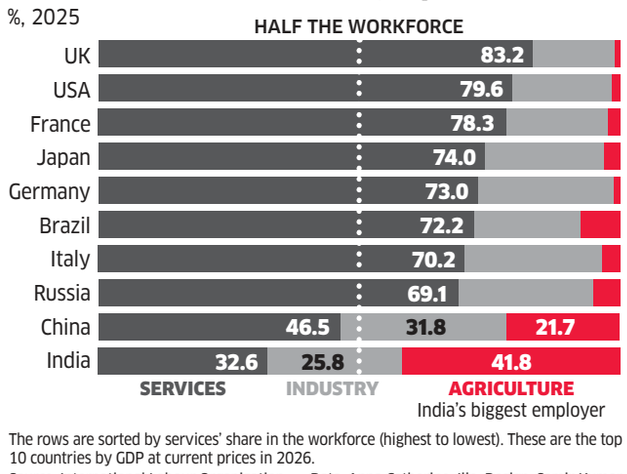
The Era of Services

THE HIGHLIGHT
The **workforce of the world's largest economies is largely in services**, India and China being the only ones where services workers aren't a majority.

POINT TO NOTE
But even in China, services is the largest employer (47%) by far; **India is the only one where farms still rule the labour market (42%).**

Sector-wise Workforce Share, Top 10 Economies

%, 2025



The rows are sorted by services' share in the workforce (highest to lowest). These are the top 10 countries by GDP at current prices in 2026.
Source: International Labour Organization Data: Anna Catherine Jijo; Design: Samir Kumar

Kia India Plans Second Manufacturing Plant in Andhra with $2B Investment

New facility to add 200,000 units of annual capacity, create 12,000 jobs

Our Bureau

New Delhi: South Korean auto major Kia India on Thursday said it will invest $2 billion, along with its supplier partners, to set up its second manufacturing facility in Andhra Pradesh.

India is Kia's fourth-largest market, accounting for 10% of its global sales.

The facility will have an installed capacity of 200,000 units per annum, taking Kia India's combined annual capacity across both plants to more than 600,000 units.

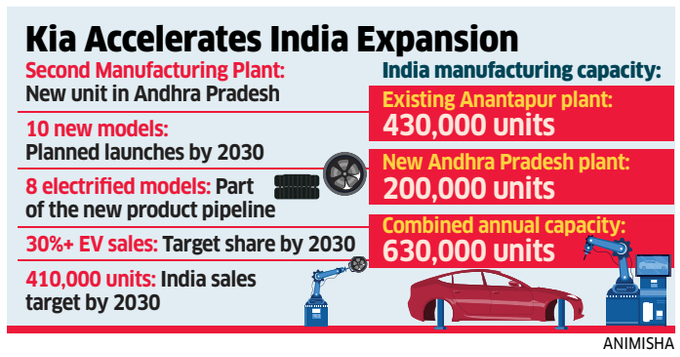
ET was the first to report on August 13, 2026, that the South Korean carmaker was planning to expand its manufacturing capacity in India to cater to expected growth in domestic sales and overseas demand.

The announcement follows the signing of a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Andhra Pradesh government. Emphasising that India is central to Kia's long-term growth ambitions, Gwanggu Lee, MD and CEO of Kia India, said, "Our second manufacturing plant marks a significant new chapter, strengthening our ability to respond to customer demand with greater speed and flexibility, while supporting the introduction of new models across ICE and EV powertrains."

Spread across a combined 465 acres for Kia and its suppliers, the proposed facility is expected to generate approximately 12,000 direct and indirect jobs.

Kia currently has the capacity to produce up to 430,000 vehicles annually at its manufacturing facility in Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh. To sustain its sales growth momentum, the company will introduce 10 new vehicles in India by the turn of the decade, eight of which will be electrified.

Overall, Kia is targeting sales of 410,000 vehicles in India by 2030. It expects EVs to account for more than 30% of its sales by the turn of the decade.



ANIMISHA

SLN Coffee to Invest ₹3,500 Cr in Andhra Food Processing Unit

Nidhi Sharma

Visakhapatnam: SLN Coffee Private Limited, the Coorg-based coffee maker behind the Levista brand, will invest ₹3,500 crore in a food processing unit in Andhra Pradesh. This will be the company's first manufacturing facility outside Karnataka.

The company signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) with the Andhra Pradesh government to invest ₹3,500 crore in the proposed unit, which is expected to create 3,400 jobs. The MoU was signed in the presence of state minister Nara Lokesh at the 31st CII Partnership Summit in Visakhapatnam on Thursday.

SLN is a family-owned business that has been growing coffee in Kodagu (Coorg) for decades. It operates plantations, exports green coffee and manufactures instant and roasted coffee at its facility in Kodagu, Karnataka.

Exceptional Items Widen Voda Idea Loss

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Telecom company Vodafone Idea (Vi) reported a consolidated net loss of ₹5,975 crore in the September quarter which widened from ₹5,524 crore a year earlier, dragged by exceptional charges related to reassessment of assets linked to UK's Vodafone Group entities.

The company recorded an exceptional loss of ₹462 crore from the remeasurement of settlement assets linked to shares earmarked by Vodafone Group entities. Barring exceptional items, the net loss stood at ₹5,513 crore, marginally lower than ₹5,562 crore a year earlier.

Vi said it had secured more than ₹10,500 crore in funding by the end of the first half, including warrant proceeds and funded and non-funded facilities. Of this, more than ₹4,000 crore in incremental bank funding was secured during the September quarter.

The company has placed capital expenditure orders worth more than ₹13,200 crore, of which nearly ₹6,000 crore has been executed, as part of its previously outlined ₹45,000-crore investment programme over three years, it said. "Encouraged by our progress in discussions to raise funding, we are confident to place additional orders and sustain the momentum in our network expansion," Abhijit Kishore, chief executive, Vi said in the earnings release.

6.2%
RISE IN REVENUE FROM OPS IN SEPTEMBER QUARTER

Vi had said in August that it had secured an initial ₹6,400 crore through warrant proceeds and financing facilities, and placed network equipment orders worth ₹9,000 crore.

In the September quarter, Vi's revenue from operations rose 6.2% year-on-year to ₹11,884 crore, supported by customer upgrades. Sequentially, revenue increased 1.7% while the net loss widened from ₹3,754 crore in the June quarter, which had benefited from an exceptional gain of ₹1,611 crore.

Vi added 1.3 million subscribers during the quarter, taking its overall base to 194.4 million from 193.1 million at June-end.

EIH Q2 Profit Up 21% at ₹141 crore

NEW DELHI: EIH, the flagship company of luxury hotel chain The Oberoi Group, on Thursday reported a 21.4% rise in consolidated net profit for the September quarter at ₹141.5 crore. The company had posted a net profit of ₹116.6 crore a year ago. EIH 's revenue from operations increased to ₹694.2 crore, from ₹597.9 crore a year ago, a regulatory filing showed. PTI

K'taka's Alcohol-Based Tax Weighs on Sales

Mumbai: Karnataka's move to tax alcoholic beverages based on their alcohol content has reduced per capita alcohol consumption by 2.4% in the first five months of implementation, even as state tax collections rose 13.4% in the April-September period, according to data cited by the Brewers Association of India.

Per capita consumption of pure alcohol in the state fell to 1.59 litres during May-September 2026, from 1.63 litres in the same period last year, even as total alcoholic beverage volumes increased.

"There are several global precedents for a rapid reduction in alcohol consumption after taxes are linked with alcohol content. Still, the speed at which it has fallen in Karnataka is impressive," said Vinod Giri, director general, Brewers Association of India.

The shift in consumption patterns follows Karnataka's introduction of an alcohol-content-based taxation system on May 11, under which the tax payable is linked to the quantity of alcohol in a beverage. According to BAI, the share of beer and wine in total alcoholic beverage sales increased to 45% from 36% over the period, as consumers moved towards lower-strength products.

Manufacturers of economy Indian-made foreign liquor (IMFL) have also reduced the alcoholic strength of some products. The average strength of IMFL fell from 42.8% to 40%, while its volume sales grew 1.1% during April-September, reversing a 1% decline in the year-ago period.

Sales of total alcoholic beverage cases in the state also grew 15.7% in the period, compared to an 8.4% decline in the same period last year. —**Aanya Thakur**

PE Firm Advent Shortlists Buyers to Sell Stake in 'Crax' Maker DFM

CRISP EXIT Partners, Chrys Cap & EQT in fray; deal expected to be valued at about ₹5K cr

Ratna Bhushan & Arijit Barman

New Delhi | Mumbai: Private equity firm Advent International, which owns DFM Foods, has shortlisted Partners Group, Chrys Capital and EQT Group for selling its 96.83% stake in the Crax snacks maker, people in direct knowledge of the development said.

IN CONTENTION

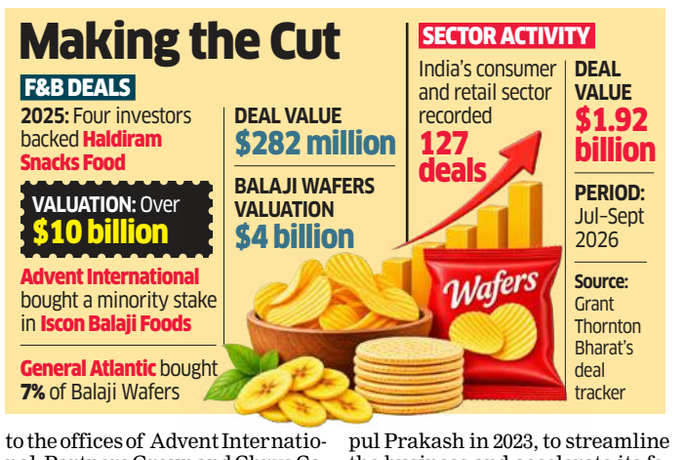
Staples and snacks maker ITC and financial services firm Goldman Sachs are also in contention for the stake acquisition, they said. The deal is expected at a valuation of ₹4,500-5,000 crore now, the executives said.

"The first stage of the deal process has been closed and advanced negotiations are underway," one of the executives said.

Rajkot-based ethnic snacks foods maker Balaji Wafers, till recently a top contender for DFM Foods, has exited, one of the people cited above said. "Other potential strategic buyers, including Britannia, Marico and Lotte, which had been tapped by Advent, too are not in the fray now, with many citing the steep valuation that has been quoted," the person said. Emails sent to the offices of Advent International, Partners Group and Chrys Capital remained unanswered till press time Thursday. Advent, which had acquired the stake in the Crax maker from WestBridge Capital in 2019 for $118.8 million, went on to delist the firm four years later, in January 2023.

DFM Foods reported net sales of ₹916 crore in FY26, compared to ₹705.8 crore in FY25, data by Tracxn showed, citing regulatory filings. The over four decades old DFM Foods had roped in former PepsiCo senior vice-president Vipul Prakash in 2023, to streamline the business and accelerate its foray to newer healthier options as well as step up presence on quick commerce platforms.

Prakash, chief executive and managing director at DFM Foods, had moved from travel platform MakeMyTrip. "The biggest deal play in the consumer space is now in foods and beverages. Apart from Coca-Cola and Haldiram's initial public offerings (IPOs) expected next year, the category is attracting large private equity interest, given the upside in the sector," said a senior executive at a large banking firm.



RECENT DEALS

Last year saw marquee investors Temasek, Alpha Wave Global, International Holding Company (IHC) and former Hindustan Unilever chief Sanjiv Mehta-led L Catterton India investing in Haldiram Snacks Food, valuing the latter at over $10 billion. Advent International acquired minority stake Iscon Balaji Foods which makes frozen foods, while General Atlantic had acquired 7% stake in Balaji Wafers for nearly ₹2,500 crore, valuing the latter at ₹35,000 crore.

India's consumer and retail sector saw 127 deals valued at $1.92 billion in the July-September 2026 quarter, according to Grant Thornton Bharat's Consumer and Retail deal tracker report last month. "India's consumption story continues to attract investor interest, but capital is increasingly directed towards businesses with differentiated brands, strong category positioning and the ability to scale profitably," Naveen Malpani, partner and consumer, retail & e-commerce industry leader, at the consulting and advisory firm said in the report.

Winter's Coming! Consumer Goods Makers Rush to Fill Shelves

Retail stocking of winter products up about 10% across sectors as demand recovery is expected to keep up momentum over three months

Writankar Mukherjee

Kolkata: Consumer goods makers are seeing a 7-10% year-on-year increase in retail and trade loading of winter-season products across personal care, healthcare supplements, apparel and electrical appliances by volume or units, raising expectations that the demand recovery seen over the past two quarters will gather further momentum over the next three months.

The healthy volume growth in primary sales (from companies to trade) of winter products comes as retailers build inventory in anticipation of a strong season, aided by an early onset of winter in North India, according to chief executives of companies with significant winter portfolios, including Emami, Dabur, Tata Consumer Products, Aditya Birla Lifestyle Brands and Lux Industries.

Dabur India chief executive Herjit Bhalla said the company's winter portfolio, led by Chyawanprash, has seen healthy trade loading. "So, we've gone in strong. Right now, we're feeling good about how the winter loading has happened," he said.

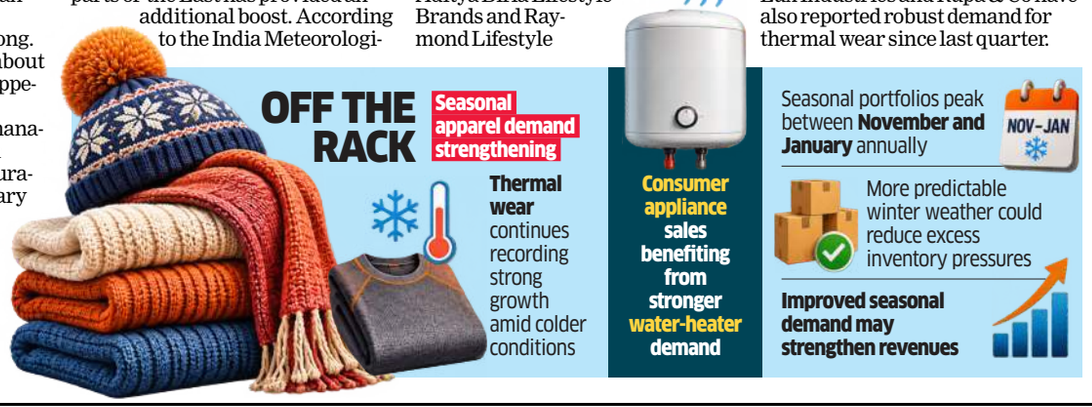
Emami vice-chairman and managing director Harsha Vardhan Agarwal said there were encouraging signs of a pickup in primary sales of winter products, including in markets that were relatively impacted by the weak monsoon last quarter. He said the company was not pushing inventory into the trade but relying on normal demand from retailers. The late festive season this year has shortened the window for winter stocking, as retailers typically begin building seasonal inventory after Diwali. The early onset of winter in North India and parts of the East has provided an additional boost. According to the India Meteorological Department's update on Thursday, snowfall is expected across the Western Himalayan region until Friday.

Senior executives of branded apparel makers such as Aditya Birla Lifestyle Brands and Raymond Lifestyle recently told analysts that suits and blazers are poised for strong sales and faster growth in the current quarter, both due to winter and wedding season.

Innerwear manufacturers such as Lux Industries and Rupa & Co have also reported robust demand for thermal wear since last quarter. Lux, for instance, reported 50% revenue growth in winter wear last quarter, while Rupa posted 30% growth in its thermal range. Rupa said it expects "good performance from the thermal this year".

For companies with seasonal winter portfolios, November-January is typically the peak business period. However, unseasonal weather and changing winter patterns in recent years have disrupted sales during this period, affecting December-quarter earnings and leaving companies saddled with excess inventory and working-capital pressures.

Companies are now expecting a reversal of that trend this year. Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals said its large domestic appliances business grew in double digits last quarter, led by water heaters.



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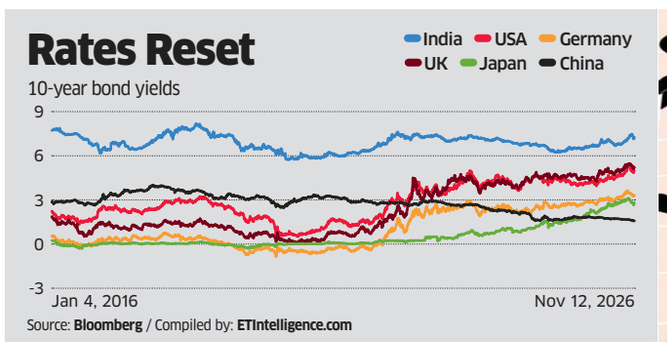
DISRUPTION: AI, STARTUPS & TECH

India Eyes Windfall as 'Blue Tsunami' Chills US Data Centre Push

US 10-year Treasury yield at its highest since 2002 | India yield hit a 4-yr high of 7.50% in Oct before easing | Rate outlook, tight policy fears weigh on bond mkts

Global Bond Yields on the Rise with Inflation, Govt Borrowing

Rozebud Gonsalves



Mumbai: A sell-off in sovereign debt pushed government bond yields across major economies to multiyear and, in some cases, multi-decade highs in the past month, as investors demanded higher returns to compensate for elevated government borrowing, sticky inflation and uncertainty over the interest-rate outlook.

The US 10-year Treasury yield was at its highest since 2002, while Japanese government bond yields touched levels last seen in 1996. The repricing reverberated across global fixed-income markets.

India has not been immune, with the benchmark 10-year bond yield climbing to a four-year high of 7.50% in October before easing, to close around 7.24% on Thursday.

Pressure on global bond markets has eased in recent weeks, with investors finding elevated yields attractive for fresh buying. Easing of the US-Iran war and the subsequent moderation in crude oil prices have also supported the recovery in government bonds by tempering inflation concerns.

However, the outlook for global bond markets remains uncertain. Persistent inflationary pressures and expectations of tighter monetary policy across major economies are likely to keep yields elevated. Meanwhile, concerns over rising government borrowing requirements and fiscal sustainability are expected to sustain higher term premiums, limiting the scope for a meaningful decline in long-term yields, according to a Morgan Stanley report last week.

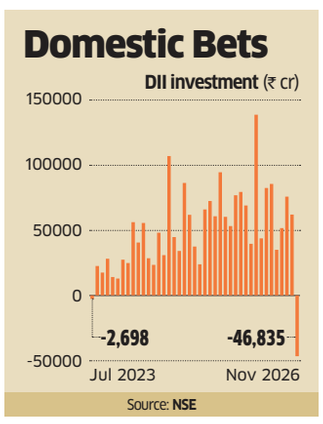
Indian yields too are expected to be volatile. "The 10-year G-Sec yield at around 7.55-7.60% offers an attractive entry point from a medium-term perspective. However, given the possibility of near-term swings in yields, accumulation should be staggered over the next three months rather than undertaken at a single point," according to Devang Shah, head of fixed income at Axis Mutual Fund.

The US 10-year Treasury yield touched 5.34% in October, its highest since 2002. The UK 10-year gilt yield rose to 5.378% on September 10, the highest since July 2007. It subsequently climbed to 5.52% on October 8. Germany's 10-year Bund yield touched 3.65% in early October, its highest since June 2009, while Japan's 10-year government bond yield hit 3.13% on October 1, a level last seen in 1996, according to Bloomberg.

PULL OUT OVER ₹47,662 CR IN THE PAST FORTNIGHT

DIIs Book Profits in Longest Selling Streak in 4 Years

Ravindra Sonavane



Mumbai: Their roles have decidedly reversed.

For years, domestic funds have provided the backstop against exiting foreigners, lifting the share of local stock ownership to a record and preventing a rout of Indian risk assets

Over the past fortnight, however, as foreign funds have come flooding in, domestic institutional investors (DII) have sought to book the profit of patience.

Mutual funds, banks, insurers and retirement funds have turned net sellers over the past nine sessions, marking their longest selling streak in four years.

Their exits coincide with the sharpest rally in Indian benchmark indices in years – and the meltdown of AI-themed trades in eastern Asia.

Data from the NSE showed that DIIs sold equities worth over ₹47,662 crore between October 30 and November 12, marking their longest selling streak since November 2022 when DIIs sold for 10 straight sessions.

DIIs sold equities worth over ₹47,662 cr between Oct 30 and Nov 12, marking their longest selling streak since Nov 2022

If the trend continues, November could become the first month of net selling by DIIs since July 2023, when they offloaded around ₹2,700 crore. It could also mark their steepest monthly selling since November 2020, when they sold equities worth around ₹48,000 crore.

Nilesh Shah, managing director, Kotak Mahindra AMC, said the bulk of the selling is likely coming from profit-booking and portfolio rebalancing by Multi-Asset Allocation Funds (MAFs), Balanced Advantage Funds (BAFs), insurance companies and pension funds. The market rally has pushed up their equity exposure, prompting them to book profits to maintain their targeted asset allocation. Arbitrage funds have also contributed to the selling, albeit to a smaller extent, by exploiting reverse arbitrage opportunities in mid-cap stocks, where futures are trading at a discount to the cash market, prompting funds to sell shares and buy futures, Shah added.

The DII selling comes even as foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) have returned to Indian equities. Since the beginning of November, the Sensex and Nifty have gained nearly 10% each, while the BSE MidCap150 and BSE SmallCap250 indices have advanced around 8% each. FPIs have invested around $8 billion in Indian equities since mid-October, amid a correction in AI-related stocks globally and a decline in crude oil prices.

Despite the recent selling, DIIs have remained a key source of support for the market through the year. Akshat Garg, AVP–Research & Product at Choice Wealth, said DIIs had been net buyers of over ₹6.5 lakh crore in 2026, supported by steady SIP and insurance inflows through market corrections. Following the sharp recovery, they are now trimming exposure to richly valued pockets, raising cash and allowing returning foreign investors to take on the role of marginal buyers.

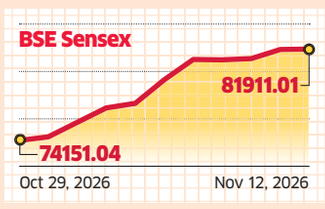
SOFTER OIL ALSO HELPS

Sensex, Nifty Mark 2-week Winning Run on FPI Inflows

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Indian equity benchmarks stretched their 2-week winning run to Thursday in a stunning reversal of roles that has seen overseas investors, hitherto net sellers, pump in more than ₹75,000 crore through November. Patient domestic investors booked profits, limiting the gains for headline indices.

The BSE Sensex climbed 31.61 points or 0.04% at 81,911.01, and the NSE's Nifty closed up 44.30 points or 0.18% at 25,299.35. Sensex fell 500 points from day's high while Nifty was trading below 25,250-mark.



Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) were net buyers of equities worth ₹7,830 crore on Thursday, taking their net investments in November so far to the tune of ₹75,565 crore. Domestic institutional investors (DIIs) sold shares worth ₹6,331 crore, taking their net sales in November to ₹46,835 crore.

Brent crude traded near $92 a barrel, retreating from recent highs, as expectations of a US-Iran de-escalation and improving regional energy flows eased concerns over supply disruptions.

Lower oil prices could offer relief to India's macroeconomic outlook and corporate cost structures, although the benefits will depend on the decline being sustained.

However, elevated US Treasury yields continued to pose a challenge to investor sentiment. The US 10-year Treasury yield hovered near 4.99%, keeping foreign investor flows in focus, as a sustained move above the 5% mark could make overseas investors more selective about their exposure to Indian equities.

PI INDUSTRIES OUT; MSCI EM STANDARD INDEX NOW AT 168 STOCKS

Four Local Stocks Join MSCI's India Party

Our Bureau

Mumbai: Index provider MSCI has added four local stocks — Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), Coforge, Adani Green Energy and Meesho — to its Emerging Markets Standard Index in the November 2026 review. PI Industries has been excluded.

The changes, announced on November 12, will take effect on November 30. According to Nuvama, Coforge's inclusion could attract passive inflows of around $630 million. LIC, Adani Green Energy and Meesho could see inflows of $468 million, $348 million and $307 million, respectively. PI Industries' exclusion could lead to outflows of about $119 million.

11.7%
INDIA'S NEW WEIGHT IN MSCI EM INDEX, UP FROM 11.5%

With four additions and one exclusion, the number of constituents in the MSCI Emerging Markets Standard Index will rise to 168 from 165. India's weight in the broader MSCI Emerging Markets Index is set to increase from 11.5% to 11.7%. The changes are broadly in line with Nuvama's expectations, except for ICICI Prudential Life Insurance, which avoided exclusion after its float factor was maintained.

Also 11 stocks will see their weights increase in the Standard Index. These include Billionbrains Garage Ventures, the parent of Groww; Lenskart Solutions; JSW Steel; Adani Energy Solutions; Coal India; One 97 Communications (Paytm); Bharat Forge; Oracle Financial Services Software; Zydus Lifesciences; Vedanta; and Bosch.

Nuvama estimates that the increase in weights could bring passive inflows ranging from $10 million to $97 million into these stocks.

Nine stocks will see their weights decline: NTPC, Eicher Motors, Grasim Industries, REC, Hindustan Aeronautics, Cipla, GAIL India, MRF and Siemens India. The changes could result in outflows ranging from $10 million to $97 million, according to Nuvama.

The MSCI Emerging Markets Small Cap Index will see 11 additions and 29 exclusions, taking the number of constituents down to 432 from 450. The stocks being added are PI Industries, Shadowfax Technologies, Apollo Micro Systems, HUDCO, Diamond Power Infrastructure, Aequs, Viyash Scientific, E2E Networks, SG Mart, Molbio Diagnostics and Axiscades Technologies.

Hawkins Cookers Ltd.

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EXTRACT OF THE FINANCIAL RESULTS IN Rs. CRORES	Quarter Ended		Half Year
	Sep.2026	Sep.2025	Sep.2026
1) Total Income from Operations	422.72	316.47	740.85
2) Net Profit for the period before Tax (before Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	54.23	42.97	95.11
3) Net Profit for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	54.23	42.97	95.11
4) Net Profit for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	41.50	31.95	71.88
5) Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit for the period after Tax and Other Comprehensive Income after Tax)	41.33	31.85	71.55
6) Paid up Equity Share Capital	5.29	5.29	5.29
7) Reserves, excluding Revaluation Reserves (as shown in the preceding/completed year-end Balance Sheet)	439.96	377.96	439.96
8) Earnings Per Share in Rs. (Per share of Rs. 10 each, Basic and Diluted)	78.48	60.43	135.94

NOTE: The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Financial Results filed with BSE Ltd. under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, as amended, for the Quarter/Half Year ended September 30, 2026. The full format of the said Quarterly/Half Yearly Financial Results is available on the BSE Ltd. website www.bseindia.com and the Company's website www.hawkinscookers.com /Q227 (QR code given alongside).

Mumbai
November 12, 2026

For Hawkins Cookers Limited
Sudeep Yadav, Vice-Chairman & Chief Financial Officer

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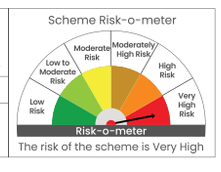
*Investors should consult their financial advisers if in doubt about whether the product is suitable for them.

Source: MOAMC Internal. *Data as on: 30-Oct-2026. The information provided is for informational purposes only and should not be construed as investment advice or a recommendation to buy, sell or hold any security. Past performance may or may not be sustained in the future and is not a guarantee of future returns. Investors should consult their financial advisors before making any investment decision.



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Enterprise Always Comes Before Family

As the Bharti Group marks 50 years, Sunil Mittal reflects on his entrepreneurial journey, charts the conglomerate's next growth phase and spells out succession priorities while urging the govt to go for bolder reforms

Sunil Mittal wants Bharti Group executives to keep taking risks and make bold bets. As the Bharti Group chairman marks 50 years of his entrepreneurial journey, Mittal, 69, tells **Kiran Rathee and Vinay Pandey** in an interview that his other two key focus areas are drawing up a succession plan and spending more time with the government and political leadership on public policy. **Edited excerpts:**

ET Q&A

SUNIL BHARTI MITTAL
CHAIRMAN, BHARTI ENTERPRISES

How would you describe this 50-year journey?

It's been a remarkable journey with the classic ups and downs. But I think the industry that I chose, eventually, from 1992 onwards, the mobile industry, it was quite a different one and a strange sort of story. It's not happened in many countries like this. The policy shifts, the regulatory curveballs, and the multiplicity of players that came through, its unheard of anywhere else—12-13 operators in a country is never seen. So, from that point of view, I would say it's a journey that mirrors India's growth if you look up from 1976 onwards. From a licence raj, where one struggled for permits and licences, import was almost impossible, foreign exchange was non-existent to where we are today, in some sense, I would say Bharti's journey has been in lock step with India's journey.

If India gets to ₹350 ARPU, my stated objective, we will still be lowest in the world. People who can pay a few hundred rupees as tip for opening the car door in a hotel, why can't they spend ₹600-700 a month on their phone?

What comes next? Bharti Airtel is a highly valued company with a solid brand.

Airtel has now come to a point where you can call it a very well-established enterprise or an institution, which is meritocracy-led with high-quality professionals driving it. Company's balance sheet is very strong now after becoming precarious in 2016-18, cash flow is strong, debt is almost non-existent. I think next year we'll have zero public debt and only DoT's spectrum payments and AGR liabilities will remain. The company now has to start to think about where to apply cash flow. So we have chosen some new events. Capex of ₹30,000 crore goes into our regular business like more towers, more fibre, more network, more IT. But in addition to that, financial services, sovereign cloud, and AI data centres—these are three big bets that Airtel is making for India. And some of these will be transported to Africa.

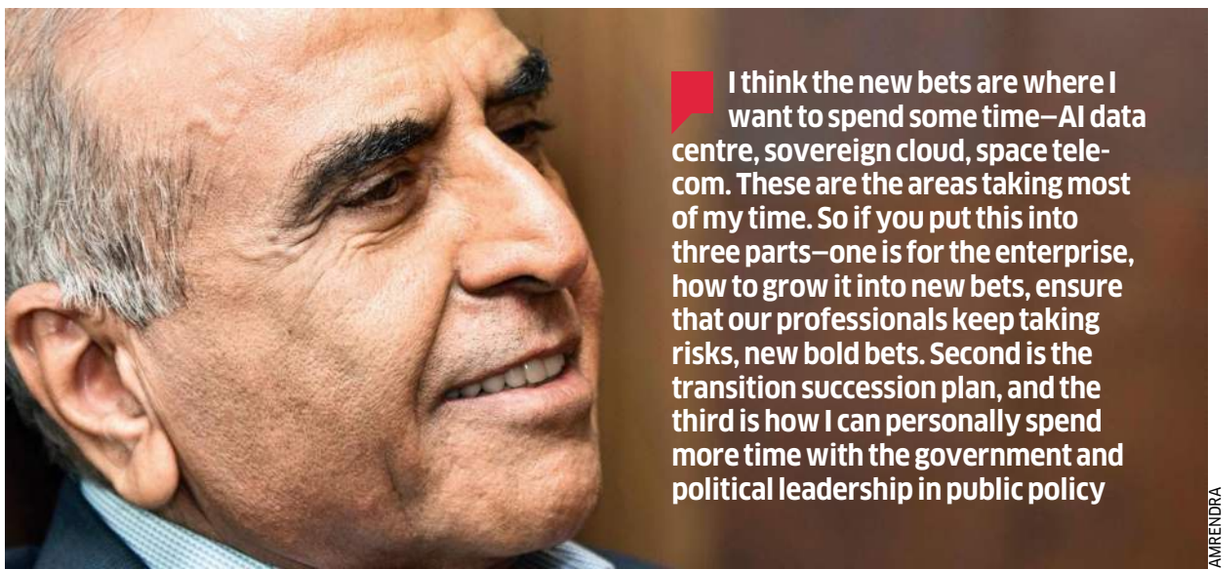
What about succession plans?

Until a few years back, that was not our priority as we were fighting difficult battles. The question is timely now and I am also working on this. There are two aspects to it. One is Airtel and its ecosystem. That part, I think, succession is already in place with very fine minds and talent who are there. Gopal (Vittal) is lifting himself to a group level, being the executive vice chair with Shashwat (Sharma) taking over in India and Sunil Taldar in Africa. Now the question, therefore, moves to what happens between the shareholder and the professional management. I can answer it at two levels. One is you look at companies like Unilever, where I have been on the board. There is no order. It's run by its people.

British Telecom until we arrived, there was no owner, it was a public company. I had been on the Standard Chartered board, again there was no owner. And then you have SoftBank, with Masayoshi Son as a big personality who drives everything. So, I've seen all the models. I think as far as Airtel is concerned, to a large extent, the Unilever model can prevail. So, if the family was not to be a shareholder, I think Airtel will be okay with a strong board and running itself. But I'm also conscious that such companies become very risk averse. New bets become very difficult. When things are okay, it works very well. But in a moment of huge crisis, a stewardship or anchor shareholders are required, especially for countries like India and the developing world. I think my next generation, my sons, my daughter, nephews, they all are coming up into good shape.

Has the thought crossed your mind that succession can be disruptive as stakeholders increase?

To my mind, it is a function of any founder that you must leave behind as much clarity as possible. So to your point, yes, it's been on my mind. We have created or laid early foundations of what I call House of Bharti. It's a charter that I have created for the next generation but they are co-creating it with me—how they will deal with issues when things come up, how will they decide if they have disagreements. Those things are now being worked upon but one thing I'm ensuring is in all situations, you bulletproof your enterprises. If there's a contest between the family and enterprise, enterprise wins every time, that's how I see it.



I think the new bets are where I want to spend some time—AI data centre, sovereign cloud, space telecom. These are the areas taking most of my time. So if you put this into three parts—one is for the enterprise, how to grow it into new bets, ensure that our professionals keep taking risks, new bold bets. Second is the transition succession plan, and the third is how I can personally spend more time with the government and political leadership in public policy

AMRENDRA

The unlimited offering at ₹399 makes no sense at all. Those people will pay a thousand rupees. And then you can actually keep subsidies down for the lower end. By bringing the whole table down, you put some load on the lower end

What about you personally? What is it that you want to do now?

I think I'd like to see Airtel get to be the first company worldwide with a billion customers. We are 600 million, so we have to get another 400 million. I think India will give us another 200 million, Africa will give us another 100-150 million. So we are still short of 100-150 or 200 million customers. My desire will be to look into markets which have higher ARPUs, higher margins and therefore, we keep spotting opportunities. I think the new bets are where I want to spend some time—AI data centre, sovereign cloud, space telecom, how the space will shape up. These are the areas which are taking most of my time. So if you put this into three parts—one is for the enterprise, how to grow it into new bets, ensure that our professionals keep taking risks, new bold bets. Second is the transition succession plan and the third is how I can personally spend more time with the government and political leadership in public policy.

If I have to give one message to the government: Keep working on your mantra of ease of doing business—more needs to be done. Sometimes I feel that our political leadership has a bigger ambition, which gets diluted as it starts to get implemented, because every reform that comes has one or two things around it, which lowers the impact of reform

Can the tariffs stay low going forward or there should be hikes?

I would say if you need the nation to have a robust digital spine, you need it to be very healthy. You don't want a situation where you're struggling. And I can tell you today, some of the European markets are struggling. They are behind in the digital journey despite being very rich economies. The US is not, China is not, India is not. And paradoxically, the US is $50-60 ARPU, we have only $3 or less here and we were still able to build it. It's very important that the companies remain very healthy. While people look at the ebitda margins, it's a wrong metric for telecom companies because a large part of our ebitda that comes through, we spend every year on new capex. There are spectrum auctions that take tens of thousands of crores. It's a very capital-intensive industry. I would say we should build 4x or 5x of what we are today. We should build a million base stations, we are merely 350,000. It's a long journey, we must have space connectivity, we must have submarine cable, so that in tomorrow's new world, where technology is most important, our fundamental connectivity bedrock is very strong. To that extent, do you need another dollar, dollar and a half—yes.

If India gets to ₹350 ARPU, my stated objective, we will still be lowest in the world. People who can pay a few hundred rupees as tip for opening the car door in a hotel, why can't they spend ₹600-700 a month on their phone? It is not a problem for them, but we have artificially kept it so low.

So there is room for differential pricing?

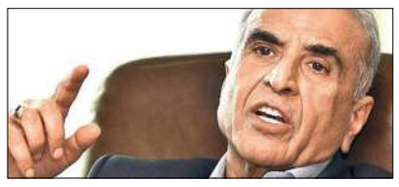
Absolutely there is. The unlimited offering at ₹399 makes no sense at all. Those people will pay a thousand rupees, they'll be comfortable paying a thousand rupees. And then you can actually keep subsidies down for the lower end. By bringing the whole table down, you put some load on the lower end.

What is stopping companies from offering such tariffs?

It's the competition. We have tried to move it, but when the competition doesn't move, you're in the market, you have to be competitive. We already have a 15-20% premium in tariffs. But that's the limit.

There is a lot of noise around the current business environment in India, the rupee, capital outflows. How do you see the situation and what kind of reforms would you expect going ahead?

I take you back to 1992, when the first wave of reforms happened and that to my mind, should give us a lot of comfort that reforms finally work. I would say we have seen this government very focussed on reforms, and they have done many reforms. And in my own industry, the digital pillar of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, from day one, became a very important gain for my industry. So if I have to give one message back to the government: Keep on working on your mantra of ease of doing business—more needs to be done. Sometimes I feel that our political leadership has a bigger ambition, which gets diluted as it starts to get implemented, because every reform that comes has one or two things around it, which lowers the impact of reform.



How do you see satcom and are you open to increasing stakes in OneWeb?

OneWeb is a European answer to the need for space telecom. So Eutelsat OneWeb will be a European constellation. And I don't think you can change the character of it. We are at 18% stake after the merger and after the French government increased stake to 30%. Possibly we can go for 30%.

India now has two $100 billion telcos and financial stress in the sector. Does it open doors for a new entrant like Starlink, which may have ambitions to become a full-fledged telecom player?

Satcom connectivity is definitely coming, but I strongly believe it's a complementary service and not a supplementary service. It cannot supplement terrestrial networks by its very nature of design. I must compliment Elon Musk that he is pushing the boundaries. The amount of capacity being created was earlier thought to be impossible. So you have to give him the credit but at the same time, the cost for a bit, cost for a GB, is never going to be at a point where he can contest fibre or terrestrial radio connectivity. The US, some markets in Europe, Japan, maybe there is a market to be picked up by satellite because when you have $50-60 ARPU, then there's a game to be played there. You can connect a home and get $50, you can be fine. You can get a mobile customer at $50, you can play the part. But if you see Elon Musk is picking up local spectrum, is building local networks on the ground and then will combine both. So in the end, even he's saying the same thing that we are saying, you can only be complementary. My own view is you will see them combining with local terrestrial operators in India and try their luck in the US.

Amid the discussions over currency, there's been talk that we need to look at outbound investment. What are your thoughts on that?

This is an interesting question. I would never compromise what is needed to invest in India at the cost of going out. But when you have exhausted your opportunities here, India is beckoning a handful of companies to go out. It builds our soft power, it builds our diplomatic relationships. It builds our presence in those countries, even politically.

Jio has listed and India already has a kind of duopoly. How do you see the domestic market?

It is good the listing has happened, which is an important event for a large company like Jio. We have four companies, out of which two are fully and partly owned by the government. There is some cooperation between Vodafone Idea and BSNL. So I would say in that sense, there are three companies—it's a perfect size, perfect market dynamics.

AI Can Boost Productivity, But Poses Risks to India's IT Sector: Moody's

Our Bureau

New Delhi: Moody's Ratings said on Thursday that artificial intelligence (AI) could boost productivity but also create displacement risks in emerging markets (EMs) with significant exposure to software, IT and business-process outsourcing. However, there is no clear evidence of either trend yet, even in potentially highly exposed markets such as India and the Philippines. In its Global Emerging Markets Outlook 2027 report, Moody's said interest expenses will contribute more than deficits to rising debt in India and China. It expects both countries to increase their public indebtedness through a combination of primary deficits and higher interest payments.

India, Russia and China, which are leading emerging market producers of metals essential for infrastructure such as data centres and power grids, including copper, bauxite, aluminium, zinc and tin, stand to benefit the most from rising demand. According to the ratings agency, inadequate access to computing capacity, digital infrastructure and skills could increasingly determine the ability of most emerging markets to capture AI-related gains.

Moody's said interest expenses will contribute more than deficits to rising debt in India and China

"For EMs with significant levels of software or IT and business-process outsourcing exposures, AI could both raise productivity and create displacement risks. But even for India and the Philippines — the potentially most-exposed EM countries — there is no current clear illustration of either trend," Moody's said.

Moody's expects GDP growth in the largest emerging markets in 2027 to remain broadly similar to 2026 levels, with some potential upside depending on an easing of the Middle East conflict. It has raised its projection for India's GDP growth in FY27 to 7% from 6.5% earlier. Moody's Ratings has forecast India's real GDP growth at 7% in both 2026 and 2027, with inflation projected at 4.5% in 2026 and 4.3% in 2027. The agency said continued commodity demand will remain a key growth driver for some metal and energy producers, although overall growth will be slow and vary considerably across countries. Resilient consumer spending, where supported by favourable policies, and foreign direct investment (FDI), where significant, will also support growth in several emerging markets.

Banks Push for Fraud Reporting Framework

Lenders seek clarity on customer eligibility, reporting timelines ahead of RBI's Jan 2027 compensation policy

Dheeraj Tiwari

New Delhi: Banks have flagged the need for setting up a centralised mechanism for fraud reporting and claim settlement ahead of the RBI's compensation policy for victims of small-value fraudulent electronic transactions, which will provide eligible victims compensation of up to ₹25,000 from January 2027.

They have approached the banking regulator seeking clarity on customer eligibility, reporting timelines, beneficiary-bank liability and recoveries, said people familiar with the developments.

"There is a view that on an individual bank-level there can be implementation challenges, therefore there is a need for a standardised industry-level framework," said a bank executive aware of the developments. "We have held internal discussions with banks, and some of these suggestions have been shared with RBI."

Another bank executive said that while banks support a compensation mechanism, its implementation may require greater co-ordination among lenders, the regulator and investigating agencies. "Already, there have been ongoing discussions on mule accounts. So, we need to set up a mechanism to ensure that all stakeholders are aligned in cases involving such fraudulent transactions before any compensation is paid to the customer."

In March, RBI issued instructions titled 'Limiting Liability of Customers in Unauthorised Electronic Banking Transactions'. Under the instructions, an individual acting in good faith who has lodged a complaint involving a gross loss of up to ₹50,000 due to fraudulent electronic banking transactions will be eligible for compensation of 85% of the net loss or ₹25,000, whichever is lower. The compensation will be available only once during the individual's lifetime.

The compensation amount will be calculated after reducing recoveries made, whether before or after paying the compensation, from the gross loss amount. As per the mechanism, where a compensation of 85% is paid, 65% will be borne by RBI, 10% by the customer's bank and the remaining 10% by the beneficiary bank in case of a complaint arising out of domestic fraudulent electronic banking transactions (EBTs). For cross-border fraudulent EBTs, RBI will bear 65% and the customer's bank the remaining 20%.

In April, RBI released a discussion paper titled 'Exploring Safeguards in Digital Payments to Curb Frauds'. It outlined four options: lagged credit for authorised push payments other than low value, additional authentication by trusted person for high-value digital transactions by vulnerable sections of society, only accounts with satisfactory additional review to receive large credits and customer-induced controls.

Safety Net

Banks pitch for a standardised industry-level framework

Highlight more coordination between all stakeholders, including investigating agencies

RBI Compensation policy for EBT... | For small-value fraudulent EBTs up to ₹50,000 | Compensation: 85% of net loss or ₹25,000, whichever is lower | Payable only once in the victim's lifetime

Year	No. of frauds	Value (₹ cr)
2021	260,000	551
2022	690,000	2,290
2023	1.31 mn	7,465
2024	2.4 mn	22,848
2025	2.8 mn	22,931

Source: National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (NCRP)

Road Ministry Raises Performance Security for Bridge Sensors to 10%

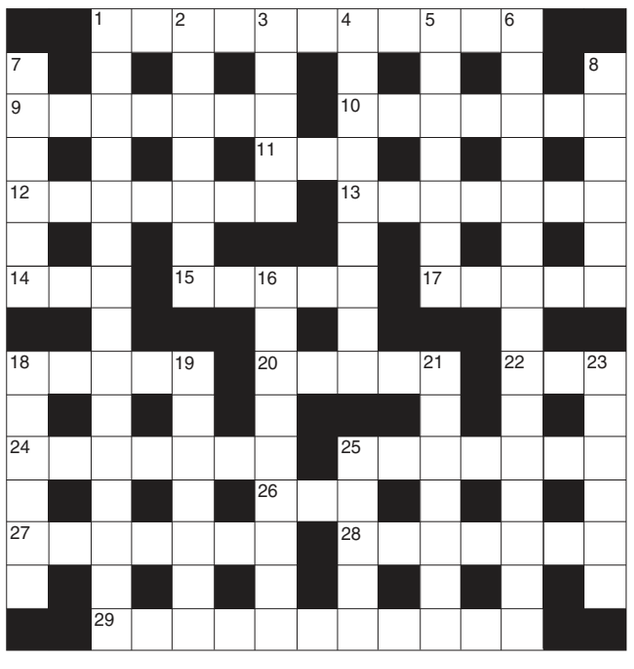
NEW DELHI: The road transport and highways ministry has raised the performance security to 10% from 5% of the contract value for concessionaires bidding for the supply, installation, commissioning, and operation and maintenance of sensors for the continuous real-time health monitoring of bridges on national highways and centrally sponsored road works. This is expected to ensure that high safety standards are in place and that there are no further incidents of bridge collapse. The amendments have been introduced in the standard request for proposal documents. – **Our Bureau**

Cab Rules Eased, Fleet can Have 5 Cars Instead of 50

NEW DELHI: The road transport and highways ministry proposed a relaxation of rules for setting up car hire businesses, including a reduction in the minimum fleet requirement to five vehicles from 50. It said the new rules would apply to self-drive cars and vehicles hired with a driver. The government believes lowering the threshold will encourage small entrepreneurs, startups and local operators to enter the market. Existing operators will be able to expand into new locations using a fleet of five cars.
– **Our Bureau**

NON-SEQUITUR

Crossword 9755



ACROSS
1 Activists excitedly scampering around area (11)
9 Arranged, like those in a queue? (5,2)
10 Devise single hour for language (7)
11 Merriment with no end of laughing in shelter (3)
12 Team wanting second colleague in a perfect world (7)
13 Number two points with child, describing some road surfaces? (7)
14 Set side in cricket making comeback (3)
15 Top equipment falling short in Italian island (5)
17 Unusually nosy director in church council (5)
18 Expat naturally accommodated in Indian city (5)
20 Chap managed to tour old hotel (5)
22 Local university found in lead (3)
24 Conduct to please number one? (3,4)
25 Joke entering winter sports event in some cases? (7)
26 Regularly choose garden tool (3)
27 Daughter provided with fine treatment that is spread out (7)
28 Outstanding pair of tenors with education performed as a couple (7)
29 Older parent, perhaps, seen pretty carelessly carrying money (5-6)

DOWN
1 Charge given late withdrawal? (12,3)
2 Note centre supported by clubs (6,1)
3 Lay on petition (5)
4 Immature comedian snubbed companion in London borough (9)
5 Echo no good in essentially best sources of power (7)
6 Largest nitpicks about medical cover? (8,7)
7 Hurried activity in a helicopter? (6)
8 A day in outhouse, free of sunlight (6)
16 I pry here possibly after parking in border (9)
18 Requests extra note about principal actor (6)
19 Thing to promote inflation? (3,4)
21 Ignore, say, volatile Celt after November (7)
23 Joins line in turns in the road (6)
25 Start to like advantage in shelf (5)

SOLUTION TO No. 9754:
ACROSS: **1** Divorces. **5** Gaucho. **9** Fluoride. **10** Braise. **12** Moth. **13** Conversant. **15** Starting block. **19** Housing estate. **23** My Fair Lady. **25** Emus. **28** Evince. **29** Mediocre. **30** Sugary. **31** Eschewal.
DOWN: **1** Defame. **2** Vault. **3** Rare. **4** Endmost. **6** Airer. **7** China rose. **8** Overtake. **11** Ivan. **14** Wadi. **15** Shuffling. **16** Ire. **17** Brag. **18** Whimpers. **20** Gale. **21** Sadness. **22** As well. **24** Incur. **26** Macaw. **27** Sikh.

©The Daily Mail

HIDATO

FIND THE PATH - SOLVE THE PUZZLE

Complete the grid so that numbers 1 - 44 connect horizontally, vertically or diagonally:

www.hidato.com Dif ★★☆☆☆

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Yesterday's puzzle solution.

Hidato Sol. 3/2

2	4	14	15	16	17
1	3	5	13	11	18
36	6	9	10	12	19
35	7	8	28	22	20
34	30	29	23	27	21
33	32	31	24	25	26

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7 LITTLE WORDS

Find the 7 words to match the 7 clues. The numbers in parentheses represent the number of letters in each solution. Each letter combination can be used only once, but all letter combinations will be necessary to complete the puzzle.

CLUES
1 enticed (9)
2 avoiding responsibilities (8)
3 makers of women's hats (9)
4 slept in a state park, say (6)
5 gets down like a catcher (6)
6 more luxurious (8)
7 deterrent on some fences (8)

SOLUTIONS

ED	MIL	TED	ATT	RK
RAC	CA	BAR	LIN	SQU
ING	ATS	MP	SHI	ANK
SW	RE	IER	BWI	ERS

Yesterday's Answers: 1. FINN 2. SIXTEENTH 3. EILISH 4. ESPECIALLY 5. BUCKS 6. GABRIELLE 7. SLAKES 12/25

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Tata Sons-TVS Transactions

▸▸ From Page 1

"The recording is not required to be either retained or shared with anybody, including the directors," the letter said.

As for the minutes of the September 17 meeting, Tata Sons said the draft had been uploaded on the board app on October 1 and that it had received Noel Tata's comments on this on October 8. Following a review of his suggestions, the required changes, wherever appropriate, had been incorporated. "A copy of the minutes will be uploaded on the board app," the company said.

The holding company also defended its established procedure for documenting board deliberations, saying draft minutes are circulated to directors for comments within 15 days of a meeting. After receiving and considering their comments, these are entered in the minutes book and subsequently placed before the next board meeting for confirmation.

Directors would then be able to raise any further issues they may have with the minutes, the company said, adding, "There is no reason to assume that the directors as a body would have any differences over what was discussed in the meeting." The letter was signed by company secretary Suprakash Mukhopadhyay.

The exchange comes amid growing differences between Noel Tata and Tata Sons over governance, leadership succession and the extent of information and documentation sought by the Trusts chairman in his capacity as a director.

The September 17 board meeting had seen Chandrasekaran reappointed for another five-year term, with Noel Tata the sole director to oppose the decision. The company said the reappointment was taken up as a board agenda item, that all directors took part in the discussion, and that the resolution was carried by a majority. On the procedural objection, it said Article 118 of the Articles of Association, which provides for a "selection committee" is "not applicable for confirming the reappointment of the incumbent chairman," a point Tata Sons said had already been made in an earlier letter dated September 24, 2026.

On filings, Tata Sons said the certified copy of the resolution was issued in line with the board's authority and applicable law. Under Section 117 of the Companies Act, 2013, such resolutions must be filed with the Registrar of Companies within 30 days, and the company said it "has acted in compliance with its statutory filing obligations."

Tata Sons also pushed back against conflict-of-interest questions over the reappointment of its executive chairman, stating that "there have been no transactions between Tata Sons and TVS Motor Co." and "does not set out any basis" to show a significant relationship between the Tata Group and the two-wheeler maker. This refers to reported conflict-of-interest allegations over a business relationship between TVS Motor Co. and a company in which Chandrasekaran's wife and son hold stakes, Hanno One Warehousing Pvt Ltd.

TVS Motor Co. chairman emeritus Venu Srinivasan was one of the board members who voted in favour of Chandrasekaran's reappointment at the September 17 meeting.

Regarding Hanno One Warehousing, disclosures about the firm had been made on April 10, 2025, to all companies where Chandrasekaran is chairman. Tata Sons said in the letter that "there are no transactions of Hanno with Tata Sons and/or any other Tata Group entities." It added that a contract awarded by TVS Motor, a listed entity, to another company in which Chandrasekaran's family has a disclosed interest does not conflict with Tata Sons' business.

Oil Cos Dealing with Hormuz Disruptions

▸▸ From Page 1

The government is offering a grant of up to Rs 5,142 crore, and will award the contract to the bidder seeking the lowest grant, according to tender documents.

The Centre is also looking to lease out about half, or 524,000 tonnes, of the storage capacity at its operational strategic reserve facility in Visakhapatnam for three years, with an option to extend the lease by another four years.

Both developments come as oil producers in West Asia explore ways to store crude outside the region to circumvent the transit bottleneck caused by the war in Iran and the prolonged disruption of energy supplies through the Strait of Hormuz. Last month, Saudi Arabia announced it would begin storing oil in Singapore's rock caverns next year. It already maintains crude storage facilities in Japan and South Korea.

The UAE, which stores some crude in India's strategic reserves, announced plans in June to store larger volumes in the country.

State-run Indian Strategic Petroleum Reserves Ltd, which operates the country's strategic reserves, has floated separate tenders for the Odisha project and the partial leasing of the Visakhapatnam facility. Bids for the new facility must be submitted by February 26, 2027, while the deadline for the storage lease is December 1, 2026.

India is accelerating efforts to expand its strategic oil storage after the Hormuz disruption exposed its vulnerability to supply shocks.

The strait's sudden closure cut off around 40% of its crude supplies, forcing refiners to scramble for alternative cargoes from across the world, often at higher costs.

The government also directed Oil and Natural Gas Corp to build 1.75 million tonnes of strategic storage capacity in Mangaluru. The state-run producer approved the plan in July.

The Odisha project at Chandikhol has been in the pipeline since 2018, when the Cabinet approved two additional strategic reserves: the 4-million-tonne facility in Odisha and a 2.5-million-tonne project at Padur in Karnataka. Both were planned under a public-private partnership model to limit the government's financial burden.

They formed the second phase of India's SPR programme, following the construction of three facilities with a combined capacity of 5.03 million tonnes at Visakhapatnam, Mangaluru and Padur. Commissioned over the past decade, these three facilities cost ₹4,098 crore to build.

Megha Engineering & Infrastructures Ltd last year won the contract to build the 2.5-million-tonne Padur facility in the second phase.

The Odisha project was delayed partly by land acquisition. The process of acquiring around 400 acres at Chandikhol is now at an advanced stage, according to the tender documents.

The government took several years to settle on a commercial model to attract private investors.

It provides a grant of up to 60% of the project cost, while the successful bidder gets to build the commercial cum strategic petroleum reserves under the design, build, finance, operate and transfer model.

Rate Hike Expectations in Dec

▸▸ From Page 1

This has intensified inflationary concerns and raised expectations of a 25-basis-point repo rate hike at the December monetary policy meeting. A basis point is a hundredth of a percentage point. Inflation remained above RBI's medium-term target of 4% for the fifth consecutive month.

The RBI has a tolerance band of 2 percentage points on either side of the 4% level. Retail price growth last exceeded the 6% limit in October 2024, hitting 6.2% under the old CPI series, which used 2012 as its base year. "The rise in inflation beyond 6% confirms the possibility of a rate increase by the RBI in December by 25 basis points," said Sakshi Gupta, principal economist at HDFC Bank.

Last month, the central bank's Monetary Policy Committee raised its policy rate by 25 basis points to 5.5%, marking the first tightening in nearly four years. Food inflation accelerated to 8.9% year-on-year in October, up from 7.7% in September, with rural prices increasing 9.1% compared with 8.7% in urban areas.

"Food inflation under pressure from a deficient monsoon and rising global food prices, an Indian crude basket averaging $120 per barrel in October and sustained producer pricing power converged to drive a broad-based rise in consumer prices," said Dipti Deshpande, principal economist at Crisil.

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by

Narendra Modi

Prime Minister

In the August Presence of

Dr. Sudha Yadav, Governor, Karnataka | D. K. Shivakumar, Chief Minister, Karnataka | Pramod Sawant, Chief Minister, Goa | Manohar Lal Khatter, Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs and Minister of Power | Ashwini Vaishnaw, Union Minister of Railways, Information & Broadcasting and Electronics & Information Technology | Hardeep Singh Puri, Union Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas

V. Somanna, Union Minister of State of Railways and Jal Shakti | Sushri Shobha Kanrandlaje, Union Minister of State of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises & Labour and Employment | M.B Patil, Minister, Govt of Karnataka | Krishna Byre Gowda, Minister, Govt of Karnataka | Vijayanand Shivashankrappa Kashappanavar, Minister, Govt of Karnataka

P.C Mohan, Member of Parliament | Tejasvi Surya, Member of Parliament | Kota Srinivas Poojary, Member of Parliament | Capt. Brijesh Chowta, Member of Parliament | Sunil Bose, Member of Parliament | Shreyas M Patel, Member of Parliament

Jairam Ramesh, Member of Parliament | Dr. D. Veerendra Heggade, Member of Parliament | Lehar Singh Siroya, Member of Parliament | Jaggesh, Member of Parliament

Friday, 13 November 2026 | Bengaluru | 01:00 PM

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pstcl PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

CORPORATE IDENTITY NO.: U40109PB2010SGC033814 www.pstcl.org

O/o:Dy. CE/Projects, Tele: 96461-04141, E-mail :se-projects@pstcl.org

Notice Inviting E-Tender

Enquiry No.	STQ-3080
Description	Construction of 220 KV Substation at Shri Hargobindpur (to be upgraded from 132kv)
Starting date of downloading/ Publishing date	17.11.2026
Last date of downloading	15.12.2026 upto 11:00 A.M.
Pre-Bid Meeting Date	01.12.2026 at 11:00 A.M.
Last Date & Time for receipt of tender	15.12.2026 upto 11:00 A.M.
Date & Time for Opening of tender	17.12.2026 at 03:00 P.M.

Detailed NIT/specification may be downloaded from PSTCL e-tendering website **www.eproc.punjab.gov.in.** Corrigendum, if any, will not be published in newspaper. As such the website may be visited regularly for updates.

DPR/Pb.:1078/12/2026-27/17006

Dy. CE/Projects, PSTCL, Patiala.

pstcl PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED

CORPORATE IDENTITY NUMBER: U40109PB2010SGC033814 www.pstcl.org

Office of CE / P&M, PSTCL, Ludhiana-141001,

Tel No.0161-2456704 & Mob-9646118208 email: srxen-proc-ldh@pstcl.org

Sr.No.	Description of tender
1.	Tender Reference No. 186 /2026-27 (Open Tender) The department of Punjab State Transmission Corporation Limited invites online bids for **"For Design, Manufacture, Testing, Supply and Delivery of Earthing Sticks Sets Complete with accessories suitable for use at 400 kV/220kV/132 kV Sub-Stations/ Transmission Lines of PSTCL"** Closing date and Time: 15.12.2026 11:00 AM Opening date and Time: 17.12.2026 11:00 AM

Note: It is informed that in case tender process is not completed due to any reason, no corrigendum will be published in newspapers. Details regarding corrigendum may be seen on official PSTCL website www.pstcl.org. Terms and conditions may be downloaded from PSTCL's web site https://eproc.punjab.gov.in

DPR/Pb.:1078/12/2026-27/17003

Sr. Xen. / W&A, O/o CE/P&M PSTCL, Ludhiana.

झारखण्ड राज्य सहकारी लाह क्रय-विक्रय एवं आहरण संघ लिमिटेड

The Jharkhand State Co-operative Lac Marketing & Procurement Federation Ltd.

(Manufacturere of SEEDLAC, SHELLAC, ALURITIC ACID, BUTTON LAC, SEALING WAX AND OTHER LAC PRODUCTS)

Website- www.jascolampf.com Phone/Fax-91-651-3511741 E-mail-mdjascolampf@gmail.com

FACTORY CUM ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE : SIDROL, NAMKUM, RANCHI, JHARKHAND, PIN-834010

Ref. No. 557 — e-Tender Notice — Dated: 12.11.2026

JASCOLAMPF invites e-tender in two Parts (i) Technical bids (ii) Financial bids) from eligible bidders for supply, installation, testing & commissioning and on-site support for the equipment/goods listed below for establishment of production house for Lac based products on Turnkey basis at Jharkhand State Co-operative Lac Marketing & Procurement Federation Ltd. (JASCOLAMPF) Sidroll, Namkum, Ranchi.

Sl. No.	Name of the Equipment/Goods	Quantity
A. Alta Making Unit		
1	Blending kettle/Mixing vessel	01Nos.
2	Reflux cum distillation unit	01Nos.
3	Distillation Unit	01Nos.
4	Bottle filling, capping & labelling machine	01Nos.
B. Nail Polish Making Unit		
1	Blending kettle/Mixing vessel	01Nos.
2	Pulveriser/grinder	01Nos.
3	Bottle filling & capping machine	01Nos.
C. Varnish Making Unit		
1	Blending kettle/Mixing vessel	02Nos.
2	Pulveriser/grinder	01Nos.
3	Bottle filling, capping & labelling machine	01Nos.
D. Lac Dye Making Unit		
1	Lac dye Plant (Capacity: 2 kg/batch/day) (As per item mentioned in 1-20 in detail specification)	01 Unit
E. Integrated Lac Processing Unit		
1	Integrated primary lac processing machine	01Nos.
2	Centrifuge	01Nos.
3	Lac winnower	01Nos.
4	Lac grader	01Nos.

Tender form can also be downloaded from **www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in.** Interested eligible Bidders may download the bid documents along with terms & conditions from the website www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in & www.jascolampf.com and can submit only through website www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Sd/- Managing Director

JASCOLAMPF, Sidroll, Namkum, Ranchi

KMF Karnataka Co-Operative Milk Producers' Federation Limited

KMF Complex, Dr. M.H.Marigowda Road, Bangalore-29.

Tel: 080-26096839/ 26096855, Email: purchase@kmf.coop

IFT No-KMF/PUR/CFRM-706/2026-27 — Dated:12-11-2026

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION (KPPP Tender No.KMF/2026-27/IND2707)

The Karnataka Milk Federation, invites Tenders from eligible Tenderers for supply of following Raw Materials as stipulated below. Tender documents along with EMD details may be downloaded from Karnataka public procurement portal https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in Interested tenderers participate in the tender by logging on the website www.kppp.karnataka.gov.in and also may contact KPPP Help line No:080-46010000/080-68948777. any corrections related to the tender will be published on the KPP portal itself.

Sl. No.	Raw Materials	Cattle Feed Plantwise Requirement in MTs				
		Rajanukunte	Gubbi	Dharwad	Hassan	Shikaripura
1	Di Calcium Phosphate	400	400	150	500	200

Tender Schedule: Date of Commencement of Tender: 13-11-2026; Pre Bid Meeting: 16-11-2026 at 11.30 A.M. Last date for submission of Tender: 20-11-2026 at 03.15 P.M. Date of opening Technical Tender: 21-11-2026 at 03.30 P.M. Date of opening Commercial Tender: 23-11-2026 at 10.30 AM.

For KARNATAKA MILK FEDERATION LTD,

Sd/- DIRECTOR (PURCHASE)

ದೊಡ್ಡಬಳ್ಳಾಪುರ ಯೋಜನಾ ಪ್ರಾಧಿಕಾರ

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ದೂ.ಸಂ:080–2956 2046 e-mail:dpa.dbpura2018@gmail.com

ಅಲ್ಪಾವಧಿ ಇ–ಟೆಂಡರ್ ಪ್ರಕಟಣೆ

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THE ECONOMIC TIMES
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ADVERTORIAL &
PROMOTIONAL FEATURE

Show stopper
Dua Lipa, Tame Impala and Madonna are among the acts who will perform at the Coachella festival in April 2027

Trump's arch casts a shadow over JFK

US President's dream project runs into further trouble, as Kennedy descendents move court

Dan Diamond

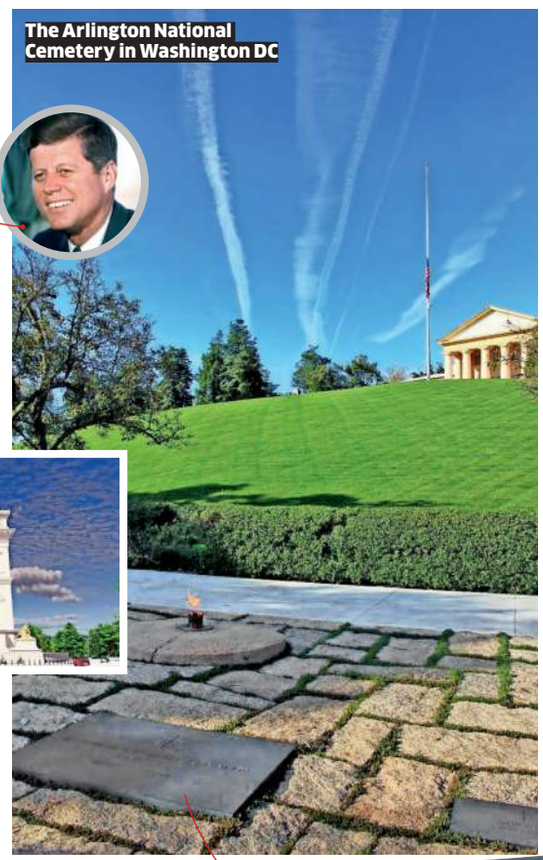
Former US president John F Kennedy's final resting place at the Arlington National Cemetery is a solemn spot visited by thousands of tourists and mourners everyday. They may have to contend with a new, and unforeseen, challenge: A shadow cast by the massive, 250-foot Triumphal Arch.

The proposed arch

Kennedy's descendants have moved court to block the planned arch in Washington DC, saying it could cast a shadow on the graves in the cemetery.

Arlington is the largest cemetery in the US, with over 4,00,000 people buried there, including military and war veterans.

The lawsuit comes after a federal judge had issued an order to temporarily halt construction.


The Arlington National Cemetery in Washington DC

"President Donald J Trump is attempting to unlawfully erect a massive arch that will permanently cast shadows and damage significant sightlines to the existing gravesites and memorials at Arlington National Cemetery, as well as to the memorials of hundreds of thousands of fallen American heroes," the lawsuit reads.

Shadowy arch

Analysis by *The Washington Post* had found that the arch would briefly cover Kennedy's eternal flame on 18 days of the year and would shade the former president's memorial on 50. Over the course of a year, the shadow of the arch would touch burial sites in Arlington National Cemetery on 284 days.

A White House spokesperson, however, defended the project and criticised the "activist district court" that halted construction. "It is unfortunate to see that some members of the Kennedy family have joined the litigation against the arch, as the project is intended to honour our heroes who rest in Arlington Cemetery," spokesman Davis Ingle said. "The judiciary should not be abused to politicise a structure designed to unite."

The triumphal arch has been Donald Trump's dream project

PIC: REUTERS

Mitigating factors

The US Interior Department, which is managing the project, said that the arch's designers ran models and found that only a small section of the cemetery would be affected after its opening, and for less than two weeks a year. "That period is less than an hour after sunrise, at which point shadows are very lengthened and distorted, and are mingled with the long shadows of trees," the department said.

Recently, US District Judge Tanya S Chutkan blocked work on the arch while the court considers challenges to its legality. Three Vietnam War veterans, a historic preservationist, the DC government and the Commonwealth of Virginia have all sued the structure previously.

The family members are Kennedy's brother Robert's seven children with wife Ethel; former Congressman Joe Kennedy; and his grandson Edward Kennedy Jr, Ted Kennedy's son.

– Washington Post

The hidden world in Rembrandt's 'Night Watch'

For centuries, millions of people have marvelled at Rembrandt's use of light and shadows to depict the militia in his masterpiece, the 'Night Watch'.

Little did they know they were also looking at a hidden world of characters, some of them from as far away as Japan.

A new exhibition, 'The Night Watch Lives', lifts the veil on this clandestine universe: The microbes covering one of the most famous works of the Dutch Golden Age paintings.

Science meets art

A joint effort by Rijksmuseum, where 'The Night Watch' hangs, and Amsterdam's Artis-Micropia Museum (more commonly known as the city's 'microbe zoo') reveals the microscopic world covering the iconic painting.

The bacteria, isolated from samples taken over six months at around 60 different spots on the painting and subsequently cultivated into colonies, are displayed in Petri dishes alongside a life-size reproduction of the painting at the Artis-Micropia museum.

"We found a lot of microbes that are very commonly found, for instance, on human skin, or in the soil," said Eline van Bloois, a microbiologist at the museum.

The microbes are not harmful to the painting itself, van Bloois said, and it was impossible to determine if some of them could be a remnant from the great master himself.

"It would be really cool, right? If they could be linked to Rembrandt. But unfortunately, from one microbe, you cannot say whether it's been on there for 400 years or for a day," she said.

Sparking curiosity

One of the most surprising findings was microbacterium saccharophilum, a bacteria commonly found at a Japanese sugar refinery. It was found in an area where the varnish had been removed.

"That's something that will keep me up for years," van Bloois said.

'The Night Watch', a 1642 painting by Rembrandt, and (right) a rough sketch by the Dutch artist

PICS: RIJKSMUSEUM, WIKI

The idea behind the exhibit was to spark people's curiosity about microbes, the life teeming all around humans.

It's part of 'Operation Night Watch', a large-scale research and restoration project on the painting, which has been ongoing since 2019, in a specially designed glass chamber at the Rijksmuseum.

– AFP

From Russian royalty to rare pink diamonds, jewels take centre stage in Geneva

The 198-carat vivid blue Ceylon sapphire bracelet

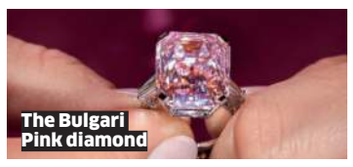
Geneva's seasonal jewellery auctions have brought together some of the world's rarest gemstones and storied royal heirlooms, with a 24-carat pink diamond from the Golconda mines and a spectacular 198-carat sapphire linked to Russia's imperial Romanovs taking centre stage.

A 24-carat fancy intense pink diamond ring sold at an auction for 12.1 million Swiss francs ($14.6 million), Christie's said.

The emerald-cut 'Bulgari Pink' had been expected to fetch 10-15 million francs ($12-18 million) as the headline item of the auction.

Ahead of the sale, Max Fawcett, Christie's global head of jewellery, trumpeted the stone as "the Mona Lisa of pink diamonds".

The Christie's sale also featured a private collection of nearly 300 20th-century jewels, including creations by Bulgari, Cartier and Graff.


The Bulgari Pink diamond

Imperial legacy

Meanwhile, Sotheby's Geneva auction turns the spotlight on European royal history, with a 198-carat vivid blue Ceylon sapphire associated with Russia's Romanov dynasty among its leading lots.

The vivid blue Ceylon sapphire, measuring roughly three by 3.5 centimetres, entered the Romanov collection in the mid-19th century although the gemstone itself is far older, said Andres White Correal, chairman of jewellery at auctioneer Sotheby's.

The sapphire was listed for sale after the 1917 Bolshevik Revolution and eventually made its way from the Bolsheviks via several owners to Cartier, which created its current diamond-set bracelet mounting in 2015, he said.

Sotheby's said the sapphire was once mounted by Fabergé as a diamond brooch.

Its sale value is estimated at between 850,000 and 1.7 million Swiss francs ($1 million to $2 million).

– Agencies

quote unquote

PIC: GETTY IMAGES

"You could be having a great morning. You read one thing, and it just ruins your whole day."

– DECLAN RICE, Arsenal and England midfielder, saying he has reduced his social media consumption because it's bad for his mental health. Rice said he quit X three years ago after he was abused online.

King Charles and Elton John mark 50 years of charity

Britain's King Charles joined Elton John for a special edition of the singer's radio show to celebrate 50 years of The King's Trust and musicians who have supported the youth charity, the Buckingham Palace said.

The episode of 'Elton John's Rocket Hour', will air on November 14, Charles's 78th birthday.

While he was Prince of Wales, Charles founded the Prince's Trust in 1976 using his Royal Navy severance pay to help disadvantaged young people prepare for work, find jobs or start businesses. Renamed the King's Trust after Charles became king, the charity says it has supported more than a million youngsters.

"Music has always been at the heart of the prince's, and now the king's trust," Charles said,.

The pair recalled benefit concerts stretching from Wembley Arena's rock galas in the 1980s to shows in Hyde Park and at the Royal Albert Hall.

Elton John (left) with King Charles

Among them was British rock band Muse, which received a grant to buy sound equipment when it performed under its former name Rocket Baby Dolls. The group later held a sold-out Royal Albert Hall concert in aid of the trust in 2018.

"If you champion a young artiste and show you believe in them, it makes all the difference," John said. "Young people are our future."

– Reuters

A picture of togetherness

Beyond the spotlight, celebrities turn the camera towards people they hold dear, offering glimpses of their special bond

1

2

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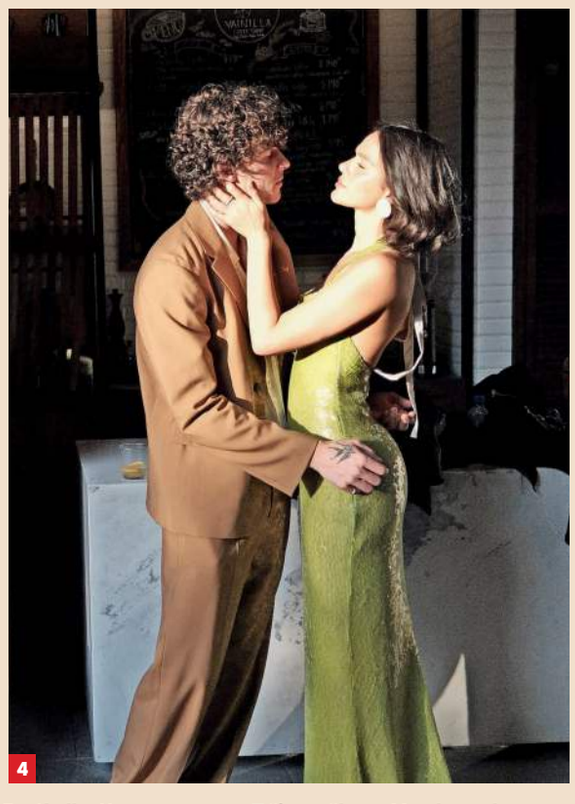
4

PICS: INSTAGRAM

1 Tennis legends Andre Agassi and Steffi Graf shared a romantic moment, with Agassi posting: "Lucky to have you, Stefanie."

2 South African cricketer Faf du Plessis shared an affectionate moment with his daughter Zoey, captioning it "My Girls."

3 Footballer Neymar Jr and partner, Bruna Biancardi, who are expecting their third child, at the Brazilian Grand Prix.

4 Singer Shawn Mendes and girlfriend Bruna Marquezine looked smitten as they posed for the camera. "Remember to celebrate love, feeling really blessed," Mendes wrote.

THE REMORSE CODE

Some apologies mend bridges, others just save face. Here's a look at how different people say sorry

Shannika Ramos

An apology can be as revealing as the offence it is meant to atone for. Take the case of Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang, who found himself in the headlines this past week for something other than his trillion-dollar company's AI ambitions.

In an email to employees on November 8, Huang admitted to being unfaithful to his wife. "There is no excuse for what I did. I am deeply sorry," he wrote, acknowledging that an apology could not undo his actions. "I hope our family will heal and that, over time, I can earn back your trust."

Not everyone, however, chooses to address a controversy head-on. In July 2025, Andy Byron, then CEO of New York-based data software company Astronomer, became the subject of a viral controversy after being caught embracing the company's then chief people officer, Kristin Cabot, on the kiss cam at a Coldplay concert. While Byron largely remained silent and, Cabot later addressed the incident on a podcast, describing it as a "poor judgement call".

Both incidents offer a glimpse into the tricky business of saying sorry.

If you've ever found yourself wondering whether someone's apology was actually an apology at all, chances are you've encountered one of these:

Former Astronomer CEO Andy Byron never apologised over the kiss-cam controversy, while Kristin Cabot later called it a "poor judgement call"

Jensen Huang finds himself in the eye of a storm over his relationship with Alice Huang

PICS: GETTY IMAGES

1 The non-apology

Technically an apology, but somehow manages to avoid taking any responsibility. Its primary purpose is to appease and make it appear that the matter has been resolved. In reality, it may not have even scratched the surface. "I'm sorry for whatever I did that offended you," can be translated to: "I'm sorry you're upset, but don't expect me to figure out why."

In 2025, singer Justin Bieber apologised to wife Hailey over a past remark that she would never grace the cover of a fashion magazine, admitting his words were "mean"

2 The meme/GIF apology

When words fail, memes take over. It may lighten the mood or break the awkwardness, but the humour becomes a convenient escape from acknowledging the hurt and offering a sincere apology. For some, this kind of comic relief might do the trick when the offence is relatively minor. For others, a video of a cat or dog with watery eyes and a saccharine-sweet message might feel less like an apology and more like a joke.

3 The conditional apology

This is an apology that is immediately followed by justifications. By adding an 'if' or 'but', the person shifts attention away from their wrongful actions and towards the other person's reaction or circumstances. This one is less about making amends and more about proving that they were right all along.

Singer Liam Gallagher faced backlash from fans for his half-hearted apology in 2025 after posting a racial slur online

4 The reverse apology

Ever found yourself apologising to someone who owes you an apology? That is a reverse apology. It may have seemed like the right thing to do in the heat of the moment, but conversations with friends and colleagues, rereading of the messages or simply a little distance can make the penny drop: You've been played. What appeared to be a reasonable attempt at resolving a disagreement turns out to be a masterclass in gaslighting.

5 The subject-changing apology

This is an apology that barely acknowledges the issue before swiftly changing the subject. Think "Let it be, I said I was sorry, didn't I?" and "I apologise for upsetting you, but let's not ruin our day with this." Rather than addressing the hurt, these statements attempt to end the conversation. Before long, you start second-guessing yourself: Did I make a big deal out of it? Was it really that serious? And just like that, the focus shifts from what was done to you, to whether you were justified in being upset about it in the first place.

Apologising is never easy; it forces you to take accountability and become vulnerable. Whether it's a text, a conversation or a grand gesture, what matters is that the sentiment behind the apology doesn't get lost in translation.

– shannika.ramos@timesofindia.com

JUST 1 QUESTION

Is feline hypertension a silent killer?

PIC: GETTY IMAGES

It's true that high blood pressure (hypertension) in cats has often been called a silent killer, because signs may not be apparent until a disease is advanced.

Feline hypertension is defined as a systolic blood pressure greater than 160 mmHg. Systolic pressure is the peak pressure in the arteries each time the heart contracts; it is the first, higher number in a blood pressure reading.

When the heart relaxes between beats, the second number (diastolic) is lower. In feline medicine, the focus is primarily on that reading because it helps assess risk of damage to vital organs.

Two conditions may be the primary causes of feline hypertension: Kidney disease and excessive production of a target thyroid hormone (hyperthyroidism). Less commonly, various adrenal diseases are involved. The secondary problems caused by hypertension are severe, which emphasises the importance of regular health checks in older cats to ensure early prevention.

Hypertension specifically damages several major organs – a concept known as target organ damage which also includes the eyes. It can cause sudden blindness due to haemorrhage or retinal detachment.

The brain can be affected, leading to disorientation, altered behaviour, balance problems, or seizures.

The heart is another target; thickening of the left ventricle causes it to become a less effective pump.

Kidney disease is a double-edged sword: It is both a primary cause of hypertension and an organ target that can be worsened by it, accelerating failure.

– Daily Mirror

An open-faced bruschettone

Artichokes served with a plant-based cashew sauce at the restaurant

Rome restaurant gives iconic dishes a vegan twist

A family-run restaurant in Rome is rethinking the city's cuisine, putting a vegan twist on dishes usually heavily reliant on meat and dairy.

Rifugio Romano had served Roman classics for decades before switching to an entirely plant-based menu in 2023.

"When we first went vegan, we decided to have two menus, one traditional and one vegan. I wanted them to taste the same," the owner, Rosa Liotta said. "I didn't want the plant-based one to feel sad and flavourless. I wanted vegans to enjoy the same culinary experience as non-vegans."

Rather than abandoning Roman culinary traditions, the family reinterprets them with vegan ingredients: Mushrooms stand in for meat and seaweed adds seafood flavours.

The name *rifugio*, meaning 'shelter', reflects the family's aim of creating a welcoming space where people can share a meal regardless of their diet.

The proportion of Italians identifying as vegan has more than quintupled since 2014, from 0.6 per cent to 3.2 per cent in 2026, according to the Italian research institute, Eurispes.

Liotta said she was especially pleased when non-vegans came to eat. "I want them to realise vegan food today is so much more than just salad."

– AFP

Rituals

Sarah & Sandeep pintuck kurta ₹85k

Miss Jo statement brooch ₹23k

Fizzy Goblet embellished juttis ₹4.9k

GET THE LOOK

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Soirées

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Aston Martin quartz watch ₹26.9k

HOW TO

- With calendars filling up with parties, celebrations and family gatherings, dressing smartly is key. Invest in a versatile button-down shirt that can take you from a daytime get-together to an evening celebration with just a few tweaks.
- Pair *juttis* with well-fitted trousers or relaxed-fit chinos for an Indo-Western edge.
- For finishing touches, introduce a glint of metal, like a statement watch or a standout brooch: A little accessorising goes a long way.

Aprajita Toor marocchino brogues ₹5k

price of love

FORMS OF FINANCIAL INFIDELITY THAT CAN HURT YOUR RELATIONSHIP

Even if the motive is well-intentioned, secrecy around money can still feel like betrayal, experts say

Jenna Ryu

When you hear 'infidelity', you probably think of a romantic betrayal involving another person: A kiss, an affair, a secret emotional attachment. But there's another form of deception many couples grapple with that has nothing to do with that: Financial infidelity.

As you might assume, the term generally refers to lying to a partner about money or deliberately hiding financial decisions from them. But part of what makes this kind of betrayal so hard to identify and repair, research shows, is that there's no universally agreed-upon definition.

What feels like a harmless shopping spree to one couple could represent a serious violation to another.

"It's okay to keep some things to yourself," said Lindsay Bryan-Podvin, a certified financial therapist and author. The distinction, she said, is secrecy. That deception can, of course, have serious financial consequences, especially when it involves high stakes moves like opening a secret bank account or withdrawing a large sum from shared savings.

So, what does financial infidelity look like? Here are some of the most common ways it shows up, according to experts, and how to tell when a money move crosses the line.

Consent is key

Maybe you enter a relationship with significant credit card debt, student loans or medical bills and never mention it. Keeping a major balance hidden can be one of the more consequential forms of financial infidelity, said Stephanie Zepeda, a licensed marriage and family therapist and owner of Financial Therapy Texas.

"It kind of goes back to consent," said Zepeda. "Are they consenting to this debt? Are they consenting to this use of the finances?"

For many families, helping

PIC: GETTY IMAGES

out financially is just part of taking care of one another. So, it may seem perfectly reasonable to cover your mom's medical bill without checking in with your significant other first or to send your niece some cash for college because she's short this semester.

And there may be a perfectly understandable reason someone hides the decision. Maybe they worry their partner thinks their family is taking advantage of them, or saying no to a

Growing up around financial disputes may make some people avoid financial conversations

parent or sibling feels worse than not mentioning the money.

Even if the motive is well-intentioned, the secrecy can still feel like betrayal, said Bryan-Podvin.

A painful message

Once you discover your partner has quietly been giving money to family, the impact can go beyond needing to tighten next month's budget or to postpone a vacation. You may start wondering: What else aren't they telling me? Why didn't we have a conversation about this?

Maybe they worry their partner will want a bigger house or more expensive vacations. Or maybe they already know what they want to do with the money – pay off debt or build savings – and don't want to have to defend that choice.

Talk it through

For others, the roots run deeper. Someone who grew up watching their parents fight about money may have learned that the safest way to handle financial stress is not to talk about it. Bryan-Podvin recommends laying out your current financial reality, including income, debt, savings, recurring expenses and obligations to family. Then talk through expectations: Are we still on the same page about our goals? What are we saving for? How much are we putting away, and should we adjust it? Which expenses do we need to discuss together?

The goal isn't to see every financial decision the same way, but it's to make sure neither of you feels the need to hide one.

– The Washington Post

Manufacturing the past

Experts are finding that AI may make us recall things that never happened

Ariana Eunjung Cha

AI GENERATED

The experiment began with 24 ordinary photographs: A wedding, a city street, a race. Pattie Maes, a professor at the MIT Media Lab, US, and her colleagues showed them to 200 people. After a break, some saw the same photos again. Others saw AI-altered versions — with facial expressions changed or signs of climate change added.

Then came a memory test. Those viewing the AI-altered images had a large increase in false recollections. Even worse, she said, their confidence in the false memories was higher.

So far, much of the public anxiety about AI has centred on 'cognitive surrender': The possibility that, as machines take over more of the work of thinking, people will become less inclined or able to scrutinise what those machines tell them. But another possibility has received less attention: AI may be changing what we remember.

Memory retrieval

In one experiment undergoing peer review, 54 people were asked to write essays. One group had no online tools. Another could use Google search, stripped of AI-generated answers. A third could use ChatGPT.

The differences were striking. The people writing unaided showed the strongest and most broadly distributed electrical activity patterns between different areas of the brain. Google users fell somewhere in the middle. The ChatGPT users showed the weakest connectivity. When participants were later asked to quote from their essays, the ChatGPT users had considerably more trouble recalling their own words.

There are already hints of what researchers sometimes call 'de-skilling'. A 2025 study published in *The Lancet Gastroenterology & Hepatology* details the potential effect. Researchers looked at 19 experienced doctors and their assessments of nearly 1,500 colonoscopies and found that after the doctors began routinely using AI, their ability to detect precancerous growths on their own decreased by about 20 per cent.

For children, researchers worry that they may outsource cognitive work before some of those abilities have fully developed.

Distorting the mind

A growing body of research suggests that generative AI can interfere with memory in surprisingly durable ways. That includes distorting what we remember, blurring the boundaries between our own thoughts and those generated by machines, and even planting memories of events that never happened.

In one study, researchers asked participants to watch a video of a crime and found that those questioned by a generative AI chatbot had three times as many false memories. In another, people were prompted to generate ideas with and without AI, and a week later they had trouble remembering which ideas originated with the machine and which ones were their own.

Other experiments suggest AI-generated misinformation can lead people to remember things that never happened at all. In one experiment, nearly half of the participants falsely remembered movie remakes that never existed, including a version of *The Matrix* starring Will Smith. In another, AI-generated videos convinced people they remembered political scandals that never happened. However, the researchers noted that deepfakes were not consistently more effective than text in creating false memories.

Human oversight

One of the most common safeguards, said Mattea Sim, an assistant research professor at Georgetown University's Massive Data Institute, is to keep a human in the loop to catch the machine's mistakes. But that assumes the human remains independent.

Sim recruited 331 people to watch a short, animated video of a car striking a pedestrian. A day or two later, the participants read an AI-generated summary of the accident. For some, it accurately described a traffic sign in the video. From them, nearly 84 per cent correctly remembered the sign. For others, the summary identified the wrong sign. Among those, just about 45 per cent correctly remembered it.

Telling participants that the summary had been generated by AI did not protect them from being influenced by it. Sim said the research shows "human oversight may not be a great solution to this problem". •

– The Washington Post

A model's dilemma

As AI-generated faces flood fashion, their real-life inspirations question the industry's future

L'Oreal's booth at the World Artificial Intelligence Conference hosted in July in China

AI-generated fashion models present brands the ability to create lifelike images for their retail websites while cutting costs compared to photo shoots with human models. But as its use expands and regulation fails to keep up, modelling agencies are seeing bookings decline, photo studios close and their models facing the loss of a chunk of their livelihoods. AI allows retailers to endlessly rework and redeploy a model's image wearing different outfits at a fraction of the cost of new shoots.

"Some brands ask to modify faces, bodies, skin, age or expressions after shoots using AI. Others are asking about creating 'digital twins' of models that they can reuse later without needing another production," said Patrick Staal, owner of modelling agency Uniko Models in Barcelona.

Model Adot Gak raised concerns about AI in fashion: "If we don't speak up, the industry will soon be full of bots"

PIC: AP

Major brands are asking to swap faces, create digital twins and train AI tools using models' photos from shoots

Ambiguous language

In a photoshoot casting sheet, Italian brand Diesel asked models to agree to "alteration or reconstruction of facial features and body proportions", along with "swapping of faces among the participating models", and "superimposition of the participant's face onto another person's body". A Calvin Klein draft contract asked the model to accept, for no extra pay, that the brand "may use reasonably unrecognisable images of Model (no identifying features such as Model's face, scars, tattoos or otherwise) to train and fine tune AI tools for learning general model attributes".

Melanie Howard, partner and chair of luxury brands at US law firm Loeb & Loeb, said such sweeping language "is dangerous in its ambiguity" and makes it difficult for models to challenge any unsanctioned use of their images.

Some firms are openly embracing AI to replace models and save money.

Fast-fashion retailer About You is launching Scayle Studios. It creates digital imagery for other retailers using AI-generated models and promises a more than 90 per cent production-cost reduction. Scayle has 130 brand clients and has generated 1,90,000 outfits in September, according to a company spokesperson.

"A lot of young talents don't fully understand the long-term consequences yet," said Staal. "Signing away AI rights at 20 years old could still affect someone ten years later." •

– Reuters

Used cooking oil powers luxury tours to Antarctica

Johannesburg-based Sasol, the world's biggest producer of fuel and chemicals from coal, ranks as one of South Africa's biggest greenhouse-gas emitters. In a shift, it is making sustainable aviation fuel, or SAF, from used cooking oil at its refinery in Natref, South Africa.

Tour operator White Desert, whose offerings range from one-day trips from Cape Town with attractions such as rappelling down a glacier, to a seven-day itinerary that includes a visit to Antarctica's Blue Rivers, has been signed up as a first customer. It began using SAF in 2021, according to its website.

SAF is a low-carbon fuel alternative made from non-petroleum feedstocks that help cut air pollution from air travel. Aviation accounts for two per cent of all carbon dioxide emissions and 12 per cent of the gas from transportation, according to the US Department of Energy. The market for SAF is currently tiny, accounting for about 0.6 per cent of jet fuel demand last year.

For now, supplying White Desert is seasonal and even though SAF prices can be two to three times higher than conventional aviation fuel, Sasol has seen interest from other potential customers and is finalising commercial terms with them. •

– Bloomberg

PIC: GETTY IMAGES

Artemis on target for moon shot

NASA ramps up its plans to land astronauts on the Moon within two years

NASA is moving fast on its plans to build a Moon base and return astronauts to the lunar surface in as little as two years. Administrator Jared Isaacman recently said that the space agency is still on track to launch Artemis III next summer on a docking exercise. Artemis IV – NASA's first Moon landing by astronauts since Apollo – remains scheduled for 2028.

But the space agency is now accelerating its pace, he noted, as SpaceX, Blue Origin and other companies scramble around the clock to meet the deadlines and NASA bolsters its workforce.

Remaking history

Both landers will be launched next summer for docking practice by the three NASA astronauts and one Italian who will blast into orbit aboard NASA's Orion capsule. Orion will dock first with Blue Origin's Blue Ghost about 435 kilometres above Earth, then with SpaceX's Starship in a slightly lower orbit.

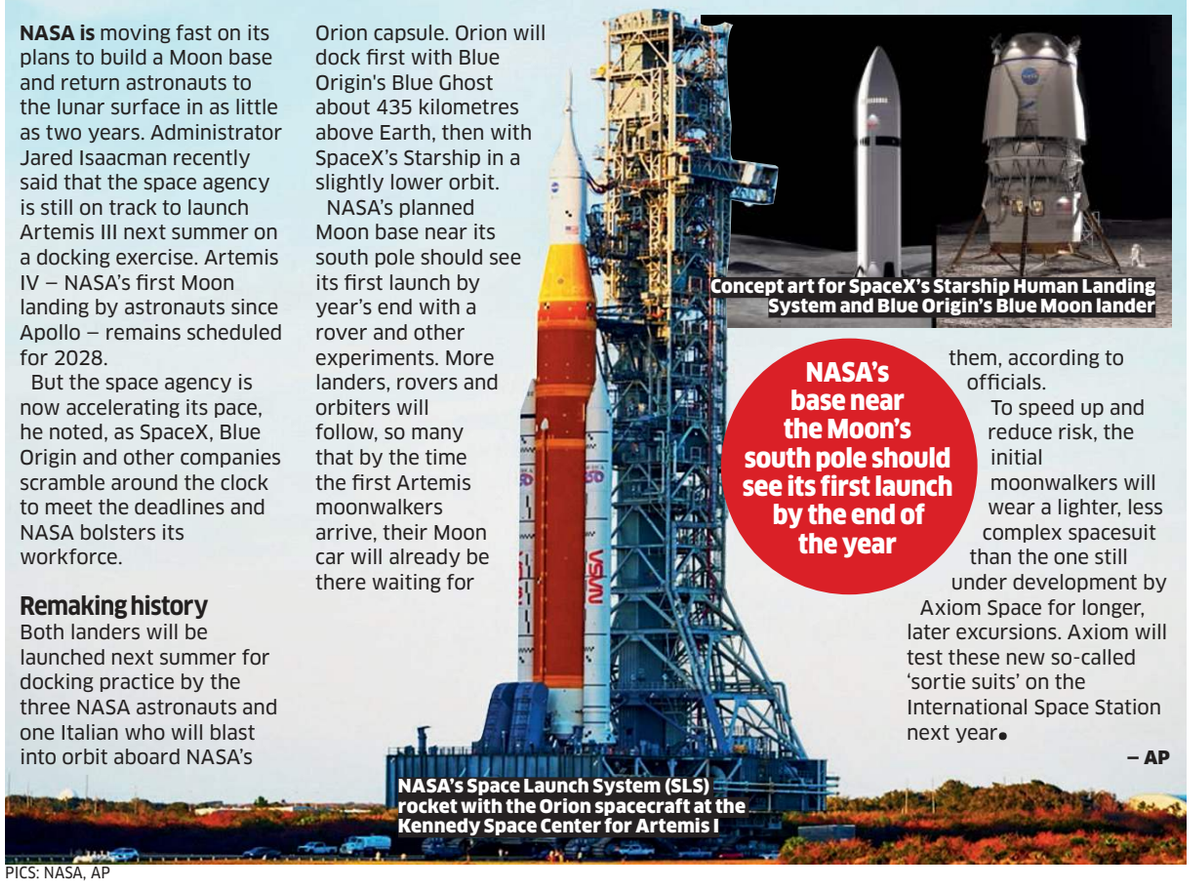
NASA's planned Moon base near its south pole should see its first launch by year's end with a rover and other experiments. More landers, rovers and orbiters will follow, so many that by the time the first Artemis moonwalkers arrive, their Moon car will already be there waiting for them, according to officials.

Concept art for SpaceX's Starship Human Landing System and Blue Origin's Blue Moon lander

NASA's base near the Moon's south pole should see its first launch by the end of the year

To speed up and reduce risk, the initial moonwalkers will wear a lighter, less complex spacesuit than the one still under development by Axiom Space for longer, later excursions. Axiom will test these new so-called 'sortie suits' on the International Space Station next year. •

– AP



NASA's Space Launch System (SLS) rocket with the Orion spacecraft at the Kennedy Space Center for Artemis I

PICS: NASA, AP

bird brained

Frequent fliers

How scientists are getting closer to solving the mysteries of migration

For most of ornithological history, scientists understood bird migration through brief glimpses. From these fragments, scientists reconstructed journeys that took place largely beyond their view. Today, it's possible to see the journeys themselves, almost in real time.

Gathering evidence

For more than 2,000 years, scientists scratched their heads over one of the most basic mysteries of the natural world: Where do birds go?

Early naturalists offered explanations that today seem fantastical: Birds transformed into other species, one theory went. Others suggested they hibernated underwater or even migrated to the Moon.

Then, in the early 1800s, white storks began appearing in Germany with African arrows embedded in their bodies. These birds became known as *pfeilstörche*, or 'arrow storks'. They provided compelling evidence that birds disappearing from Europe were travelling all the way to Africa and back. Bird banding was the first tool used to attempt a systematic approach. Of more than 79 million birds banded, only about 6.5 million have been recovered.

Over the past quarter-century or so, the tools used to determine where birds go have changed dramatically. Tracking devices can now be carried by increasingly smaller birds, recording their movements and communicating with land-based receivers or satellites orbiting the earth. Testing stable isotopes in feathers and other tissues can reveal where a bird originated. Genetic testing can distinguish populations. At the same time, the extraordinary growth of birdwatching and citizen science has created another revolution.

Why migration matters

Yet scientists have known surprisingly little about where specific populations go. The connections between where a bird breeds and where it spends the winter are called migratory connectivity. It is critical for understanding everything from the consequences of climate change on birds to how avian pathogens and diseases spread and a species's basic ecology.

North America has lost about three billion birds during the past half-century, and many migratory species continue to decline. To understand why a population is declining and help save it, researchers need to understand the species' entire annual cycle: Its critical stopover habitats, wintering grounds and threats along its migration routes.

For much of the history, scientists studied birds primarily during their breeding season. Birds are conspicuous then — singing, defending territories, building nests and raising young. But conditions such as weather, food availability and habitat quality encountered during migration can determine whether an individual survives to breed again.

Tracking technology has allowed researchers to follow individual birds across continents and oceans. Today, millions of birdwatchers contribute observations that, thanks to advances in data science, allow us to watch migration unfold. That knowledge is helping to identify where conservation efforts can make a difference for the future. •

– AP

PICS: GETTY IMAGES, AI GENERATED

Mbappé vs China: How a meme cancelled football

The French captain became the latest celebrity to realise the price of free speech, and now faces a long way back to redemption

PIC: AI GENERATED

Kylian Mbappé, Real Madrid and La Liga all issued separate apologies to China over the superstar striker's comments about Mao Zedong, but it still wasn't enough. Chinese broadcasters did not air a single match from that week's schedule, while Real Madrid's win at Racing Santander wasn't even available on paid television.

The boycott came about after the French captain, one of the best footballers on the planet, said he was amused by an internet meme showing his face photoshopped on Mao Zedong. The problem was his comment where he called the leader "some guy, think he's a Chinese dictator".

Mao remains officially revered as the hero of the communist revolution and founder of the People's Republic of China. Publicly mocking him is taboo in the country, and Mbappé's remarks saw him become the latest foreign sports figure or entity to infuriate Beijing.

Major Chinese brands have cut ties with the 27-year-old, and Chinese state media and social media users lined up to slam him, even those who were in the dark about what exactly he said.

'Serious damage'

China is the world's second biggest economy and can be hugely lucrative for sporting leagues and teams.

A spokesman for China's Foreign Ministry said Beijing took Mbappé's apology "seriously".

Real Madrid coach José Mourinho said the club had "done our part" to put the controversy behind them, while La Liga president Javier Tebas said they're on wait-and-watch mode. "Given how events have unfolded, everything depends on things calming down, on all the mess easing," he said. "I'm speaking with the Chinese authorities and we're going to wait."

Tebas said the league's contracts with Chinese broadcasters were worth about $11.2 million a year.

But experts said it'll be a long road to redemption. "This is clearly a very damaging incident," veteran sports commentator Yan Qiang said. "It causes serious damage to the image of La Liga and Real Madrid in China. In the age of the internet, things blow up quickly on social media and emotions run high. An apology does not necessarily mean the end of the story."

Familiar tale

This script has played out before. Various overseas sports leagues or players have found themselves in hot water for comments on topics that are politically sensitive in China.

In 2019, China cut ties with the NBA after then-Houston Rockets general manager Daryl Morey tweeted his support for protesters in Hong Kong. NBA executives said Morey had the right to freedom of expression. In contrast, La Liga immediately distanced itself from what Mbappé said.

The NBA, which rivals football for popularity stakes in China, stayed off air for more than a year and is said to have lost hundreds of millions of dollars in revenue.

No way back?

Spanish football also has a lot to lose. A source within La Liga said China and the US finance the "majority" of international broadcasting rights, which were valued at 748 million euros for the 2024-25 season.

According to the Spanish newspaper *Marca*, Real Madrid generates between 10 and 15 per cent of its sales of jerseys and merchandise in China. Real Madrid also counts Chinese companies among its main sponsors, with Hisense, Kaiyun Sports and Linglong Tire all featuring prominently.

Adam Zhang, founder of the Beijing-based Key-Solution Sports Consulting, said showing fast and heartfelt remorse was the first step. "This will influence the decision on whether to continue the broadcast ban and, if so, for how long," he said.

But Yan cast doubt over whether Mbappé's reputation can ever recover fully. "Judging by commercial sponsorships and big ad campaigns he appeared in during the World Cup, he has a huge influence in China," he said. "If that influence can't be sustained, there can be no talk of commercial interests, and La Liga and Real Madrid will definitely be badly affected."

Yan said it was "genuinely hard to predict" what happens next. "In the short term, I'm not optimistic," he added. "If they want to repair their image, their future actions and behaviour will be key." •

– AFP

Paris FC players during a recent match

PICS: AFP, GETTY IMAGES

Arnault scion takes charge of Paris's second club

Antoine Arnault has been elected Paris FC's new president following the resignation of Pierre Ferracci, the French Ligue 1 club said.

Ferracci took charge of the club in 2012 and oversaw its rise from the third tier of French football to the top-flight. Arnault joined the Paris board in 2024 after Agache Sport and Red Bull acquired a majority share in the club.

"It is an honour and a source of pride to succeed Pierre Ferracci on behalf of my family"

The 49-year-old is the CEO and vice-chairman of French luxury goods brand Christian Dior, and the eldest son of billionaire Bernard Arnault, the CEO of the LVMH conglomerate.

"It is an honour and a source of pride to succeed Pierre Ferracci on behalf of my family. He has been the tireless architect of the Paris FC project for nearly 20 years," Arnault said.

Paris FC are third in the Ligue 1 standings with 20 points after 10 rounds of games. This is only the club's second season in the top-flight, after having spent nearly four decades away. •

– Reuters

New York's coffee prices make even pop stars cry

New York City is notoriously expensive. So much so that even millionaire pop stars can feel the pinch.

Singer Harry Styles, who recently completed a 30-show residency at Madison Square Garden, thought prices for coffee in the city were some of the spookiest things he saw.

"It is a cappuccino. It can't be $10, it can't be," he said during a concert. "The scariest thing is the price of caffeinated beverages in this city. Astronomical. It's out of control," he added.

Styles also complained about expensive tipping. "And then they spin it around, and it's a 22 or 24 per cent [tip]. It's out of control," he added. New Yorkers typically tip 20 per cent for services in the city, something that confounds Britons like Styles.

However, some fans pointed to the apartment in Manhattan where the former One Direction star is living in, which reportedly costs in excess of $8 million, and said if he could afford that, a $10 coffee and $2 tip shouldn't be a problem for him.

Others also criticised ticket prices for his concerts — which went for as much as $1,000 — saying it adds to their cost of living. •

– Reuters

PICS: GETTY IMAGES

Making a power play

Influential names from the worlds of entertainment and art came together at the LACMA Gala in Los Angeles recently, raising nearly $7 million in funds

PICS: GETTY IMAGES

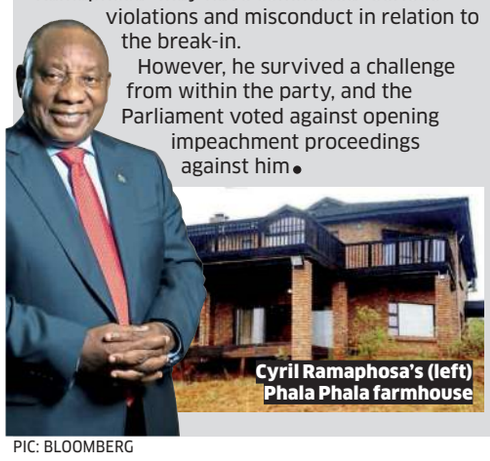
$580,000

The amount that was stolen from South African President Cyril Ramaphosa's luxury farmhouse in 2020, a scandal that nearly cost him his job. Six years after the heist, a court has found two men guilty.

The saga erupted in 2022, when South Africa's former spy chief lodged a complaint accusing Ramaphosa of concealing the theft, alleging the burglars had made off with $4 million instead. Ramaphosa said the money – an amount he pegged at $580,000 – actually came from the theft of 20 buffaloes.

But the scandal was enough to question his leadership. An independent panel said Ramaphosa "may have committed" serious violations and misconduct in relation to the break-in.

However, he survived a challenge from within the party, and the Parliament voted against opening impeachment proceedings against him •



Cyril Ramaphosa's (left) Phala Phala farmhouse

PIC: BLOOMBERG

dogs of (cold) war

Remembering Laika, the original animal rights icon

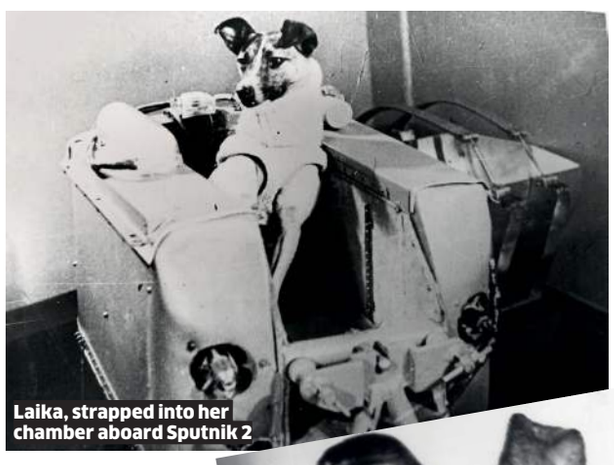
Matthew Hay Brown

The news from Moscow was positive. It had been four days since the Soviet Union launched Laika, the first dog in space, to global adoration.

It was 1957, the Cold War had split the world in two, but the two halves were united by their love of Laika. From Moscow to Montana, people were searching the sky above for a glimpse of a streaking white blip that would be Sputnik 2, carrying the three-year-old canine.

It was believed that Laika, a spitz-terrier mix, would soon be coming back home. "Return of the dog would complete a triumph in the saga of the second satellite: A roundtrip into space," the *Associated Press* enthused. "The parachute drop would be the longest ever."

What they didn't know, of course, was that the big-eyed, pointy-eared pup was already dead by then. She must have succumbed to overheating inside Sputnik within hours of its launch. The truth was, there was never any plan to bring her back alive.



Laika, strapped into her chamber aboard Sputnik 2

Space race

For the Soviets, the launch of Sputnik 1 had not only been a scientific triumph, but also a propaganda coup. Moscow's mastery of the technology required to send the first man-made satellite into orbit, and the military superiority it implied, had provoked a crisis of confidence in the West, and Soviet premier Nikita Khrushchev was delighted.

Nearly seven decades ago, the Soviet Union sent a dog into space with no plans of bringing her back alive

Eager to expand this lead, Khrushchev gave his space programme just weeks to ready the next mission: Launching an animal into orbit.

That was time enough to select a dog from a Moscow shelter, surgically implant a device to monitor her vital signs and get her accustomed to the quarter-cubic-metre space into which she would be sealed. But there wasn't enough time to plan a re-entry to Earth.

Though animal welfare groups condemned the mission as cruel, there didn't exist an organised movement like it does today. Moreover, that the mission would be a one-way trip for Laika wasn't part of the announcement.

Blast off

Laika was given enough nutrition and oxygen to survive seven to 10 days. Over the next week, Soviet officials claimed daily that the dog was alive and well. Then, they said, she was euthanised humanely before her capsule ran out of oxygen.

It wasn't until 1991, after the Soviet Union collapsed, that the truth emerged: During liftoff, Laika's heart-rate tripled and her pulse quadrupled. When the rocket entered orbit, heat insulation tore away. Inside the capsule, temperatures rose above 100 degrees Celsius. Laika is believed to have died between five and seven hours into the flight. The craft circled for another 161 days, completing some 2,570 laps of Earth before falling from orbit.

The aftermath

For the Soviets, the achievement of Sputnik 2 was tempered by the outcry against the premeditated killing of a live animal.

In the coming years, the Soviets continued to launch dogs and even monkeys and chimps into space. But never again was an animal the victim of a suicide mission; all these flights had plans for the animals' recovery.

As for Laika, she became a seminal figure in the animal rights movement and rights advocates continue to invoke her memory in arguments against animal testing. •

– The Washington Post